The Colony
Stories from a Down East Island

Remembering things I never knew
about Grandfather Orris and his times

Lowell P. Beveridge, Jr.

The Colony

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Published by Lowell P. Beveridge, Jr.

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Albion
Arthur
Lyford

Preface

The islands of Penobscot Bay, Maine, hold a special place in the American imagination, and are as exotic in their own way as the Aleutian Islands or the Florida Keys or the sand islets in the passes of the Louisiana Gulf Coast.

A particular breed of innovative and very hardy fishing and farming families settled them—particular in that unlike almost any other demographic in America, many of them were equally comfortable and adept at planting and harvesting, mowing hay, woodcutting and carpentry, as they were at commercial fishing and handling boats, boatbuilding, clamming. Perhaps at no place or time on earth were farming and seafaring so expertly married in single families, in single individuals. The lore and myths, humor and culture of every- thing we think of as "Downeast" came out of this remarkable time. It was a short-lived and colorful phenomenon. The islands were settled just as The United States of America was coming into being, and within a hundred and fifty years the agrarian and fishing economies were almost wholly supplanted by an economy centered around the caretaking and provisioning of "Summer People", with a small percentage of families continuing to make a living off the sea in lobster boats.

What makes *The Colony* so peculiar and wonderful is that it follows the close history of a single family through the entirety of this unique era and up to the present day, and probably could have been written by only a handful of people. Pete Beveridge was born into the last days of the island's true working subsistence farms when hay was forked up by hand and families still built their own houses, and his interests and passions as a boy led him to learn and practice as much as he could of these skills. He handled a two man crosscut saw and learned to clam and hay and build houses. But he was also blessed by being born into a family of scholarly uncles and aunts who collected priceless oral histories from relatives and neighbors, and kept detailed archives of family history. Pete himself became a dedicated historian and genealogist.

The voices come through out of the past in the cadences of a time and place that will never exist again. And the daily details of those lives are almost tactile: What was it like to row eight miles at night to the mainland to fetch a doctor and then bring him back in the same rowboat before morning? To raise eight children with no running water, with a single horse to plow and skid and ride? How does it feel to mow four acres by oneself with a scythe? What were the daily chores, the threats and joys. What was seaweed used for, and how *did* they fit thirty neighbors into a tiny parlor for a dance—and why did the fiddler have to press himself into a nook next to the pantry? Could a kid ever top the thrill of running down to Marsh Cove and seeing a weir filled

with so many herring you could practically run across them? And when the farms and fisheries could no longer survive and most descendants moved to the towns of the mainland and became teachers, why did they return every summer, all summer, year after year, and build cottages and houses and plant large gardens, and try to educate their children in island ways?

I couldn't put it down. But what I loved most about reading this book is that the rigorously documented history is informed as much by memory as by research. By the love of a place and a people, and of relatives that are now long gone. So if I said *The Colony* was peculiar it is because it is a special blend of memoir and history, and a rare tribute to a landscape and a tribe of resourceful and imaginative elders.

It is also in some ways a cautionary tale: in the increasing speed of technological development, in our own rush toward lives that are increasingly specialized, and in the continuing concentration of populations into cities, there is the sense that we are losing touch with nature and with our true center, and perhaps with God. Because nature in the end rules all things; not computers or social media. The Maine islanders of *The Colony* adapted and thrived in a particularly exacting locale. They were comfortable, individually, and in families, in making a living from the land and the sea as few people have ever been. They organized with other families into communities that helped the weak and took care of the elderly and educated their children. Even as children moved away to other towns and cities in New England, they returned for months at a time and stubbornly practiced many of the old subsistence skills. They could do more than one type of work—they could do a dozen jobs reasonably well. I think we could learn from them. I think we have to. Because the seasons and the tides still rule us, and we pretend otherwise at our peril.

Peter Heller, author of *The Dog Stars* and *The Painter*

Down East History

Background

First some background of geography and history:

The two Fox Islands, North Haven and Vinalhaven, sit at the entrance to Penobscot Bay in the State of Maine about mid way between Rockland on the west and Deer Island on the east. North Haven, the northernmost of these two islands has a land area of 11.5 square miles (7,360 acres) — about half the size of Manhattan Island. In the census year of 2010, the population was 355. For the past 130 years the Island has been a popular summer resort for people "from away" originally called "rusticators" but now called "summer people" to distinguish them from the year-round population of "natives". Summer people are now the major industry on the Island, but it was not at the time of Orris' birth in 1860. Unless you have access to a private boat or airplane, the Island is accessible only by a ferry which runs three time a day from Rockland and takes a little over an hour. This relative isolation has helped to preserve the natural beauty and simple life style which makes the Island so attractive. Ironically, in earlier days before steam ships, railroads, automobiles or airplanes, when water and wind provided the fastest and most convenient long distance transportation, the Island was, relatively speaking, very accessible. Under favorable conditions, one could sail from Boston to North Haven in two days, whereas the same trip by horse drawn coach would take about two weeks, and even the rather crude accommodations of a working vessel would make for a more comfortable ride than would a fine carriage over dirt road.

The Gulf of Maine and the shallow waters of the adjacent Georges Bank and Grand Banks off Newfoundland had been known fishing grounds for centuries — one of the worlds most abundant and diverse habitats of sea life. The reason for this I will leave to more knowledgeable authorities to explain. The Native Americans cherished their access to this treasure and Europeans had been coming there to fish long before Columbus "discovered" America. They came from Iceland, England, France, Spain and Scandinavia, They made temporary camps on the islands and coast of Maine to replenish supplies and cure the fish which they caught, but never established a permanent colony. Salt cod from these fishing grounds was a sought after source of protein — it was cheap, non-perishable, plentiful and tasty. It fed the navies and merchant fleets of the world and also the slave populations of the Caribbean and North and South America. Eventually man's ingenuity, greed and shortsightedness destroyed this wonder of nature, but in 1860 cod was king — plentiful and profitable.

The native American tribes of the Wabanaki Confederacy: Abenakis, Maliseets, Passamaquoddies, and Micmacs, lived inland in the forest during the winter months where they would hunt and trap and

migrated to summer camps on the coast and the islands to gather berries and shell fish and catch and cure fish.

In the sixteenth century, long before the Pilgrims landed at Plymouth Rock, the same coast and islands of Maine had become familiar to English, Basque, Portuguese, Spanish, French, and Icelandic fishermen. These crews landed on the islands and coast to replenish supplies and set up temporary summer camps to cure fish. In the beginning there was enough space and fish for everyone; no group tried to establish permanent ownership, and there was relatively little conflict. When it finally came the conflict was a big one.

The permanent settlement of New England by Europeans began with the arrival of the Pilgrims in Plymouth in 1620. It grew substantially with the establishment of the Massachusetts Bay Colony in 1628 and the so-called Great Migration of over 10,000 people from England over a period of about ten years. The basic economy of these settlements was subsistence agriculture, supplemented by fishing, and craft work. To be sustainable each family required as much as fifty acres for raising crops, grazing live stock and harvesting wood for fuel and construction. This land had to be near a river or the ocean for ease of communication and transportation, a requirement that severely limited the amount of land available for settlement. The Abenakis and other native tribes had similar territorial requirements, although they had few permanent settlements, they needed free access to large areas for hunting, fishing and gathering to avoid depleting these natural resources.

There probably were enough land and other resources available to allow both groups to live together in peace and to prosper for a long time, maybe for ever, but that was not to be for a number of reasons. The Native Americans had no concept of private property. To them land was, like air and water, a common resource to be used and preserved by everyone. Although there were many instances of friendship and mutual cooperation between the two groups, these were trumped by bad behavior and retaliation. It did not take much of that to create a permanent atmosphere of aggression and distrust that lasted for generations. War and local raids were the norm. The Pequot war (1634-8), King Phillip's War (1675-8) and the French and Indian War (1754-1763) were the most vicious and long lasting. As the European population grew and required more land, new settlements had to be grouped in villages which could be fortified and defended. Every man of military age was armed and most were members of a militia.

The story of the westward migration during the Nineteenth Century of European settlers is well known, but less has been written about the earlier eastern migration from the earliest settlements around the Cape Cod area down the coast of what is now Maine and

up the rivers flowing into the ocean along that stretch of water. This route, mostly by sea, was much more convenient and available before the overland western tails had been opened up and later the canals and railroads were available. During this period what is now the State of Maine was a province of the Massachusetts Colony and thus subject to the King of England — at least theoretically. In practice civil and military control was thin and weak. There were conflicting claims from the Native Americans and the French and rival settlements. As far as the English were concerned the land belonged to the British Crown and land title came from the King who issued so-called Patents giving ownership or rights to large areas of land to well connected individuals or companies. These proprietors in turn recruited settlers to occupy and cultivate the land. They offered land and often transportation, tools and arms in return for labor and a commitment to settle and create a village. The usual deal was that the settler would be required to work for the proprietor's benefit a certain number of days per year for a period of five to seven years. The interests of the proprietors and the settlers did not always coincide. Conflict was the rule rather than the exception.

Thomas Beverage's New England.

1 Edgartown, MA
2 Attleboro, MA
3 Marshfield, MA
4 Dorchester, MA
5 Brattleboro, VT
6 Berwick, ME
7 Portland, ME
8 Brunswick/Topsham, ME
9 Hallowell, ME
10 North Haven, ME

This, then, was the general background for the early English settlement of the Fox Islands, an adventure that involved several of Grandfather Orris' ancestors. His parents, Benjamin and Amelia were old enough to remember these early settlers and must have passed some of the stories on to their son. For instance, Benjamin's grandfather, Thomas Beverage, one of the early settlers died in 1834 when Benjamin was 12 years old. Thomas' grandfather, James, emigrated from Scotland in the early eighteenth century to Marblehead, in the colony of Massachusetts, about twenty miles north east of Boston. He was probably an indentured servant.

There, his first son James, Jr., Thomas' father, was born in 1724. By that time things were getting pretty crowded in southern Massachusetts, so James the elder, like many of his contemporaries looked eastward for opportunity and land. In 1735 James joined the army and ended up with his family at Fort Richmond near the mouth of the Kennebec River just north of present day Bath, Maine. This was the site of one of a string of government run trading posts called truck houses. They supplied the local settlers and also traded with native tribes — an early version of counter-insurgency tactics aimed at winning over the hearts and minds of the enemy.

Down East Maine.

The fort was under the command of Captain John Minot, also from Marblehead. Minot later resigned and set up his own trading post in a house surrounded by a stockade on a long peninsula south of Brunswick called Mair Point (now called Mere Point). James the younger married the widow Jean McKinney White. She was from Ireland. Jean and her first husband, Nicholas White, had two sons: George and John. Nicholas was killed by Indians while on patrol. Jean and James were apparently living in Minot's stockade when their first son, Thomas was born in 1750. Soon the family moved to the neighboring town of Topsham, where Thomas grew up during the time of the French and Indian War (1756 — 1763).

The Peace of Paris at the end of that war removed the threat from the French and produced relative peace with the native tribes, so it was safer for settlers to move away from the protection of settled towns in search of land and opportunity. Most of the land in Maine at that time was controlled by Patents. The Waldo Patent, one of the largest, controlled much of mid-coast Maine including Topsham, but the Fox Islands, fell outside of the Waldo Patent's area. About sixty families eventually settled on the Fox Islands prior to the Revolutionary War.

About 1771 Thomas joined these early settlers on the Islands, including his step-brother, George White who had moved there five years earlier. They faced the hardships involved in starting a remote settlement from scratch. George Hosmer described the first homes of a similar settlement on neighboring Deer Isle:

"When the settler came, his first care was to provide a shelter for his family. A hut, the sides of which were built of logs, and the roof of bark . . . a wall of stones laid up for a fireplace, with a hole in the roof to let out the smoke and let in the light and air, and a floor, if any it had except the ground, made of small trees sided with an axe. The walls were plastered with clay or mud in the spaces between the logs caulked with moss to keep out the cold."

Among those first settlers of the Fox Islands were Captain Ezekiel Kent, his wife Susannah, and six of their children. Susannah is buried in the Kent Cemetery at the edge of Kent Cove on the southern shore of North Haven. As of this writing that property is still in the family. Ezekiel Kent was from Marshfield, Massachusetts, a coastal town about twenty miles south east of Boston. Several other early Fox Island settlers were from Marshfield. At that time, which was just before the outbreak of the War for Independence from England, Marshfield had a reputation for being a hot-bed of Tories — people loyal to England — an allegiance which became increasingly unpopular as the hostilities escalated. It may be that those who left at that time were distancing themselves

from their Tory neighbors, or merely trying to get away from an uncomfortable and potentially dangerous political situation.

Like many other residents of Marshfield, Ezekiel was a ship builder and owner as was his father, John Richard Kent II, who was also a Representative to the General Court of Massachusetts. Thomas Beverage met and courted Mercy Kent, one of Ezekiel's daughters. Since Thomas was the son of a common soldier and laborer he must have had some impressive personal qualities to be accepted into a socially prominent family such as the Kents. The fact that they were all early settlers living under rather primitive conditions may have leveled the social hierarchy.

The Kent family had survived war with the French and Indians, but as a sea fairing family had suffered more than its share of tragedies: in 1734 Susana Kent's first husband, Nathaniel Winslow, drowned in the North River near Marshfield at the age of 25; in 1763, Susana's son (Mercy's half-brother) Nathaniel Winslow, Jr., died at the age of 30 in the West Indies; in 1773 Josiah Winslow, the husband of Mercy's sister Penelope, was lost at sea at age 40 (he was also a first cousin of Penelope and Mercy); that same year Mercy's brother, Ezekiel Kent, Jr., fell overboard and drowned in Boston Harbor just a few months before Thomas and Mercy married in Boston on April, 13, 1774.

Interesting Times

That was an interesting time to be in Boston. It was a year before "the shot heard around the world" was fired at Lexington on April 19, 1775, thus starting the War for Independence against Great Britain, but the tension was already mounting. On the night of December 16, 1773, angry citizens dumped a cargo of tea into Boston Harbor in protest against a tax. Three months later on March, 7, 1774, a similar, but lesser known second Tea Party took place. This was just a month before Thomas and Mercy were married in Boston. There is a family story that Thomas participated in the Boston Tea Party. If true, no record of it survives — not surprising since it was an act of treason subject to the death penalty; participants went to great lengths to conceal their identities. Thomas' name is not in a list of participants published in the book Tea Leaves in 1884, however, Thomas likely knew some of the organizers and was in town when it happened. Whether or not he actually participated is, perhaps, less important than the fact that the story has persisted and is a matter of pride for his descendants. Thomas and Mercy's first child, John White Beverage, was born at their Fox Island home four months after their marriage. Judging by other genealogical records, this close timing of marriage and birth was not unusual for that time and place.

When hostilities finally broke out after the Battle of Lexington, life became hazardous and difficult for everyone in the Penobscot Bay

area — patriots, loyalists and fence sitters alike. The island and coastal communities were easy targets for the ships of the British royal navy, which repeatedly raided them for supplies and recruits. Eventually all the early settlers of the Fox Islands abandoned their homes and sought refuge further inland.

By 1779 the British had established a major fort at Majabigwaduce (now Castine), in Penobscot Bay near the mouth of the Penobscot River. Francis McLean, the commander of the fort issued in June of 1779 a proclamation requiring that all adult men in the area come to the fort and swear an oath of allegiance to the Crown or face dire consequences. In preparation for a massive attack on the fort at Castine in September, Solomon Lovell, Commander of the Patriot forces in the area issued a counter proclamation threatening dire consequences to anyone who swore allegiance to the crown. Fence sitting was not much of an option. The attack on the fort by the Patriot forces has been described as the infant country's worst naval disaster in history until Pearl Harbor. This defeat made matters even worse for the local citizens. Edward Gould in his monograph British and Tory Marauders of the Penobscot wrote,

There was a feeling of uneasiness among the small settlements on the Penobscot, because one could never know whether his next door neighbor was friend or foe.

The constant operation of the British marauding parties by land, and the "Shaving mills," as the small boats of the British were called, by sea, from 1779 to 1783, swept American commerce from the eastern ocean and completely scattered the inhabitants of the Islands and the Main, so that some settlements were completely obliterated.

The people lived by the products of the soil and what could be caught from the sea. The parties of British and Tories burned the log houses of the settlers, stole or destroyed their boats and vessels, killed or drove off their live stock, devastated the growing crops, carried away the food products stored in cellars for winter use, imprisoned the old men and boys whom the war had left to operate the farms, as most of the men of military age were in the Continental service.

After destroying all a family might have of habitation and means of livelihood, then the women with their numerous small children were driven into the woods to suffer and die.

Thomas may have been involved in that ill-fated expedition against Castine. He may also have been a privateer during the war. After the war Thomas and Mercy returned to the Fox Islands with their three oldest children: John, Nathaniel and Benjamin. Thomas' father, James, also returned, but died there soon after in 1787. Younger brother Matthew returned and, in 1801, married Abigail Dyer who was Mercy's niece — the daughter of her sister Susana

Kent Dyer. Thomas' Sister Sarah also returned; she married Mercy's brother Benjamin Kent in 1779. So the Beverage and Kent families became quite entangled.

About sixty other families also returned to the Island. At a town meeting in March, 1785, Thomas was elected clerk and his half-brother George White was deputized to present the following petition to the General Court of Massachusetts asking that clear land title be granted to the settlers (see sidebar, next page).

The petition was eventually granted. Thomas settled on his allotted acres in the center of the North Island. The settlers were free at last from fear and threat of predatory, rapacious and vengeful enemies: English, French, Indian, and landed proprietors (their own countrymen).

Benjamin's other grandfather, Captain Eleazer Crabtree, died in 1824, when Benjamin was only two years old, however, his daughter, Benjamin's mother, Jemima Crabtree Beverage, lived until Benjamin was 15 in1837. She could have told Benjamin the story of Captain Eleazer. He, like Thomas Beverage, had settled in the Fox Islands before the Revolution. He eventually settled on the western most end of the North Fox Island on a point of land which is named after him. He was forced to leave because of British raids on the Island and it is believed the British used it during the War. He joined the Massachusetts Sea Service and participated in the defense of the Fox Islands. He also served in the ill-fated Castine expedition.

Commonwealth of Massachusetts
To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives
in General Court Assembled
The Petition of the Inhabitants of the Fox Islands in
the County of Lincoln

Humbly Showeth,

That your Petitioners, their ancestors did about twenty years since settle on the small Islands known by the name of the Fox Islands, which was then in the Sate of Nature, and not claimed by any Power, Potentate or Individual in any other way than the Crown of England had claims to this whole commonwealth.

That your Petitioners removed with their Families to the said Islands which they divided into Lots and have cleared the lands in part.

That when the British Troops took Possession of Bagaduce (Castine) the Inhabitants of said Islands not choosing to be under the Tyranny of the British (King) removed with their Families within the Protection of this Commonwealth, and did serve during the Expedition to Penobscot bearing arms against the enemy, but upon the defeat of Troops of this Commonwealth the greatest part of your Petitioners were obliged to abandon their Possessions to the Mercy of the Enemy, who came over to the Islands and burnt their Houses, plundered them of all the Substance that they were obliged to leave upon the Islands and many of the Inhabitants they (out of revenge) took from their families and obliged them to work upon their Fortifications at Bagaduce and cruelly treated those who showed any Reluctance at it.

Your Petitioners are now peaceably settled upon these Islands, have erected Huts, until they can rebuild their Houses and are determined, as soon as Circumstances will admit, to erect a Building for Public Worship; and to settle a Minister of the Gospel among them; and also to found a Public School for Education of their Children.

The Petitioners now entreat your Honors to take into your Wise Consideration their peculiar Circumstances and sufferings and grant them in the full Possession of the said Islands, that they may enjoy every Privilege and Immunity with the rest of their fellow Citizens in the Commonwealth, and under that Government they ardently wish to be supported in their Persons and Property. They therefore pray that your Honors would relinquish any claims that this Commonwealth may have to the said Islands, to all the Inhabitants and their heirs and Assigns forever.

And our Petitioners as in Duty
bound will ever pray

George White) Attorney
George White) Attorneys for the Inhabitants

After the war he returned to the Fox Islands and joined Thomas Beverage in petitioning for clear land title. Upon his return he built a house on a hill at the head of Southern Harbor. He became a ship builder and sea captain. One of his ships, the Lucy & Nancy was shipwrecked off the coast of Ireland while under his command. He and his crew were rescued by a passing ship and taken to Liverpool whence they found their way home to North Haven.

Abandoned house built by Captain Eleazer Crabtree on the hill at the head of Southern Harbor.

Orris' mother, Amelia, was the granddaughter of Solomon Grant. He was not one of the original settlers of the Fox Islands, but he must have come quite soon after since he married Amelia's grandmother, Catherine Lassall Grant, on the Island in 1794. He could have told an interesting family story: Solomon's father, Andrew was a captain in the Continental Army during the Revolutionary War. Andrew's great grandfather, Peter Grant, was a Scottish soldier who fought for Charles II in the English Civil War against Oliver Cromwell in the ill-fated route at the Battle of Dunbar in 1650. He was one of over 5,000 prisoners who were force marched south and incarcerated in Durham Cathedral. Only about 1,500 survived the ordeal. They were eventually transported to colonies overseas as convict laborers — temporary slaves. Peter and his brother James were purchased by Joshua Foote and his partner John Becx of London, who were managers of the Lynn Iron Works in Massachusetts. Peter and James Grant worked there for seven years to pay off their indenture. Peter became a carpenter and land owner in Berwick. His son, James continued in that trade and also served as a Captain in the Colonial Army. He was wounded during an Indian raid.

The Penobscots Were Here First

The petitioners of 1785 were not entirely honest when they said they found the Fox Islands "in the State of Nature, and not claimed by any Power." The Penobscot Indians did not have permanent villages or land ownership in the European sense, but their livelihood and lifestyle depended on access to the land and resources of the river and islands of the bay bearing their name where they would camp during the spring and summer seasons. My Uncle Eliot conducted many oral history interviews with Island residents. One of the people he talked to was Nora Davis Waterman (Her husband, Clarence "Bob" Waterman was the great great grandson of Joseph Waterman, one of the original settlers from Marshfield.) Nora told a family story she had heard as a child, "the Indians were here first. The Indians was so thick here, then that they went back to Marshfield after they landed here, and then they come back, and when they did I s'pose the Indians was cleared out then, or something." This reference about what happened when the Marshfield settlers first arrived on the Island is a little cryptic, but it is supported by a statement in *Gould's Revolutionary Soldiers and Sailors of Knox County* that Eleazer Crabtree "came to the Fox Islands as early as 1760, but because of the hostility of the Indians he departed." It seems that upon first arriving they found a group of Penobscots encamped on the Island. The estimated size of the tribe at that time was 700. If they were all there on the Island it would have been a formidable party to try to crash. So apparently the Marshfield visitors retreated without a confrontation and came back later to find the camp abandoned and the land temporarily undefended. Although Nora mentioned one incident that was part of the Waterman family lore, which seems to contradict this. Thomas Waterman (Clarence's great grandfather) was one of the original settlers from Marshfield: "The Indians was here, and when their family first come they lost one of the little girls. They never found her. One of the Indians got this little girl (yes, carried her off) and they never see her again."

Nora's statement is the only evidence I have found of a physical clash between the Penobscots and the Fox Island settlers. They must, however, have been aware of an incident which took place in 1757 about twelve miles to the south of them: Ebenezer Hall, the first permanent settler on Matinicus Island was murdered and his wife and children carried off after he persisted in burning over the nearby Green Islands to improve the hay, despite several formal protests by Indians who collected birds' eggs and grass on these islands. The children were never recovered but the widow was ransomed in due course.

Ebenezer was an ancestor of my Aunt Annie, who was married to Benjamin's brother Charles. As a child I spent many hours listening to

her tell family stories, but I never heard her mention that one. I wonder if she knew about it.

Indians visited and lived on the Island even after the Commonwealth of Massachusetts had granted title to the petitioners, with no recognition of any prior claim on the part of the Penobscots. Nora told another story about more recent times involving her grandparents, Dighton and Margaret Grant Thayer, about 1860:

There was an Indian family still livin' here ... down on the shore, so they used to come up and get milk. They lived in a little hut thing, you know, down on the shore. Ayuh ... it was the last family that there was (that's what they told me). Grandfather, one night, he'd taken some milk down to him, see? And Grandfather come up, and it was supper time and he set down to the table, and he said — all of a sudden (and he'd washed his hands, too) but all of a sudden he said, "Well, my hands smell just like that damned Indian!" and he looked up and the Indian was standin' right in the door. Why, I've heard him tell that story and how he felt, you know. But he [the Indian] never said anything: he just laughed 'n' didn't say anything back to him. Oh, dear. The Indians fished, 'n' they had a boat just like Grampa did. ... So that was the Indians: that was the last ones."

Cousin Vernon was known sometimes to take liberties with the actual truth, but he related an intriguing story told to him by his grandfather, Benjamin, about Amelia's grandfather, Solomon Grant (1773-1840):

Old Sol Grant — good gracious, he told me about what he did here and there and other times; and he said he woke up one morning and he went to the stove to build his fire, and he said that he thought he saw a shadder go across the window. He said he looked out and there was a man outside. He said he opened the door and there was a whale of an Indian standing there, and he says, "I claim to be the champion rassler of New England" and he says, "and I want to see what I can do with you." He says, "You've got quite a reputation outside." Uncle Sol says, "All right;" he says, "you've found the right man." So he says they walked out there, and he said Uncle Sol heaved that old red Indian just as fast as he c'd get up. Oh, that did tickle him. But, he said, "You take the grounds out there," he says, "God — Rye! After they got through there on that land you'd thought somebody'd plowed it," he says. Then, shortly after that several men — with a big dory, rowed down from Castine; and they landed at Uncle Sol's and they told Uncle Sol that there was a real Champion of New England trying to find somebody that was able to rassle with him; and he said there wasn't any of their men that could stand him and they wanted to row him back up there to see what he could do. And he said, "All right, I will go." And, 'course, he ended this way: "That Champion of New England" he says, "he couldn't get Uncle Sol down. But after all," he says, "Uncle Sol couldn't get him down, either.

Orris remembers seeing Indians come ashore to harvest limbs from this ash tree near the barn.

That may have been the last Indian family to live on the Island, but my father recalled other contacts:

You know the huge old ash tree at the bend of the road up by the barn? Father has talked about actually seeing Indians come ashore down here in the cove and walking through here up this road to that particular ash tree. It's a little difficult to believe, because there are other ash trees around; but that is a notable one, and very likely at one time it stood out by itself and would attract a lot of attention. And I don't know how the rights and privileges of the Indians are today, but I understood that they have the privilege of coming and helping themselves not only to the ash bows, but to the birch bark. Now it's my recollection that I heard that directly from Father. And I personally remember at least one occasion when a group of people who were said to be Indians came onto the Island somehow and set up their booths down here in the Village and sold baskets.

Early Settlement

In 1789, shortly after the original sixty families had returned to the Fox Islands and received title to their land from the Massachusetts Court, they incorporated as the town of Vinalhaven, which originally included both the North and South Islands (In 1846, the North Island separated and became the town of North Haven). The first United States census was taken in 1790, just three years after the incorporation; it showed 257 people in 47 families on the North Island. In the seventy years between 1790 and the birth of Grandfather Orris in 1860, three generations lived and, for the most part, prospered on the Island increasing to 952 people in 168 families. Most of this increase was home grown. Many families had eight or ten children and the average was about 5.

In 1820 Thomas Beverage's son, Benjamin, described the economy of the town as follows:

There are three Stores, about seven hundred tons of vessels from 10 to 100 tons burthen mostly fishing vessels, three saw mills, two grist mills. The land produces from 15 to 20 bushels of wheat to the acre, or from 10 to 40 bushels of Indian corn, or from 150 to 300 bushels of potatoes and about one ton of hay to the acre. No part of the State produces better beef parts, mutton, butter, and cheese. There are ten paupers supported by the town. There is one Meeting. The Baptist Church contains one hundred and twenty five members the Methodist Society thirty members which are most part of professors of religion in the town. There not being more than five of any other denomination who are professors of religion. No money is raised by the town for the support of the ministry. They are supported by voluntary subscription. The town is divided into eight School Districts and contains about three hundred Scholars from four to sixteen years of age, four hundred dollars is annually raised to support Schools. The inhabitants

are mostly farmers and fishermen. The inhabitants manufacture most part of their clothing. There is one tanner with a stock of about 500 dollars, the town has many good harbors, and considerable fisheries are carried on both in the Cod and Herring fisheries.

Thomas and Mercy first settled on land next to he family, the Kents, on the south side of the Island on the cove known as the Cubby Hole. In 1784 they moved to the Pulpit Harbor area where Thomas built a log cabin jus east of the present Witherspoon landing strip. He later built a house and a large barn on what is still called "Old Barn Hill" at the head of Pulpit Harbor, at the intersection of the Middle Road with Town Road going over the Pulpit Harbor Bridge. They raised cattle, sheep and pigs as well as agricultural crops. Thomas was also a partner in a saw mill and a grist mill on the Mill Stream, both operated by tidal power. His partners included his half-brother George White and his son-in-law Henry Alexander (husband of his daughter Mercy). He was also active in town affairs serving as Town Clerk, Selectman and School Committeeman.

Thomas and Mercy had ten children, eight of whom survived to adulthood. Three of these eight never married and one, his second son, Nathaniel, left the Island to settle access the Bay in Camden. The remaining four (John, Benjamin, Mercy and James) settled on the Island and raised their families.

Benjamin's North Haven.

The oldest son, John White Beverage, married Rachel Crosby from Edgartown on Martha's Vineyard. They settled on a farm just north of Thomas and Mercy on the north side of the Mill Stream. He probably built the house later occupied by his grandson Norwood and bought by my father in 1944. John farmed and helped his father operate the mills and served as Town Clerk and Constable, among other duties. John and Rachel had ten children: four of them died young; two moved to Rockland; the remaining four (Sarah, Robert, Norwood, and Josiah) married and raised families on the Island.

Thomas' third son, Benjamin Kent Beverage, married Betsy Douglas, an Island girl, in 1802, and established a homestead further north at the entrance to Pulpit Harbor. It was this property that his grandson, John H. Beverage, sold to Thomas Lamont in 1917. Benjamin died just a year before his fiftieth wedding anniversary. At that time he had a prosperous farm of 220 acres worth $2,400. He also had a distinguished political career. He was State Representative in 1822 and held many town offices including Selectman, Tax Assessor, School Committeeman, and Justice of the Peace. Benjamin and Betsy had six children. Abigail died young and the three other girls, Barbara, Mercy and Mary all married and moved off-Island. The two boys, Henry A, and James Douglas, raised families on the Island.

Thomas' oldest daughter, Mercy, married her neighbor Henry Alexander, who was from Topsham, and probably had known Thomas there. Mercy gave birth to five children and died in childbirth at the age of 34.

Thomas' younger son, James, contrary to the general practice of primogeniture, wherein the oldest son inherits the father's estate, was the son who stayed and farmed Thomas' original land. There he replaced the original log cabin with the house that still stands on the property on the south side of the Middle Road. He married Jemima Crabtree, the daughter of the Revolutionary War Captain Eleazer Crabtree. By 1850 he had one of the most prosperous farms on the Island — 160 acres valued at $3,000. He had two oxen, 17 cattle and 46 sheep. In addition to farming, James operated a tannery on the Mill Stream near the mills run by his father and brothers. He was also active in town politics serving as Selectman, Constable and Tax Collector and School Agent, among other offices. He also ran, unsuccessfully, for State Representative.

James and Jemima had five children; four of them married and settled on the Island. Their youngest child, Lucy, died at the age of 20 before marrying. Lucy was born just nine months after her sister, Abigail. Jamima died at the relatively young age of forty-four when Lucy was only six years old leaving James to care for two young daughters.

James' sister Sarah, who never married, came to live with him to help out.

Benjamin Crabtree Beverage, the father of my Grandfather Orris, was the first child of James and Jamima. He was relatively old by the time he established his own family. He may have postponed his first marriage in order to help his widowed father run the large farm until his two younger bothers were old enough to take over. In any case, he was 26 by the time he married Sarah Loveland in October, 1848. Unlike most marriages at that time and in that place, however, this one did not last until the death of one of the partners.

Sarah was nine years younger than Benjamin. She was the second of nine children of Elijah and Susan Loveland of Camden, Maine. Elijah was a farmer and laborer who had previously lived in Vinalhaven. I don't know how Benjamin and Sarah met, but it was an ill-fated relationship that ended in divorce which was very rare in that time and place. Benjamin's statement to the court is quite specific about what happened, but does not say why:

Your Libellant as further complaining avers and says that after their intermarriage as aforesaid he and the said Libellee lived together as husband and wife until the month of August A.D. 1849 when the Libellee left his house in North Haven upon the pretence of making a visit to her parents who resided in Camden, but after she had been gone three days or thereabouts on her visit as he the said Libellant supposed he went to her father's house where she was, and requested her to return with him to his house but she utterly refused so to do and told him that she would never live with him again, that she never has returned to his house, but has continued up to this time to live away from him, and he further avers that though he has not seen nor cohabited with her since she left him as aforesaid she was in the month of February A.D. 1852 delivered of a child which was begotten by some person [unknown] to your Libellant.

And the Libellant further complaining was that the said Libellee wholly regardless of her marriage covenant at Camden in said County in the month of May A.D. 1851 committed the crime of adultery with certain lewd men whose names are to your Libellant unknown and that the said Libellant & Libellee have not cohabited together as husband & wife since that time. Wherefore your Libellant prays that the bonds of Matrimony between him and the said Sarah W. Beveridge may be dissolved the same being a measure reasonable and proper conducive to domestic harmony for the good of the parties and consistent with the peace and morality of society.

The divorce was granted September 3, 1852. Sarah is listed in the 1870 census as Sarah Richards living in Camden with Augustus Richards, a house joiner. I have not found a record of their marriage. A daughter, Elizabeth Richards, born February 1852, is living with them

— the child mentioned in the divorce statement. They had another daughter, Mary Ellen Richards, four years old in 1870.

Two years elapsed after the divorce before Benjamin found and married another wife. By that time he was 31 years old. He did not, however, have to look far to find her. She was Amelia Beverage, the daughter of his cousin, Norwood, who was living right across the Mill Stream from him. He had known her since the day she was born, when he was already eleven years old. She would have been a little underage for Benjamin at the time of his first marriage, but by February 19, 1854, when they were married she had just turned 21.

I can imagine that this marriage was the cause of considerable family discussion and negotiation. As the oldest son, Benjamin would have been the traditional heir to the family homestead when his father James died in 1850. This was the original Thomas Beverage farm where he had been born and raised. Benjamin would have established his family there, but as a consequence of his marital detour and delayed second marriage his youngest brother Albert Glover Beverage got there first: He married Olive Carver in December 1851 and was now ensconced in the homestead with his new wife and their first child, Ellen born in August 1853. Also still living at the farm were their bachelor uncle Josiah and still unmarried Brother Harrison and Sister Lucy — a rather full house. Apparently Benjamin's father James had anticipated this problem.

When Benjamin was only eighteen years old, on May 2, 1841, James and his brother Josiah had bought 100 acres of what eventually became the Benjamin Beverage farm from Asa Cooper and Elijah Glover, (and also a half interest in Bald Island). Seven years later on October 30, 1848, the same month as Benjamin's ill-fated first marriage, they bought an additional 60 acres adjacent to that plot from James L. Frye of North Haven and James Frye of Saddle Island.

Why James bought this particular land is unclear. About two miles to the east of his homestead, thus not suitable just as an extension of his farm, it may have been the closest available land and it may be his relationship to Elijah Glover, one of the sellers, had something to do with it.

Elijah was James' brother-in-law. His wife Nancy Crabtree was the sister of Jamima Crabtree, James' wife. Maybe James' original intention was that this land would go to Benjamin, or he may have planned for it to go to the younger brothers, but he apparently died without a will. Upon his death in 1850 the land was inherited by all three brothers and they eventually decided that Benjamin should have it. It took a while, however, to come to this agreement. The deed transferring the ownership from brothers Albert and Harrison to Benjamin is dated April 8, 1856, two years after Benjamin's second marriage to Amelia.

The farmhouse that Benjamin built on the property does not show up on the town map until 1859, so it was probably completed some time in 1858. James and Amelia must have spent the first four years of their married life at the old homestead where Amelia would have given birth to their first two children, Theodore in 1855 and Harriet in 1856. In the same house at the same time, Benjamin's brother Albert and his wife Olive were also raising their first two children, Ellen born 1853 and Fremont born 1856 — a very crowded house indeed.

If Benjamin and Amelia were still there in August of 1858, that would have been a very busy time because their third child, James, was born on the 5th of that month and five days later Albert's wife Olive gave birth to her third child Leonora — an exciting confluence of events complicated by the fact that Olive was the only midwife in town.

In those days if you wanted a house, you pretty much had to build it yourself. If you were fortunate you had relatives and neighbors who would help out, but everyone had to take care of his or her own affairs at the same time. I try to imagine what Benjamin's life was like during those early years of his marriage when he was simultaneously operating a farm to raise food for his family and building a house on a site two miles from where he was living. He must have had some help, but I am not sure from whom.

Benjamin and Amelia being first cousins once removed, Amelia's father, Norwood, was Benjamin's first cousin as well as his father-in-law. So there was a double family bond, but it also meant that the two families overlapped, so there was a smaller pool of potential family help. This is an argument against cousin marriages which is not talked about much, but it could be a real problem especially in societies where family members were so economically and socially dependent on each other.

Norwood was a man of considerable enterprise and resources. He owned and operated the mill which had belonged to his grandfather, Thomas, located on the inlet at the head of Pulpit Harbor where Fresh Pond empties out. It was a tidal mill powered by the ebb and flow of the six foot tides.

Norwood operated the mill with his brother Josiah. The mill ground grain and sawed lumber and shingles. In 1860 their output was valued at over $4,500. The mill was almost certainly the source of the material for the house Benjamin built in 1858. In addition to working the mill, Norwood farmed 27 acres where he harvested 80 tons of hay and kept three milch cows.

Norwood was also part owner with his Cousin James Douglas Beverage of the ship Montezuma. Cousin James and his Brother Henry A. ran a prosperous cod fishing business. In 1850 they owned six vessels, employed an average of 36 men, and reported an annual catch valued at almost $5,000. That year Norwood told the census taker he

was a fisherman, so his primary occupation was probably working for his cousins James and Henry, but by 1860 he described himself as a mill man. He had taken over the management of the mill after the death of his older brother Robert in 1854. Norwood was also a shoemaker and apparently worked on and off for the master shoemaker W.H. Whaling. He was also active in town affairs, his barn was the site for town meetings, he was a deacon in the Baptist church and held several town offices. He was a busy man and probably did not have much spare time to be of any physical help to his cousin and son-in-law, Benjamin.

Amelia was one of Norwood and Hannah's six children; by 1858 she had only two living siblings, her younger brothers, Lyford age 16 and Dana Harrison age 11. Her family had suffered the loss of three children: in 1845 Thomas died in infancy having survived for only a month. In 1850 the two oldest sons, Robert and Orris, drowned in an accident on Fresh Pond when they were only teenagers. Fresh Pond is a small, usually calm body of water. It is hard to imagine how two young boys could drown in it, but probably, like many people on the Island, neither of them could swim. According to Sam Beverage the story he heard was that their boat got stuck in the dense reeds, and they got out to try and reach the shore. There are a lot of deep water holes among the reeds so they may have got trapped in them.

That a seafaring community on an island would be populated by non-swimmers may seem strange, but if you have ever put your foot in the water of Penobscot Bay at any time other than the end of August, you might understand. The water was something to be feared, respected and to stay out of. It was not conducive to recreational swimming. It wasn't until the foolish "rusticators" with nothing better to do started to visit the island around 1880 that anyone thought to go swimming for fun. So, the remembrances of Island people in my father's generation include childhood recreational swimming.

Home of Norwood and Hannah Grant Beverage where their daughter, Amelia, grew up. Hiram Beverage raised his family here and in 1945 sold it to his cousin Lowell Beveridge.

Robert and Orris were not the only local victims of the cruel sea. Among others, their cousin, William Beverage, who was with them on the day they drowned and escaped, but met a similar fate 13 years later He was Captain of the Gloucester fishing schooner, Charles C. Dame which was driven ashore at North Cape, Prince Edward Island in the great gale of August 1873. He and the entire crew were lost. Amelia was 17 years old at the time her two brothers drowned. They were close to her in age and it must have been traumatic for her. She named two of her sons after her two dead brothers. One was my grandfather Orris.

Benjamin's father James had died in 1850 at the age of 61, his mother, Jemima Crabtree Beverage, having died before that of a hemorrhage at the age 44 in 1837. His only sister, Lucy, died young at the age of 20 in 1850. Benjamin's younger brother Albert, as mentioned previously was tending a large farm of his own and raising a family contemporary with Benjamin's. His other brother, Harrison, was living with them.

From looking at the record, Harrison doesn't seem like a hard working type; maybe he was just a late starter. At the age of 24 in 1850 he was still living on the farm of his father, James, but his occupation was listed as a "laborer." If he had been helping his father, he would have been listed as a "farm laborer." He could well have been farming for his own account at that age, but was not. In 1860 at age 34, still unmarried, he was living with his younger brother, Albert, and his occupation enigmatically listed as "Gentleman." This term was used as an occupation in those days. Apparently it refers to a retired person with an independent income. The other eight people who are listed as Gentlemen in the 1860 census are all over 60 and have personal assets: none were listed for Harrison. It seems that Harrison, or maybe the census taker, Perez Babbidge, who certainly knew better, was indulging in a little joke.

In 1870 Harrison was still living with his Brother, Albert. His occupation was listed as "farm laborer" that year, but in later years he seems to have found some less strenuous things to do: Justice of the Peace, ship owner, town clerk, secretary of the town Board of Health, and a sinecure peculiar to the State of Maine called a Dedimus Justice, a lifetime position appointed by the governor, whose sole duty is to administer the oath of office to public officials. He was also a prolific poet.

In 1870 at the age of 44 he married 18-year-old Eldora Brown. Their first child, Susan, was born 6 months later. They eventually had six more children. Two children died in infancy; three died in their teens; only one, Everett, the last born lived to be an adult. According to Barbara Beverage Reeves in her *James Beverage Descendants*, the pain of losing one's whole family save one child must have taken a toll on both

Harrison and Eldora. Family tradition states that Eldora left Harrison in such a hurry that the crops were in the field, with other chores in the process of being completed, to run off with Fred Alexander. On 5 May, 1900, 11 months before Harrison's death, she married Fred.

So the pool of potential help from Benjamin's immediate family was limited and stretched rather thin. He must have had assistance from neighbors or his extended family, but their identity is lost to history. Some likely candidates include Glover Webster who was married to Adelia Beverage. They lived not far away on Webster's Head. Glover's younger brothers, David and Leander, also lived nearby and may have been available. Mark Calderwood, a cousin of Brother Albert's wife Olive Carver Beverage, may also have been available. He is listed in the 1860 census as a "house carpenter."

Benjamin's Farm

Men's Work

Benjamin and Amelia had been living in their new house for about two years when their fourth child, my Grandfather Orris, was born in 1860. Benjamin was a farmer. His real estate was valued at $2,500 and personal property at $500. He owned about 180 acres, a horse, 2 milch cows, 2 other cattle, 50 sheep, and 2 swine. The value of his real estate was above the average for the farming households on the Island of North Haven, In fact there were only 5 farms worth more than his. Of the 80 enterprises on the agricultural census, the average farm size was 78 acres and the average real estate value was $1,560.

Although Benjamin's farm was one of the largest on the island, the value and quantity of goods produced was below the average, a reflection of the fact that it was a relatively new farm and Benjamin was working it with only his wife, Amelia, who had her hands full with four young children.

The Island farms had little equipment: the average value of implements and machinery was $87. Twenty-nine of the farms had neither a horse nor an ox. Oxen were the favored work animals, but only 29 farms had one and only 19 of those had a team of two oxen.

Benjamin had one horse and no oxen. These households were basically subsistence farms raising enough food for the family, but with little surplus for the market. Benjamin's Granddaughter, Dorothy Beverage Howard, who was born on the same farm in 1918, and grew up there, told me that they always had plenty to eat, but not much else. However, they never felt poor because everyone else in their community had about the same standard of living.

As Orris and his siblings grew up they learned from their parents and were increasingly able to help out with the family farm. (Older readers may remember what life was like on a subsistence farm and might want to skip reading this section, since you probably know more than I do about the subject.)

My first-hand knowledge comes only from three summers working as a hired hand for Tony Caldewood when I was a teenager. For the rest of you, I will attempt a brief description. Benjamin's day started at sunrise, or considerably before that in the long northern winter nights. Even in summer it was chilly and damp at that hour. In winter it was bone cold. Amelia was up before him. The first order of business was to fire up the stoves which had been banked the night before and then heat up a little hot water for a cup of tea.

Benjamin might grab a cold biscuit and head for the barn for morning chores: milk the cows, shovel up the straw bedding and dung from the animal's stalls, dump it on the manure compost pile behind the barn, feed the critters, and let them out to pasture. This routine along with the evening chores had to be performed 365 days a year in good

weather and in bad, in sickness and in health and kept a farmer tied to his land with no vacation, unless he had reliable and competent family members to help out.

After chores Benjamin was ready for a hearty breakfast prepared by Amelia: meat or fish, potatoes or beans, biscuits and gravy, and pie for dessert — not your usual city-folk breakfast. By the time breakfast was over, it was late enough to have some idea of what the weather was going to be like and that determined the day's activities, which varied with the season.

If it was spring and the ground had thawed and it wasn't too wet he might spend a day preparing for planting. 140 acres of the farm were "improved" — that is cleared and usable for farming, but most of that land was used for pasturing or haying, not for growing crops. The 1860 agricultural census listed Benjamin's harvest as: 25 bushels of Indian corn, 2 bushels of beans, 50 bushels of Irish potatoes, and 30 bushels of barley. These are the crops that the census tracked; he probably raised for his own use root vegetables such as turnips, beets, carrots and parsnips as well as cucumbers and winter and summer squash, but I would guess that he never had more than an acre or two under cultivation. This, however, was plenty of work for a one-man farm. Picture an acre as being about the size of a football field.

Before planting a crop the earth must be fertilized, plowed and harrowed. The fist step was to spread the manure — hitch up the horse to a cart, back it up to the manure pile behind the barn and load up the cart. The manure would have been curing for several months and the heat built up inside the pile killed unwanted weed seeds and created a drier less smelly mixture than the original, but it still had a distinctive odor. The horse pulled the cart up and down the field while Benjamin, standing in the cart spread the fertilizer. This operation was much better done with two people, one to look after the horse and one to spread the fertilizer, but with an understanding horse, it was possible for it to be a one-man task.

Next Benjamin's horse pulled a plow while he guided it from behind working as hard as the horse to keep the plow on line and to deal with rocks and roots in the way. Proverbially, the largest and most consistent crop of Maine soil is rocks. No matter how many are taken from the field to build those ubiquitous stone walls, by the following spring the frost will have thrown up a fresh crop.

After plowing, the field required harrowing — the process of breaking up the remaining lumps of hard earth and sod and smoothing out the soil. Several kinds of mechanical harrows were available at that time, but Benjamin apparently did not own one. He may have borrowed one from a neighbor; if not, this process was done by hand with a hoe

and a rake. After the last frost of the spring, Benjamin planted by hand the seeds of the crops he had decided to grow that year.

Of course no one could tell for sure which frost would be the last one. That was a matter of guesswork like so many other aspects of farming. If he guessed wrong and planted too early, the crop could be destroyed by frost and he would have to plant a new one, if he had enough seeds. If he waited too long to plant, the crop might wither and dry up when the weather got too hot and dry. Commercially grown seeds were available on the market at that time, but I would guess that most of Benjamin's seeds were saved by him from the previous years' crop, or he bartered and traded seeds with his neighbors. Since cash was scarce, buying seed was an unnecessary luxury.

This was before giant agricultural corporations like Monsanto figured out that they could sell farmers seeds for hybrid plants. Granted these seeds produce larger, disease resistant crops, but they are sterile so farmers have to buy new seed every year.

When the seeds sprouted, Benjamin had to thin them out, weed them, and cultivate the soil. He probably also mulched, covering the soil between rows with hay or seaweed to keep out weeds, preserve moisture and add fertilizer. There is usually more than enough rain on the Island, but during occasional dry periods he might have to cart water from the well to keep his crops from drying out.

Spring was a critical time for Benjamin's major cash crop — his sheep. That was when the ewes dropped their lambs. Benjamin had to make a daily visit to wherever his flock was pasturing to check on the health of the new babies and their mothers. Prior to the lambing season he would have spent days walking the perimeter of his pastures and repairing the fences. When I did that work as a teenager we used barbed wire and wooden posts, but Benjamin had to rely on stone walls supplemented with split rails. Barbed wire was developed in 1873, but not generally available until several years later. In any case it was too expensive for Benjamin in a cash poor economy.

Summer time was haying time — a time of obsessive anxiety for farmers on an Island where the weather was unpredictable and often wet — a game of chicken played against the Gods of weather. To turn green grass in the field into dry hay in the barn it must be mowed and left on the ground in the sun and turned, or tedded, at least once until it is brown and dry. It is then raked up, pitched onto a hay rack and driven to the barn where it is pitched up into the hay loft and stowed away.

If the hay is damp or green when it is stowed away it will rot or, worse yet, heat up by spontaneous combustion and possibly set fire to the barn, so it is important that the hay be dry when it is stored away. With favorable weather this curing process can take as little as a day but, if it turns overcast or rainy while the hay is on the ground, one must

wait for the sun to return and ted the hay again until it is thoroughly dry. One doesn't want to mow more hay than one can harvest before the next rain storm. That is what is meant by "make hay while the sun shines."

Mowing hay by hand with a scythe was one of the hardest and most time consuming jobs on a farm. An acre of grass will produce one to two tons of hay. For Benjamin to harvest 20 tons of hay, as he did in 1860, he had to mow between ten and twenty acres. They say that an acre is the size of a field a man can mow with a scythe in a day. If Benjamin was able to do that, he was a much better man than I.

An experienced mower (which I never became) will keep his scythe sharp, and fall into an easy, rhythmic, swinging motion letting the scythe do most of the work, but to keep that up hour after hour requires real stamina. Because mowing was such arduous work, it was the first farm task to be mechanized with the advent of the industrial revolution. By the 1850s several models of mowing machines were available to farmers. The inventory of Benjamin's assets at the time of his death listed one "mowing machine" valued at $10.00. This was probably an early model of the so-called sickle bar similar to the kind still being used by Tonny Calderwood when I worked for him in the 1940s. I don't know when Benjamin got his machine, but it was probably not until he had spent many years mowing his hay by hand.

Cousin Vernon told an interesting story about how to use a scythe: "I used to cut Zimmerman's hay, and ... had Nat [Stone] helping, and I needed something and I went into the house, and I come out and I could see Nat swinging with about all the force he had, and he wasn't taking it the way he should — I mean, the scythe wasn't taking it — and I left what I was doing and come over where he was, and I said to him, 'How's your scythe working, Nat?' and he said, 'Just like a razor.' And I said, 'O.K. You don't mind if I look at it a minute, do you?' and he said, 'Oh, no, certainly not.' So I looked at it, and I said, 'You wouldn't mind ... if I put the stone on it for a minute?' and he said, 'Oh, no — but it's sharp as a razor.' And I touched it up a little bit and said, 'All right, take that in your hand and try her now.' Well, he swung with that scythe the way he'd been doing, and he swung himself clean around! When he got his balance he straightened up 'n' he thought for a moment, 'n' then he said (kinda s-l-o-w), 'Well, Vern;' he said, 'I guess I didn't know how sharp a scythe ought to be."

The autumn was harvest time with work for everyone — Benjamin, Amelia and the little ones had to dig up the potatoes and root vegetables, clean them and store them in the root cellar; pick and husk the corn and hang it up to dry; pick and shell the beans and dry them for storage; gather apples and store some for winter; press some in the

cider press and make apple sauce for canning with some; pick peas, cucumbers, green beans, summer squash, etc for canning or pickling.

In 1860 Benjamin also harvested 30 bushels of barley. I don't know what the barley was used for. It could have been milled in Norwood's grist mill and used for making bread or cereal. It might have been used as feed for his animals, although that amount would not have gone far. Barley was, of course, also used for making beer, but I am not aware of a beer making tradition on the Island. I believe that hard cider was the preferred home brew at that time, but as far as I know, Benjamin was a good Baptist and his household was alcohol free. The Maine soil and climate was not suited for raising wheat which was the preferred grain for human consumption. By 1860 cheap wheat grown out west was available in the east thanks to the recently completed railroads. So Benjamin probably found it made sense to buy rather than grow.

These days the late fall is hunting season. The deer population on the Island has gotten to the point where it is threat to agriculture and Island fauna. Many people supplement their food budget by shooting a few deer at this time of year. I don't know if there was much hunting done in Benjamin's day or, indeed, if there were any deer to hunt on the Island. Jetson Dyer remembered hunting duck:

We used to go duck-hunting out here in the Bay. Go out in a rowboat — set on a ledge (Ayuh) — wait for the birds 'come along. Had tollers [retriever dogs], you know: put tollers in the water 'n' go set on the ledge 'n' wait for the birds. No, wa'n't too comfortable out there sometimes — settin' out on the ledge, waitin' — now I tell ye. Yeah, we'd set there a while ... till the birds come; and when we'd shoot then we'd pick 'em up and we'd go home. No, wouldn't set there any longer. They wouldn't come back that day, no. They wouldn't naw'n come — unlest they come from a long ways off, where they couldn't hear the gun. Not very often they'd come back after you'd fired once or twice. I don't blame 'em, do you?

We didn't use to shoot more'n two or three to a time, anyway. All we wanted was just enough for a meal. I wouldn't shoot a bird now — I wouldn't shoot a cat — I wouldn't shoot a squirrel — I wouldn't shoot nawthin' now. 'n' I used to go rabbitin' (shoot rabbit 'round the island, here) and I wouldn't shoot a rabbit for the world, now. And all my brothers 'turned the same way. That's a funny thing: they all used to go (yeah, counted on it) in the winter. I just can't bear to go out and shoot anything.

When I was young, my father taught me how to make a small animal trap out of a wooden box and some sticks so that the box would fall on the critter when it took the bait. We would catch and release squirrels and rabbits. My mother never offered to cook them and I didn't push the issue. I don't know if this was a skill my father learned from his father, or if it was something he learned from a book

In the winter, the barn chores of course had to be done daily no matter how windy, cold or wet it was, and on better days there was wood to be cut for the following season. When the weather discouraged outdoor work, there was work to be done in the barn or the house such as mending harness, repairing and sharpening tools, maintaining wagons and carts, building and fixing furniture, inspecting for decay and culling the food stored in the cellar.

Autumn after the harvest was the time to do maintenance and repair work on the house, the barn and the various outbuildings as well as tools and farm equipment in preparation for the winter; repair or replace shingles, roof trees, flashing and gutters on leaky roofs; scrape, putty and paint windows and trim; clean chimneys; take in boats and moorings; and clean and repair fishing gear. Every farmer or fisherman was, by necessity, a jack-of-all-trades. Although not every one had the skill and tools to make a boat, house, chair, cabinet, barrel, carriage, wheel, boot, horse shoe, or harness, there were craftsmen on the Island who could do all those things and certainly every man (and most women) were able to maintain and repair such items. Every farm had at least a basic woodworking shop and tools. I am sure Benjamin did, because that must have been where Grandfather Orris learned the skills that he passed on to his children who passed them on to me.

My father had a good set of tools some of which he had inherited, others he had bought: farmer's tools like a scythe, sickle, clipper and shears; lumberman's ax, hatchet, wedge, maul, buck saw and two man saw; mechanic's wrenches, screw drivers, pliers, tin snips; files and carpenter's chisels, gauges, cross cut saw, rip saw, joiner plane, jack plane, bit brace, draw shave, spoke shave, level, t-square, hammer, and mallet. We also used a big old grinding wheel with foot treadle which sat out in the woods available for all to use. It may originally have belonged to Benjamin. My father taught me how to sharpen and maintain these tools and how to use and handle them efficiently and safely so that neither I nor the tools were damaged. Not everyone had a full set of tools, so there was quite a bit of borrowing between neighbors, as there must have been in Benjamin's time. Tool borrowing etiquette required that one returned tools promptly in good condition. Not everyone lived up to this standard, and my father's contempt for those who failed made me particularly careful in this matter.

Many people practiced more than one trade. For example, every household needed wood for heating and cooking. Cutting wood was an important economic activity which did not show up on the 1860 census. The 1880 census, however, did report that the annual wood harvest averaged over 12 cords per household (a cord is a stack of four foot long logs piled four feet high and eight feet long). A skilled

woodsman can cut a cord of wood in a day using hand tools — an ax, a two man saw and a buck saw (although nobody does that today).

Cousin Vernon described the joy of using a well-sharpened saw:

Long before there was a power saw (chain saw) I used to work in the woods with my father with the old two-man saw. That, I tell you ... that is something that you really ... you have to learn to do. You take one of those old cross-cut saws, and really have it so's 'twill cut — have it sharp and have it set ... the way it should be — and it's hardly any effort. You don't want to put any pressure on it — any amount. Just enough — just sliding back and forth — the saw does all the work. And fast! There's one thing that always used to please me. I smile every time I look at it. When I was going to school Dad used to go over in the woods — there was always a lot of trees down if there was any woodlot sawed somewheres, and he'd go over and fix up a tree — limb it up and get it ready — and wait till I got home and I'd go over with him and help him saw it. One day — one night, this tree he had picked out (at that time, there) was decayed on the inside, and when we cut through at a big knot there a squirrel's tail dropped out of it. I tell you that must have been some surprised squirrel. Sharp! — that's exactly like a scythe: well — it goes right back to the old-fashioned razor.

Grandfather Orris showing off the wood pile he helped harvest.
Standing on top is probably Vernon and sitting are Arnold and Lowell.

A woodsman must fell the trees, cut off the limbs, cut the trunk into four foot lengths, stack them and clean up the brush. When I was a teenager fire wood was selling for $8.00 a cord, so I thought I might make some easy money by cutting wood. If I could cut a cord a day that would be a dollar an hour. This was twice the going rate for common labor in those days. Well, I was still working on my first cord at the end of the second day. I was not a skilled woodsman.

After the cordwood had been cut, it still had to be transported to the house woodpile and each log was then placed on a sawhorse and cut with a buck saw into three or four equal lengths to fit the stove or fireplace. Each short piece was then split one or twice with an ax or a wedge and mall and stacked under shelter to keep it dry. It is said that wood you harvest yourself warms you three times — once when you cut it, once when you split it, and once when you burn it.

Great Grandfather Benjamin Crabtree Beverage (1822-1875).

Wood was as critical as food for survival. Keeping a supply of dry wood on hand and tending the fires was a job that had to be done no matter what. By the time I was about ten years old, it became one of my permanent chores during summers at the Island cottage. Often when I went to collect the mail in our mailbox by the crossroads next to my great aunt Annie's house I would see her out by the woodpile splitting wood. She was in her eighties at the time and could not have weighed over 100 pounds.

There were times when illness or bad luck caused a household to run low on wood. When that happened a local tradition called "wooding" helped to avert catastrophe: on an agreed upon day each neighbor would load up a cart with wood from his or her own wood pile, drive to the household in need, and dump it in the yard. This was usually done quietly at night while the recipients slept so the donors would not be identified, thus avoiding the awkward problem of implied obligation. In earlier days this local charitable function was the occasion for a more elaborate community festivity called a "woodchopin'."

In addition to his work as a farmer and fisherman, Benjamin was a deacon of the Pulpit Harbor Baptist Church and, like most of the adult males on the Island, he performed his share of civic duties. Women did not have the right to vote at that time and were excused from (or excluded from) holding public office. The town was self-governed and self-managed by citizens who served with a very nominal stipend or none at all. Benjamin's offices included Selectman, Auditor of Accounts, Juror, Fence Viewer, Town Agent and Superintendent of the School Committee.

Grandmother Amelia Beverage with her Brother Hanson Beverage in front of the farmhouse built by her Husband, Benjamin.

Women's work

The 1860 census listed the occupation of Orris's father, Benjamin, as "farmer," but his mother, Amelia, had a blank space after her name in the "occupation" column as did most all the other married women in town. We know better than to assume that they were all women of leisure. On the contrary everyone knew what a good wife's job was, so it was not necessary to spell it out. While tempting today to feel smugly superior to the male supremacists in the census office who gave no recognition or value to "women's work," I believe some of that attitude still lingers in our society. By 1870 someone in the census office had made a slight movement in the right direction and instructed enumerators that, "Women keeping house for their own families or for themselves, without any other gainful occupation, will be entered as 'keeping house'."

The farm house built by Great Grandfather Benjamin Beverage. Bought and renovated in 1954 by his Grandson, Eliot, who named it Eastern Bay Farm. The original ground floor layout of Benjamin Beverage's farm house.

However, "Grown daughters assisting them will be reported without occupation." Interestingly, "The term 'housekeeper' will be reserved for such persons as receive distinct wages or salary for the service." If you got paid you were a "housekeeper," if unpaid you were "keeping house." The latter was by far the most demanding occupation.

In 1870 Amelia's job was finally recognized by the census enumerator and she was listed as "keeping house." This was her job for 21 years from the day she married Benjamin in February, 1854, at the age of 19 until his death in December, 1875. (After his death she was still keeping house but had the added job of head of household.) Let me try to describe what I think that job entailed. This description is based on some reading and talking with and observing my father, his siblings and his two aunts, Annie and Lettie. I have also lived in the house on the Mill Pond where Amelia grew up and in the house where Amelia raised her family and I have, on occasion, done most of the chores involved.

The house that Benjamin built stood in the middle of his 180 acres on a hill with a sweeping view across a meadow out to eastern Penobscot Bay with small islands dotting the middle distance. On a clear day Mount Desert, Dear Isle, and Isle au Haut were visible beyond. It is the kind of view that the Rusticators and their artist friends would later pay handsomely to enjoy for a few weeks each year; Amelia saw it every day of her life.

I wonder if she appreciated it as much as they. When the Rusticators started building their summer homes they built as close to the water as possible (a practice which is now prohibited by code for ecological and conservation reasons), but Benjamin's house, like all the old farm houses stood well back from the shore by about a quarter of a mile. This gave it some protection from winter storms and made it more accessible from the road when it snowed and during the spring mud season.

The house was on the small side as Island farmhouses went. It consisted of a two story and basement main unit that had a footprint of about 600 square feet and a one story 250 square foot addition or ell on the west side that had no basement. Every farmhouse had a room like this, usually called a wood shed. It was the working entrance to the house and served as a transition from the outside to the inside. It was used to store wood and tools, to separate milk and make butter and cheese, to process and store produce such as eggs, apples and root vegetables, a place to shed and store boots and coats and other gear so as not to track mud and dirt into the house, and as a drying room during frequently wet weather.

This ell was also used as a kitchen during the summer months. The house had a formal front door on the south side opening into a small entrance hall off of which to the east was a formal sitting parlor. These features were used only on rare occasions for funerals, weddings and

visits from the minister. Also on the ground floor was a dining room/kitchen to the west of the front entrance and in the rear a pantry with stairs down to the basement where root vegetables and preserved goods were kept.

In the rear, facing north, was the master bedroom with a small "borning room" opening off of it. If you put a modern king size bed in the master bedroom there would be room for little else. The borning room was where Amelia retired to birth and nurse her nine children. I suppose it was also used as a sick room and possibly as a workroom and storage area for Amelia's materials and tools required for domestic crafts such as sewing, knitting and net making. I believe there was a stove in the ell as well in the dining room, the master bedroom and the parlor, but upstairs was, as far as I can tell, unheated and un-insulated. That is where the children slept.

Nora Davis Waterman, born in 1888, told about survival tactics:

Heat flatirons and take to bed with ye'. The room would be cold but your bed would be warm. Hot flatirons, rolled up in clothes and paper. Put them in some 'head o' time. Prepare't ahead o' time 'n' get your bed all warm. And then when the fire was out you'd be all ready t' jump in. I don't know how they ever brought up children that way, but I guess that was the way they done.

The reader will notice that this inventory of spaces does not include what we know today as a bathroom. Some of the functions of the bathroom were accommodated by a dry sink such as one can now find carefully restored in high-end antique shops. There was probably one in the master bedroom and maybe one upstairs for the children. It held a ceramic wash basin and water pitcher on top and had a cabinet underneath for a chamber pot which could be used at night and in bad weather to avoid a long, dark, cold, or wet trip to the "outhouse."

Eventually, though, someone would have to empty the chamber pot. I suppose this was Amelia's job, at least it was her responsibility to see that it was done. It was probably one of the first chores assigned to her growing children as soon as they were old enough.

Whether one used the chamber pot or the outhouse, there was what we might call the tissue issue. Once the purpose of the trip to the outhouse had been accomplished, what was to be done? It is hard for most Americans to imagine a world without toilet paper, but that is the world that Amelia lived in and into which Orris was born.

The first commercial toilet paper in this country was marketed in 1857 by Joseph Gayetty of New York. The cost was $.50 for 500 sheets. Cash was scarce in the Island economy. Paid labor earned less than a dollar a day. Benjamin's farming produced adequate food for his family, but little actual cash. His total non-real-estate assets were $500. As the

cost of a package of Mr. Gayetty's tissues would have made a big hole in Amelia's family budget, I am quite sure she would have decided the cost was not worth it even if the product had been available to her, which was probably not the case.

So what were the alternatives? I have heard that they included sticks, sponges, sea shells, moss, leaves, stones and rags — some of which I have used myself with no better solution at hand. Amelia may have been able to supply her family with a modern amenity — recycled paper. In 1851 the weekly *Rockland Gazette* started publishing and I am sure it was distributed on the Island then as it is today. It was not many pages, however, and a single issue might not have lasted the family for a week in its secondary use. *The Old Farmer's Almanac* was also useful for this purpose and came pre-punched with a whole in the upper left hand corner so it could be hung on a nail in the outhouse, but it, too, was not big enough to last a family from one issue to the next.

Only when Sears Roebuck started publishing its door-stop-sized catalogues in 1894 were American outhouses supplied with a reliable and affordable solution to this problem. This solution lasted until Sears began to print its catalogue in color on glossy paper unsuitable for this secondary use, thus giving a boost to the industry started and dominated by the Scott brothers, I believe, sometime in the 1920s.

By then many of the nation's outhouses had been replaced by indoor water flush-toilets which did not easily handle the courser catalog paper and suffered blockage and back ups when it was used. Amelia's outhouse, however, continued to be used by her children, grandchildren and great grandchildren until my uncle Eliot replaced it with a flush indoor toilet after he bought the farm from his cousins in 1954.

While on the subject, I should say a few words about the treatment and disposal problem presented by the outhouse. In my family this was considered men's work. I inherited the job from my father at about age 15. I suppose it was men's work in Amelia's family, too, but based on my personal experience, it would have required considerable nagging on Amelia's part to get Benjamin to do something about it. It was the sort of job that inspired creative excuses and procrastination.

The outhouse was a small structure containing a bench with one or two holes in it. Beneath the hole was a pit three or four feet deep which was gradually filled up with human waste. There were holes in the door and in the sides which let in fresh air but, also, insects and occasionally other wild life. A bucket of lime with a scoop was kept in the outhouse. After each use a light sprinkling of lime would help kill the odor-causing bacteria thus mitigating the smell, attractiveness to insects, and risk of infection.

The downside of the use of lime was that the bacteria which it killed could eventually, if left undisturbed, reduce the waste to an odorless

dry substance which was excellent fertilizer. This process was, however, too long and olfactorally painful, so the lime was used and the pit eventually filled up with unprocessed human waste. At that point the content of the pit had to be bailed out and buried elsewhere.

An alternative strategy was to dig another pit and relocate the outhouse. Neither of these jobs would rise to the top of a man's to-do list until absolutely unavoidable. As far as I know human waste was not considered a proper fertilizer, but one could identify the sites where outhouses had stood or their contents had been buried by small circle of extra lush growth.

Aside from the outhouse issue, waste disposal in Amelia's world was much less a problem than it is today. Indeed it was practically non-existent. Had there been a garbage man, he would have been as idle as the proverbial Maytag repairman.

Animal waste was used for fertilizer; organic waste was fed to the chickens or hogs or composted; there was no plastic; there was little packaging material; food and other merchandize from the general store was for the most part sold in loose bulk and carried home in reusable container supplied by the store or the customer.

Paper was burned in the stove or fireplace or recycled in the outhouse; wood was reused or burned; bottles and jars were reused; canned food was beginning to appear on the market, but in small quantities and the cans were usually recycled as containers or scrap metal; used nails, screws and hardware were carefully removed and saved for reuse.

The waste from fish processing was thrown back into the ocean for processing and the waste from livestock processing could be burned or buried. There really was no need for a garbage pail — let alone a garbage man. I don't suppose there was even a town dump in those days. By the time I was a young boy, several sites were used as dumps by common agreement where people would leave old tires, leaky containers, broken tools and equipment; non-functioning appliances, even an occasional stripped down car, etc. They were really more like an informal outdoor exchange station.

It was said that some people, especially Beverages, had a bigger load coming home from the dump than they did going to it. During the war (WWII) my cousins and I would collect scrap metal and rubber at these sites for the war effort, but it was pretty slim pickin's. Today the town dump is one of the major industries on the Island with several fulltime employees overseeing a substantial recycling program and collecting fees for disposal of all manner of waste which, by law, must be shipped off island.

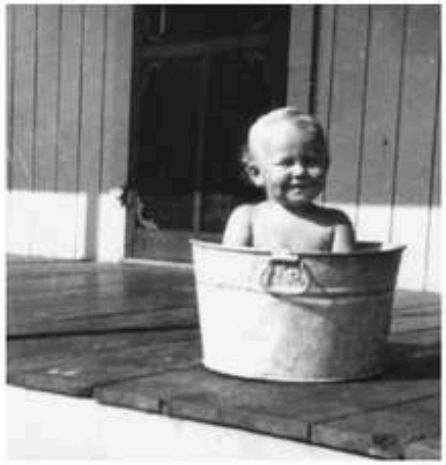
What about the bath part of the function of the bathroom? Farming, fishing, housekeeping and other trades involved heavy, dirty work. How

did people get cleaned up after a hard day's work? Part of the answer is that standards of personal hygiene were not as high in Amelia's time as they are today. Homes had no bathtubs. Infants could fit in a laundry tub but, after the age of two or three, I doubt if anyone ever enjoyed the experience of total immersion.

When I was young, living in our summer cottage which also had no bathroom, we had a weekly Saturday night bath; a custom which I suppose was a carryover from Amelia's time. Nora Davis Waterman described the process:

If you was goin' to do a wash, or anything you'd have to go up and get a couple of pails before noon and get dinner, and then go in the afternoon again if you were really doing anything. Like baths: Take a wash-tub and set it on the floor anywhere. You could take a bath right on the floor. You know, set it on the floor 'n' put water in, and you had to heat the water, 'course, on the stove. You could stand up in it or you could wash some 'n' then sit down (sit down on a chair) 'n' soak your feet in it. Why, I think of these young people — if they had to go through what we went through in them days! They don't; they have everything so handy.

When a lot of adults were in the house, this process could take quite a while and you really wouldn't want to do it more than once a week.



The author in one of his first Saturday night baths
on the porch of the Red Cottage.

Aside from the Saturday night bath, personal hygiene was limited to what could be accomplished at the dry sink with a washbasin, a pitcher of water, which was usually cold, and a bar of soap. The soap may have been store bought since, by then, it was generally available commercially at an affordable price, though it was probably not as soft and gentle and nicely scented as that available today. Amelia may, however, have made her own soap, almost certainly her mother did.

The ingredients for making soap — wood ash and fat or lard — were in plentiful supply. I have never made soap, so I won't attempt to describe how it is done. Sweet smelling powders and lotions and perfumes were probably not available, although Amelia may have used a sachet filled with flower petals and spices in a drawer with her linens. So the level of olfactory stimulation, even in the house, was probably higher and richer than today's urban dwellers are used to, but so long as everyone was in the same boat — so to speak — it was quite tolerable, one might even say stimulating. The smells of the barnyard, fish processing and human exertion mixed with the odor of burning wood, fresh cut hay, wood chips, clam flats and the fresh wind off the water combined to make a not unpleasant overall affect.

Washing clothes presented some of the same problems as washing people. The same tub was used. Keep in mind this was probably a wooden tub and not one of the lighter galvanized iron tubs which although available then, were too expensive. Wooden tubs looked like a wood barrel cut in half. They were cumbersome and heavy.

Once filled with water you didn't want to have to carry them, so in good weather the washing was done outside where the tub could be tipped over and the used water dumped on the ground. In bad weather the washing would be done in the kitchen where the waste water could be ladled into the sink or lifted up and dumped if there were a couple of strong persons available for the job. If Amelia's sink was similar to others of that vintage which I have seen and used, it was a large zinc troth about 2 feet by 5 feet and 6 inches deep with a drain at one end which went through a hole in the floor and drained onto the ground outside.

Some houses had a hand-operated suction pump mounted on the counter next to the sink to pump water from a well. I do not believe Amelia had this amenity. Water for the kitchen had to be carried in a wooden bucket from the well which was about fifty feet to the north of the building. Perhaps Benjamin had placed a barrel near the kitchen door and ran the downspout from the house gutters into it to catch rainwater from the roof. This would have been more convenient and also, rainwater, being almost as pure as distilled water, was "softer" and easier to wash with than the "harder" mineral laden water from the

well. By the way, I believe that the water from the well was not pure enough for drinking and that it occasionally ran dry.

Drinking water came from a spring located about half a mile from the house down the hill to the shore. This is the spring from which my family drew drinking water a hundred years later. My father always said it was the best water in the world. Whenever we passed the spring we would stop and take a ceremonial drink whether thirsty or not. In later years when parts of the original farm surrounding the spring were sold off, the deeds all provided for a right of way from the farmhouse to the spring. That is the basis for my saying that the spring water was essential for the farm. It was a long way to fetch a pail of water. I know, because it later became my job to carry water from that spring a similar distance to our cottage.

So the water was heated on the stove, poured into the tub with flakes from a bar of soap and the dirty clothes were added. Some hand operated washing machines that agitated the clothes were on the market, but it is doubtful that Amelia would have had one in those days, so she would do it the old fashioned way. With a washing stick or paddle the clothes would be stirred and agitated up and down and around for ten or fifteen minutes. Commercially made washboards were available, but Amelia probably did not have one of them. Stubborn spots and stains were attacked by rubbing the clothes together.

After the wash cycle the clothes would be wrung out by hand and either put into a second tub of clean rinse water or, lacking a second tub, the original tub would be emptied and filled with clean water. Later on Amelia may have had a hand operated clothes wringer with rollers, but probably not in 1860. Depending on how dirty the clothes were and how high Amelia's standards were, the wash-rinse cycle might be repeated once or twice. She may also have used bluing and starch for some items, which would have added cycles to the process.

After the final rinse, the clothes would be wrung out and hung up to dry. Amelia may have had rope for a clothesline and some home made clothespins. If so, it was probably worn out hemp line originally used for ship rigging or fishing gear. More likely, the clothes were just spread out on bushes or grass to dry. That is if the weather was right.

When the sun was shining and there was a nice dry breeze clothes would dry in an hour or two, but this was seldom the case. More likely it would be foggy, overcast or raining, in which case the wash would be hung on wooden racks or lines in the kitchen and the shed. In rainy weather the laundry had to compete for drying space with outer garments that also needed drying.

A method of waterproofing material had been developed in England by Charles Macintosh in 1823, but it was expensive and not generally available in rural America. The original distinctive yellow oilskins

(linen and later cotton canvas treated with linseed oil) which one thinks of as the national costume of Maine fishermen were not in general use except among sailors. They were too heavy, hot, stiff and smelly for everyday wear. My father wrote:

I don't remember that we ever, as kids, had any oilskins or waterproof stuff. We just went, you know, and got soaked, and came in and got dried out. I can remember coming back and day after day Mother would have all this wet stuff hanging around in the kitchen — on the kitchen stove or behind the stove; we didn't have any oilskins or waterproof stuff!

In addition to the weekly washing, it would have been Amelia's job to acquire, or make and maintain her family's clothes. This would have involved expenditure of a considerably higher proportion of the family's cash income than we are used to today. Amelia probably did not spin and weave cloth as her mother may have done and most certainly her grandmothers did. By the early nineteenth century the invention of the mechanical cotton gin, the slave labor on southern cotton plantations, and the water powered looms of New England mills had made inexpensive cotton cloth generally available.

Prior to that, the main alternative to wool for New Englanders was to grow flax, process it, spin it, and weave it into linen — a messy, tedious and time consuming task. In 1850 and 1860 the agricultural census was still tracking the production of flax, but none was reported grown on North Haven. As mentioned before, a lot of sheep were raised on the Island, but I doubt if much of it was processed and woven locally. 100 years later Amelia's grandson, my Uncle Eliot raised sheep and his wife, Aunt Dorothy, used the wool for weaving on her loom. Amelia may have carded and spun wool from her own sheep to knit or crochet some of her family's clothes, but I doubt if she would have done any weaving, when affordable woolen cloth was available.

Although cloth was affordable and available, the readymade clothes industry was in its infancy. The market for men's clothes was more advanced than women's clothes — men, for the most part, being less style-conscious and more willing to settle for a common, mass produced look.

Men's clothes of that period were similar to what we think of as business attire today, although made of coarser material and a looser cut. Photographs from that time show men wearing full cut trousers, usually supported by suspenders, long sleeved button up shirts with collars, vests, and jackets. When working, a loose fitting overall with bib might be worn and the jacket left off. Any or all of these items might have been purchased ready made for Benjamin and his sons. In the neighboring town of Vinalhaven, two tailor shops, E.P.Walker and

Timothy Lane, made men's coats and pants. Freeman Smith's general store on North Haven may have carried those items.

Amelia's own clothes and those of her daughters were probably made by her, by hand, from yard goods purchased at the general store. She might also have used the services of a local dressmaker. There were four listed in the 1860 census including her cousins Susan and Sarah Kent. Photographs of women in her era show full, ankle-length skirts with high-necked, long-sleeved blouses covered with a full-bibbed apron while working. The fancy hoop skirts, bustles, crinolines and corsets fashionable in the latter part of the nineteenth century are not in evidence in most photographs of Island women.

Sewing machines powered by a foot-pedal were available in Amelia's time. She may have acquired one at some point. I know Orris's wife, Grandmother Rose, had one because it was still working when I was a kid and she taught me how to use it. My girl cousins made some of their own clothes on it. Grandma Rose also taught me how to sew on buttons, hem, baste, darn, quilt and embroider by hand. She was an expert needle worker having learned from her mother, Olive Hart Pierson, who as a young widow supported her family by running a millinery shop in Tenants Harbor, Maine.

Whether Amelia bought clothes from the store, a dressmaker, or made them herself, each garment inevitably required repair and alteration as children grew and as garments were handed down from one child to the next, a custom that was still practiced in my time. As the oldest male in my generation I did not get so many hand-me-downs, but Norwood, my youngest uncle said he never had a new piece of clothing until after he left home as an adult. The custom is institutionalized today in the North Haven Thrift shop run by the Baptist Church, one of the most popular business enterprises on the Island.

The fabric of most clothing had a second or even third life. Many household convenience items which we take for granted today were not available to Amelia and her family. I have already mentioned toilet paper but, also missing from the market place, were paper towels, paper napkins, Kleenex, disposable diapers, and sanitary pads. Most of the functions performed by these items today were accomplished with recycled cloth. Pieces of fabric which escaped these fates were destined for near immortality as a part of a quilt or of a braided or hooked rug. I am quite sure Amelia and her daughters would have spent some of their "leisure time" crafting these items.

Amelia's daughter-in-law, my Great Aunt Annie Leadbetter Beverage, was still practicing these crafts when she died in 1960 at the age of 93. I spent many hours watching her and learning from her. She also taught me how to knit fishnets and lobster pot heads, a craft which Amelia also probably practiced.

At one time most Island women — and some men — supplemented their income by knitting nets. Ida Wooster Dyer who was a clerk at Staples' Store about 1900 explained how that worked:

And another thing Mr. Staples had in his store that the women all enjoyed were the dip nets, because they could make a few cents by knitting up the dip nets. They were size 12, 18, 24, 36, 48, and 60, and as I recall, the 12" dip nets Mr. Staples paid about a dollar and seventy-five cents a dozen. And the 18 and 24 were a little more, and they increased gradually in price up to about four dollars each for the 60" ones. And they were made usually in thirds: the first — if it were a twelve, a third of that would be four inches — would be knit with a quarter of an inch mesh board. The next mesh board would be about three-eighths, and the next mesh board would be about half an inch; so you see, it would take quite a long time to knit a 60" net, and it was well worth the four dollars each. They weren't used here at all — they were used by the American Net and Twine Company, and they sold them to stores where they sold sporting goods. I made dip nets. I earned my shoes. Oh, it took me all summer to make a dozen of whatever I was doing, and I bought my shoes that way. If I didn't have enough money to buy my shoes at the end of the summer I had to go with the holes in the soles of my shoes. Seven pairs of shoes, you know, in September was quite a bill for a man to pay. Mr. Staples paid the women for their nets. Some would have them charged toward their food bills. Others would take cash — I always took cash!

I learned the craft of knitting and crocheting from my Irish-born grandmother on my mother's side and still have an afghan she made for me. My mother and her two sisters used to knit, but I don't remember seeing any evidence of that craft being practiced by Amelia or her descendents. This is odd since the raw material was running around in her pasture on four legs. I suspect that she must have knitted, although the physical evidence has disappeared. Today there is a rebirth of interest in knitting on the Island and North Island Fibers offers instruction, tools, materials and hand knit items.

Amelia's job of "keeping house" of course involved the chore of keeping the house clean and tidy. This must have been a daunting challenge. Compared with 21st century urban and suburban living today, there were some things that made Amelia's job easier: she had less total space and no bathrooms to keep clean; her family had fewer possessions, furniture and furnishings — less stuff; the outside air was less polluted. On the other hand there were factors that made the job more difficult. Wood burning stoves and oil burning lamps gave off soot and smoke. There were no paved walkways or streets so mud, dirt and snow ended up indoors in spite of the use of boot scrapers and door mats. Although people tended to spend more time outdoors, in bad weather and at night time the house was crowded and completely

lacking in privacy. I am not sure if the absence of "labor saving" devices and products made things harder for Amelia. It may have just meant that there was less labor to be saved. Her tools were rags, mops, a rug beater, and a broom, which may have been factory made, but more likely was home made. I would guess, however, that her most important tool was discipline — getting the children to pick up after themselves and help with the daily chores. A picture of her taken by Orris when she was about fifty gives me the impression that she was pretty good at this.

Family Growth and Preservation

As the children grew older Amelia would have had some help with housework, but there was one important function that only she could do — producing a family. I have calculated that during the 19 years between the conception of her first child, Theodore, in 1854 and the time she weaned her last born, Robert, in 1873, she was either pregnant or nursing or both about eighty percent of the time. In making this calculation I assumed that she weaned her children at about one year:

Children born to Amelia and Benjamin Beverage:

Theodore E.: 03 Jul 1855
Harriet N "Hattie": 1856
James: 05 Aug 1858
Orris L.: 11 Aug 1860
Charles H.: 13 May 1862
James N.: 06 Nov 1866
Jemima A. "Mima": 06 Nov 1866
Mary E. "Mae": 27 Feb 1869
Robert E. "Win": Jul 1872

Until the older children were able to take care of the younger ones, Amelia would have been operating a one-woman fulltime daycare center in addition to all her other responsibilities. There is no end of mischief that a young child can get into on a farm. I remember, however, from my own childhood on the Island that every adult felt free and obligated to exercise parental authority and it was difficult for a child to remain unnoticed for any length of time. I am sure that system was in place in Amelia's time.

Island Life

Health

There was neither hospital nor clinic on the Island and it was not until 1880 that there was a resident physician (George Esterbrook) and a nurse (Lucy Bray). Corydon Brown told a story about his father James F. Brown who was born in 1846:

"Someone was sick in the family. And he ... took a skiff — rowed to Camden, got the doctor, rowed back; took the doctor back, and he rowed back himself the same night. Yeah — started over for him in that evening (alone), got him and took him back. Pretty well morning, 'twas, when they got there! No, he couldn't do nawthin' for him (it was an older man). Well, he said what he'd give him for one thing'd just poison another! I suppose he gave him some medicine."

The absence of medical services for a rural community like North Haven was not unusual in the mid nineteenth century. In fact the medical profession did not have much to offer in terms of disease prevention and treatment until the end of the century. In 1860 life expectancy at birth was about 39 years. If you survived until age five, you could expect to live to 55.

These numbers were not much different in 1900. Early childhood was the critical period. The 1900 census recorded for each woman the total number of children she had given birth to as well as the number still living. In North Haven that census listed 73 women who were married or widowed age 45 or older (past child bearing age). These women had given birth to 292 children (an average of four each). 220 (75%) of these children were still alive in 1900. In other words, these women outlived 25% of their children.

The care of the family sick and injured would have been Amelia's responsibility; the women of the community were the default care givers. She may have had access to a copy of a manual such as the widely available *The Family Nurse, or, Companion of the Frugal Housewife*, by Lydia Maria Child published in 1837. It contained a lot of good advice about diet, cleanliness and exercise. Mrs. Child recommended that certain basic necessities be kept on hand; Ipecac, Castor oil, Magnesia, paregoric and laudanum. The latter two contained opium, which was about the only pain reliever available at the time and paregoric was suggested in small amounts even for infants.

Amelia's medicine cabinet probably contained paregoric and laudanum and some of the many available patent medicines whose ingredients included these in addition to alcohol. There was no Food and Drug Administration at the time so the ingredients were neither listed, nor guaranteed to be pure and harmless. It is possible that even good Baptist households which were otherwise alcohol free would unknowingly (or knowingly) harbor that evil ingredient in a medicine

cabinet. Lewis MacDonald had a store where he sold Jamaica Ginger a popular patent medicine referred to as "Jake" which was 70% to 80% ethanol. It was frequently purchased by men who had no symptoms other than alcohol withdrawal.

Ruth Dole Parsons, born in 1898, tells of remedies from local plants which Amelia may have used:

My father had a place — he wouldn't tell anyone where 'twas — but he would go int' the woods and he would dig up a little place of moss and he would dig what they'd call 'gold-thread,' [Coptis trifolia] and take it home, and Mother used to dry it and she'd put a little bit of it into real alcohol and let it sit, and if we had a sore throat, or if we had a canker in our mouth she would take a little bit in a sauce-dish, wet cotton in it, 'n' dip it into that gold-thread solution. And 'twas one 'the best things that there ever was for a canker, and it was the best thing in the world for a sore throat — that you ever heard tell of 'n' I know something else that's good for a canker: Herbert used t' go down in the woods 'n' he'd take 'n' cut off a piece of cat-spruce bark and he'd bring it up t' the house; and after you take the bark off of a tree the inside is all pink, isn't it? You take and scrape off that inner lining and chew that pink inner lining, and it's one of the best things there ever was for canker. And that's an old-fashioned remedy, but it was good.

Amelia must have had knowledge and use of other "natural" remedies. Child has a long section on the uses of herbs and roots. Those that I know were available growing wild on the Island include: charcoal, wild cherry bark, peppermint, goldenrod, dock, dandelion, juniper, cedar, ash bark, pine pitch, spruce gum, fir balsam, blackberry leaves, sumac berries, skunk cabbage root, milk weed root, marsh mallow root, and burdock. The gathering and preparation of these would require considerable time and effort.

Probably, however, the most effective part of her treatment would have been labor-intensive tender loving care. She had lost her son, James, at the age of four in 1863. Each of her remaining eight children almost certainly contracted the common childhood diseases of scarlet fever, measles, mumps, chicken pox, and whooping cough and had other ailments and injuries requiring her ministrations. Being an only daughter, Amelia would have also been responsible for nursing her father, Norwood, when he died in 1868 at the age of 58.

Diphtheria was a scourge against which Amelia and her neighbors had no defense. It is a contagious disease which causes swelling of the neck making swallowing and breathing difficult. As the disease progresses it can lead to paralysis, kidney failure and heart failure. Untreated cases result in 40% to 50% mortality.

There was no known treatment in Amelia's time. An antitoxin was discovered and used successfully for the first time in 1891, but in

1920 there were still 13,000 to 15,000 annual deaths from the disease. By 1924 a vaccine had been developed and a national campaign of inoculation brought the disease under control.

A diphtheria epidemic on North Haven hit Amelia's family very hard in 1875. Her oldest son, Theodore, had died at the age of 18 the previous spring, possibly of that disease. By the end of 1875 her mother, Hannah, was dead at the age of 64, and her husband, Benjamin, died at the age of 53 the same week of the same disease. In the same epidemic, Benjamin's brother Albert lost three daughters: Lenora (17), Julia (9), and Nettie (19 months), and Albert's wife, Olive, lost two sisters: Lenora Carver Beverage (35) the wife of Benjamin's cousin John W. Beverage, and Orinda Carver Beverage (37), the wife of Benjamin's Cousin Alvin Beverage. Benjamin's brother, Harrison, also lost his infant son Fred (7 months). Orris' first cousin, Mercy Beverage Sleeper also died in 1875 at the age of 66.

Cause of death on North Haven for 1860, 1870 and 1880

Given Name	Surname	Age	Cause of Death	Year	Contagious
Deborah	Grant	74	Apoplexy [probably stroke]	1880	
Mabel E	Brown	1	cholera infantum	1880	
Glover G	Webster	49	dropsy of chest	1880	
Julia	Fuller	56	Dropsy*	1880	
Jason M	Dyer	17	drowned	1870	
James	Dyer	42	drowned	1880	
Horatio G	Brown	70	heart disease	1880	
Jabez	Leadbetter	63	kidney complaint	1880	
Mercy	Annis	86	old age	1860	
Olive	Lindsey	95	old age	1870	
Nehemiah	Stone	86	old age	1880	
Mary	Webster	85	old age	1880	
Ann	Calderwood	80	old age	1880	
Benjamin	Mills	75	Paralysis [probably stroke]	1880	
Romana C	Brown	33	uterus disease	1870	
Winnie P	Cooper	0	brain fever [probably meningitis]	1880	X
Lydia	Lindsey	84	consumption [tuberculosis]	1860	X
Lydia	Wooster	76	consumption [tuberculosis]	1860	X
Ralph	Wooster	23	consumption [tuberculosis]	1870	X
Margaret M	Smith	29	consumption [tuberculosis]	1870	X
Lettie C	Waterman	15	consumption [tuberculosis]	1880	X
Amanda M	Cooper	44	consumption [tuberculosis]	1880	X
Martha A	Ames	1 1/2	croup [diphtheria?]	1870	X
Edgar	Wooster	1	lung fever [pneumonia]	1860	X
Addie	Webster	2	smallpox	1860	X
Edna	Frye	2 1/2	smallpox	1860	X
Susan	Cooper	14	smallpox	1860	X
Lydia	Wooster	38	typhoid fever	1860	X
Mary V	Alexander	17	typhoid fever	1870	X

Jetson Dyer remembered Amelia's neighborly concern for others saying, "She was just a nice old lady. She used to go over there when we was sick take care of us. Come over to our place when a baby'd come, you know, she'd come over, 'n' help out — take care of my mother. I think I was one of 'em (ayah). She was a nice old lady."

In spite of the lack of professional medical services, however, life on the Island may have been healthier during Orris's childhood than it is today. For each census year of 1860, 1870 and 1880, the US Census Bureau prepared a Mortality Schedule showing the cause of death for everyone who died during that year. I have summarized these schedules in the table on the previous page so we can look at the number and cause of death for three of the twenty one years from 1860 to 1880 when Orris was living on the Island. This is 14% of the total, so although not a complete picture, it indicates what was typical for that period.

It is interesting that the death rate for 1860 (8 out of 952) and for 1870 (7 out of 806) were each 0.8% of the total population which is about what the mortality rate was for the country as a whole in 2009. In 1880 when there was a resident physician on the Island the death rate more than doubled to 1.8% (14 out of 755). I am not suggesting a causal relationship between the two facts and, in fairness to the medical profession, there were no known cures for any of the fatal conditions listed in the schedule other than the body's natural defenses.

In many ways the environment and lifestyle on the Island back then was healthier than today: people got plenty of exercise, they got plenty of rest, there was little pollution other than wood smoke, food was produced locally and organically, there was no processed or junk food. In 2009 heart disease and cancer accounted for 50% of deaths in this country (about 25% each). Both of these can be attributed for the most part to environmental and life style conditions which did not exist back then. There is only one case of heart disease listed on the schedule and only one (uterus disease) that might be cancer.

Food

So Amelia's duties included child care, house cleaning, nursing, wardrobe maintenance, and helping Benjamin on the farm. In addition to all that she had to find time to prepare and serve three meals a day for up to ten people. Amelia's mother Hannah probably had to cook in an open fire place as a young woman — certainly her grandmothers did. But Amelia must have had a cast iron wood burning stove. Since it was used for both heating and cooking, she would have kept a fire going in it almost constantly except in the summer. Those stoves did not have a timer or a heat control it took considerable experience and skill to cook on one. Dishes which could tolerate some variation in time and heat

such as slow simmering or low heat baking were the easiest for a busy housewife.

I doubt if Amelia ever had to worry about having enough food for her family, although her menus may have lacked variety, and she may have despaired about finding the time and energy to prepare and serve it. Her cellar, shed and pantry would be stocked with produce from her farm: corn, potatoes, beans, squash, onions, apples, cider, root vegetables, and salted or smoked beef, pork and fish. The chicken coop produced plenty of eggs and an occasional hen. In addition the produce from one or two milking cows was more than enough milk, butter, cream, and cheese. These items could always be supplemented with an occasional fresh fish, lobster, clam or, scallop from the bay.

Amelia did not have an ice box. Although introduced around 1860, they were not in general use until later in the century. When iceboxes became more popular, especially when the influx of rusticators after 1880 created a demand for summer ice, Elmer Hopkins employed a crew of fifteen harvesting ice from Fresh Pond in the winter, but that business folded when gas and electric refrigerators came in.

There was no electricity up-Island on the Middle Road until 1932 and none in Benjamin's house until about 1954. During warm weather Amelia might keep a few things cool by lowering them into the cool water of the well, but otherwise perishable food like dairy products had to be consumed quickly or else fed to the hogs.

In the late spring and summer this fare could be supplemented with wild berries, rhubarb, wild dandelions, and greens from the garden. The rest of the year the family diet would have been short on fresh fruits and vegetables. I doubt if Amelia did much, if any canning. It was a messy time-consuming process, difficult to do well with the primitive equipment available, so spoilage was a big problem.

The Mason jar had been invented in 1858, and the clamped lid Lightning jars were invented in 1882. These were improvements, but they were scarce and expensive in her day. She may have put up a small amount of jams, jellies and pickles as condiments, but canning enough produce to make a substantial contribution to the winter diet was not a practical option.

Canning was not the only way to preserve food. Ruth Dole Parsons had a recipe for pickled dandelion greens that must have been handed down for generations:

I've got an earthen jar, and I plan on having that full of salty greens in the spring. You dig 'em before they blossom; they're no good after that. Well, you want the teeny little buds. You want a little bud, but you don't want a great big bud on the stalk. The little buds right in the center of the green is all you want, if you want a good one. 'Cause when they begin to have a long bud on a stem, they're bound to be bitter. Yes, sir; I found that out the hard

way. I wash them thoroughly and put 'em in. I just put them down in the jar with salt. I drained 'em, and put in a layer of salt, and a layer of greens, and a layer of salt, and a layer of greens, and they made their own pickle. I always have a clean rock; I save the rock every year, and I wash it and put it where it's clean (a good-sized rock). And I've got one plate that I always use; and I put my plate on top of the greens and I put my rock on top of the plate, and then you want a good tight cover. That's all they is to it.

In addition to local produce, Amelia purchased a few imported items: sugar and molasses from the West Indies, wheat flour from the mid west and maybe an occasional bit of tea from China. The sugar and flour were bought in bulk — 50 and 100 pound bags or barrels — not the two and five pound boxes you find in the grocery store today. Bread, biscuits, muffins, pies and pastries were of course all home made from scratch. When my father designed the kitchen for our cottage in 1930 he had built into it two large bins which could each hold 50 pounds of sugar or flour.

Given these resources and limitations, some variation of what has come to be known as New England boiled dinner was the meal most often prepared by Amelia: a cut of preserved meat such as corned beef or smoked ham shoulder boiled with whatever vegetable were on hand — usually cabbage and some roots such as potato, turnip, parsnip, rutabaga or carrots. Beans baked overnight in the oven were traditional on Sunday night — a hearty meal requiring no preparation time on the Lord's Day.

Mention of baked beans brings back a flood of memories and makes me realize how much my own food preferences have been influenced by my father who was raised on a diet similar to what Amelia fed Orris in his youth. My mother used to bake beans for my father based on the lore handed down from Amelia. I really miss those baked beans. On rare occasions I bake a pot for myself, but my family does not share my enthusiasm and it is rather a bother in this day of fast food, since the process takes at least 24 hours. They are seldom on restaurant menus and I am almost always disappointed when I do order them. I have not found a canned variety that is anything like the home cooked version.

Other simple, inexpensive, delicious dishes I remember fondly are baking powder biscuits with butter and molasses, hominy and molasses, corned beef hash, and creamed salt cod. The salt cod came in little wooden boxes which were recycled for use in the kitchen and work shop as handy storage containers.

I search in vain for clam chowder as good as I remember from my childhood in Maine. Maybe it is the process of digging and shucking the fresh clams oneself that makes the difference, or maybe the problem is that clams have become an expensive luxury item to the extent that it is

a rare experience to find more than one or two pieces of actual clam in clam chowder.

Pilot bread or crackers were an essential accompaniment for clam chowder and other soup dishes. Pilot crackers, also known as hard tack are made of just flour, water and salt. They had a long shelf life and were a staple in the diet of seamen in the nineteenth century. They are basically the same thing as the unleavened bread called matzo eaten during the Jewish ceremony of Passover. They are convenient and reliable even if not very tasty. Those who are not affected by pilot cracker nostalgia have compared them unfavorably to cardboard, but in our house, at my father's insistence, we always had a supply of this essential staple to go with our chowder and for snacks and lunch to be consumed with peanut butter or jam.

In 1792 Pearson & Sons Bakery in Newburyport, Massachusetts, started making and selling pilot crackers commercially. Through a series of acquisitions, by 1898 that company was absorbed into National Biscuit Company, known as Nabisco, which was a household word in our home. People in other Maine households apparently had a similar affection for pilot crackers, because, when Nabisco stopped manufacturing them in 1995, a statewide campaign was organized to persuade the company to resume production which it did for another seven years. But now, as far as I can tell, they are no longer available.

The countryside provided a menu to satisfy between meals cravings: Strawberries, raspberries, and blackberries in season presented themselves for casual grazing. Apples were available in the late summer and fall. Grass — especially the succulent Timothy grass — was available all summer for chewing on. Clover and honeysuckle blossoms provided a sweet treat. Pungent spruce and fir needles and spruce gum provided an interesting taste experience. Salty seaweed was good to chew and sometimes just a plain salty pebble from the beach was fun to suck. These were all healthful — or at least harmless — ways to satisfy needs which in a consumer oriented urban environment are met by less healthy items such as candy, sugary drinks and fast food snacks from the corner store or street venders.

Recreation

Several of Uncle Eliot's oral history informants told about what they did for fun and recreation. Although they were talking about a period several decades after Orris' childhood on the Island, I think their descriptions give some of the flavor of what Orris' life was like. A few of these activities required investment in equipment — a pack of cards, skates, a fiddle — but for the most part leisure activity was free. Nora Davis Waterman, for instance, described a wood chopping:

The men would come and chop wood all the afternoon; the wood'd be sawed, you know, from the woods, n' they'd split it, ready for the stove. And then, supper time, the women had supper ready: the baked bean supper and the biscuit 'n' whatever they had, and after supper — after the women got all cleaned up — why, they took the stove and set it back into the fireplace and they had the whole kitchen to dance in, up and down. Floyd Duncan's father [Henry] played the violin. That's all the music we had, yes. There was a little jog up in there, you know. Go down through the kitchen, and then there was a jog up where the cupboard come, you know, and he'd stand up in there. So we'd do the Lady of the Lake and go clear down. And sometimes we did the square dance, and the waltzes, you know. About all we done, then, was the Lady of the Lake; they used to have more fun with that than they did any other.

Winnie Burgess remembered:

One thing that we liked to do, as a family when we were growing up was to sing. Someone would play, and we'd all get together and sing. We never had much instruction, but one teacher that we had she'd make the scales on the board, so we'd know what the notes were (something like that) and then Mama showed us where they were on the organ — and so we used t' play just to amuse ourselves. We'd all sing: Harvard n' Papa n' Lucy 'n' I 'n' all of us. Well, we had the hymns, and then we got so we'd had some of the popular music — sheet music — (I've got a whole stack of that that I brought up from home. I wouldn't part from it) Grammy had an organ. We didn't have any organ, at first, but Grammy had one.

Florence Beverage Brown was a neighbor and grandniece of Benjamin. She recalled evenings at home:

There were half a dozen families 'round here then, and we'd get together evenings for games and things. Well, they used to have 'lot of different games t' play — mostly card games, like Flinch and Muggins; and they had checkers 'n' Chinese checkers ... so they used to have a lot of fun doing that. And I remember there was someone they used to tell about, that if she got beaten — that that was an awful tragic thing for her. Well, that was Isa Beverage — you remember her? This is what we did, mostly, for entertainment. The Grange wasn't organized till nineteen hundred and nine, and 'course, then they met every week; and they had real good times in the early Grange.

Nettie Beverage talked about games she played as a child:

We played "Halley Over". They tossed things over the schoolhouse — balls and things. The schoolhouse was low enough so's the boys could get things over — toss the ball over it. Someone on the other side tried to catch it (I don't remember exactly the rules of it.) And we used to play "Drop the

handkerchief": (you know) stand in a circle, drop the handkerchief, and everybody was s'posed to be on the alert, and anybody would try to get around before they could see that they'd dropped the handkerchief behind them. And if they did, they were the "fool" and they had to stand in the middle of the circle.

We always looked forward to May coming, because we hung May baskets. And people would hang us May baskets — they'd pound on the door and then they'd run and hide — and we'd get out as quick as we could and chase after them. We had a big willow tree back of the house which they used a good deal to hide in, and around the buildings and everything. And we'd climb up in the tree, yes; I've climbed up in that tree a good many times. The baskets weren't anything fancy, they'd go to the store (whoever hung the May basket) and buy some candy — and perhaps oranges — and put 'em in a bag, and hang 'em in the bag they brought 'em home in (hang 'em on the door.) Well, they usually just set 'em down, but we always called it "hanging May baskets" ... but we always set 'em down on the threshold or somewhere outside so they wouldn't step on it when they come out in a hurry. Yes, we were s'posed to run n' catch 'em, and the story is they're s'posed to get kissed, but we didn't do that part very much, I don't think. We had parties between Uncle Frank's folks and the George Alexander family and us three houses. We visited back and forth and spent the evening, and we'd play games — parlor games, you know — like "Jenkins up." But when we planned to have a party and invite the neighbors, we always popped corn and did have something for a treat.

Leah Young Beverage talked about skating:

Oh, I loved to skate! And I was a good skater too, if I do say so. But of course we didn't go up to the Lamont's, or up to the millpond, or anything like that. We skated around in the pasture. Will Dole's pasture had quite a few good skating places in it. We all skated together. After school the whole grammar school would be over there in Will Dole's pasture, skating; and once in a while — if there was a moonlight night — we were allowed to go over and skate by the moonlight. My skates were a steel blade put onto a wooden sole; and then it had straps — toe straps that fastened up around, and ankle straps — and the boys used to have what they called Red Runner skates. They were a wooden skate about that long with a steel in the bottom of it. The blade was steel; the rest of it was a wood sole that strapped onto the foot. We didn't have shoe-skates — that was unheard of. There was one of the boys did have clamp skates, and I have heard more swear words because. you get them all clamped on, and — specially if you pushed off sideways with your skate — they would come unclamped right off the sole and send the boy sprawling. I have heard quite some language about clamp skates. But when my children came along — were old enough to skate — why, shoe-skates had come in then.

Getting Around

According to cousin Vernon Beverage:

There wasn't what you could call hardly an open road on this island up to the time I was born [1890]. If you went anywheres, you went through somebody's field or pasture, and you opened gates and shut 'em. Of course, everybody knew that they didn't have any claim to them — that they had a right of way through them as long as they behaved themselves, and they did, too, as a rule.

There were exceptions, however, and Vernon recounted a story told to him by John Beverage that he remembered from childhood:

Mr. Frye came down along this way, an' he opened Father's gate — and left it swinging. In half a minute his father came out, and had a gun; and he said that Mr. Frye kept walking, and he came up abreast of his father and he says, 'Good morning, Mr. Beverage.' And he said his father said, 'Good morning, Mr. Frye.' But he says, 'Mr. Frye, I think you forgot something.' Mr. Frye says, 'I didn't forget a thing. That gate's going to swing all day as far as I'm concerned.' Father said, 'Mr. Frye, I think 'twould be better if you changed your mind, because you'll never get by here alive. I'll drop you just as quick as I'd drop a black duck.' He said Mr. Frye went back and shut the gate.

So, if you wanted to go anywhere you traveled a trail through pastures. Most of the time one would walk. There wasn't much of a tradition of riding horseback. According to the 1870 census there were only 25 horses on the Island. A few families had carriages or surreys, but horses were used mainly for farm work and moving heavy loads. However, most places one would want to go on the Island were accessible by water and most people had access to a row boat or sail boat.

The first telephones were introduced on the Island in1898, but it was a while before they were in common use in households. So there was no way to arrange social or business meetings ahead of time. There were, of course, regular meeting times for various organizations, but social visits were, for the most part unannounced — usually on a Sunday afternoon. This custom persisted for some time even after telephones were in general use, and was annoying to people not used to Island customs. Ida Dyer was the first telephone operator and explained how it worked:

About 1898, Dan Glidden came up and saw Mr. Staples and asked him if he could have the exchange in his office. And Mr. Staples agreed (I don't know what they paid him, but they paid Mr. Staples something for having the switchboard there) and Mr. Staples asked me if I would tend the board. And I said yes, I would, if Mr. Glidden would show me how to do it. He

said there was nothing to it: there would be just a ring — if they wanted Smith's store I would ring (push in a button and ring) and tell who was wanted, and that Vinalhaven wanted them, and I'd push in the Vinalhaven button and put them both and connect them. And when they were through I would have to push the buttons back. And if they wanted Rockland I'd have to do the same: I'd have to call Vinalhaven (and then instead of a button you had to grind a little grinder wheel that had a little handle on it and would ring a bell, and I would say "Vinalhaven" and I would say "Rockland," and Rockland would come on and say, "This is Rockland," and if I wanted Western Union — somebody wanted to send a telegram — I'd say to Rockland, "I want Western Union" and they would give me Western Union. And then I would give the telegram, or talk with whoever came on, and then push my buttons back and wait for another call. It really wasn't a very big board, but it seemed important to us at that time. I don't believe there were more than six phones. I think we had a phone at Vinalhaven before the North Haven was connected, and the stores both had phones, and I think Mr. Smith had a phone and I think Hans Crocket had a phone (I'm not sure: he had a post-office there at that time, you know, and I think he had a phone in his post-office — or in his house, maybe). I think Mr. Frank Beverage was one of the first ones who had phones.

Cash Crops

The most important cash crop for farmers in 1860 was sheep, a crop destined to become more valuable with the rise in the price of wool during the Civil War and the introduction of steamship service to the Island which made it feasible to ship fresh meat to Boston and other mainland markets. In 1860 seventy households were raising sheep with an average of 28 each. Benjamin's 50 sheep made him one of the top dozen sheep raisers. The presence of so many sheep necessitated many fences that required a lot of time and effort to build and maintain.

Although sheep have a reputation of not being very smart, they frequently found ways to get on the wrong side of a fence, so sheep were marked with a distinctive cut on the ear. Each owner registered his "ear mark" with the town clerk. I guess that is the origin of the term.

In 1860, however, even sheep raising did not bring in much cash. Farming was quite adequate to put food on the table for most families, but since practically every household raised their own food, there wasn't much of a local cash market for agricultural products and the off-Island market had not yet been developed.

The author holding a lamb ready for shearing on one of the last sheep roundups on the Island.

These sheep belonging to Hiram Beverage were one of the last remaining flocks on the Island, shown here about 1945 in front of the barn which had been part of Norwood Beverage's farm and was frequently the site of town meetings in the nineteenth century.

Later on North Haven sheep raisers developed a market in Boston where North Haven lamb was considered a delicacy, but this was short-lived. North Haven farmers were unable to comply with government regulations. Cousin Hiram explained the problem:

We used to send the lambs to market. In those days we could market our sheep without any difficulty, locally or ship them — either one. But later on — as time went on — they kept putting on restrictions, and they wouldn't allow you to do anything (I mean, unless they was federally inspected); What we did, we had to sell them alive to somebody on the mainland and they took all the profits. We used to have a special Market up there. We used to do pretty well, lots of times. They'd take the lamb and they'd turn around and give you so much for however much they'd retail 'em out — retail the parts, I mean — and it turned out pretty good. But the last time we shipped up there — we come pretty near getting in Dutch, because we weren't supposed to retail them out unless they were stamped by a Federal inspector. As I say, there was no inspector on the island — we couldn't get them federally stamped, not here. So we had to ship them live to somebody'd come off the mainland.

The total value of all agricultural products on the Island reported in the 1860 Agricultural schedule was $8,788. I suppose there was considerable barter — eggs for milk, beans for potatoes, wood for corn, etc., but for cash, the most obvious resource was the sea around the Island and the more distant Banks.

Not surprisingly there was a strong correlation between the amount of land one owned and whether one was primarily a farmer or a fisherman, but the record is unclear which came first — the land ownership or the decision to be a farmer. I suspect in most cases it was the former. I also believe that land ownership at that time was more a matter of what family you were born into and your birth order, than a reflection of individual ability and enterprise.

Grandfather Orris and his Brother James in Marsh Cove getting ready to go fishing.

Probably every household on North Haven profited from cod fishing.

A Federal census of Corporations or individuals producing articles to the annual value of $500 or more in North Haven in 1860 lists ten enterprises. Eight of these were engaged in fishing. The other two were Norwood Beverage's mill operation which employed three people and produced $4,575 and a shoe and boot shop operated by a John H. Harrison also employing three men and produced goods worth $3,060.

In contrast the eight fishing enterprises produced $76,980 (90% of all goods produced) and employed an average of 262 men. There were only 240 able bodied men between the ages of 18 and 65 living on the Island in 1860. There was probably overlap in the reported employees with some men working for more than one enterprise, and some of the men were probably from neighboring towns, nevertheless it would appear that nearly every man on the island spent some time that year with the fishing fleet.

Perry Westbrook in writing about neighboring Swans Island describes life on the Banks in the 1860s as follows:

On the fishing grounds the hours were long and the work exhausting. The baiting, setting, hauling, or under running of trawls, the cleaning and curing of the catch, not to mention the sailing of the vessel, made for round-the-clock working. Yet discipline was extremely easy. These were crews of equals sharing in the profits of the venture and thus working for themselves as much as for the owners, though the owners, who paid the outfitting bills, naturally got the largest share. The Maine boats were manned almost exclusively by men of native stock, all of the same background. Many members of a crew would be blood relations. The master had no need to be like the tyrants who commanded the motley crews of the whaling vessels. Certainly there was no need for the regimentation found on a man-of-war. Often the captain would consult with the men before making decisions. The food was necessarily simple and the quarters confined. Rum, particularly in earlier times, was a staple on all voyages. Sometimes a keg was lashed on deck, a cup handy, so that the crew could help themselves at will. In the hold, beneath the salt required for curing the catch, other barrels of rum would be stowed, partly so that it wouldn't be drunk up at once and partly as an incentive for the men to work hard using up the salt.

By 1860 the larger and better equipped boats from Gloucester and ports nearer to Boston were beginning to be too much competition for the smaller communities closer to the Banks. This was the beginning of the race to the bottom which ended in the total collapse of the fishing industry in that part of the world by 1890 with the introduction of ever bigger vessels and more destructive equipment and practices. Although the fishermen of North Haven's fleet were eventually forced out of the cod industry, they still had many options and adjusted their activities to take advantage of markets for other species whose habitat was

closer to shore and could be harvested commercially on day trips, thus avoiding the long absences from home and expense of larger vessels and provisioning and equipment required for fishing on the Banks.

Fish oil along with whale oil was the major fuel for lighting in those days. (Dependency on Mid-East oil was many years in the future). Oily fish such as mackerel and menhaden, or pogy, were in demand to feed the fish oil extraction plants along the coast.

The 1860 industrial census for North Haven records 176 barrels of fish oil produced for a total value of $2,500. A process for canning fish had recently been discovered (or rediscovered), and fish canning factories on the coast created a market for fresh fish, especially herring which became sardines when canned. By 1870 there was a lobster canning factory on North Haven which employed 12 female and 3 male residents. In 1860 there were only 2 men and 4 women reported working there, although there may have been more who worked there occasionally, but not enough for it to be recorded by the census as their primary occupation.

Olive Stone Lermond told about how her father, Hiram, was often away from home for months at a time as late as the 1880s as were many other Island men:

A great many of their fathers weren't home; they were away fishing. My own father used to go off the Carolina coast for mackerel. Well, they'd go early in the spring down there, and then come back. Now, he was born in 1860; he was probably doing this by the time he was twenty or twenty-two or three. Yes, the fathers went off fishing, and what farming was done was done by the boys that were left. Not all of them, of course, were farmers that were left; but a great many of them had farms.

When I was young there was an active weir between Hog Island and Oak Hill on land adjacent to our family property. It belonged to my Great Uncle Fred Carver, husband of Orris's sister, Mima. On at least one occasion when the herring had been running my father and I rowed out to the weir while the fishermen were bailing the herring from the purse of the seine into their dories. As a favor they would dump a net full of fish into a tub for us to take home — by the end of the week we would be tired of eating herring.

Fred Carver's niece, Elsie Carver Brown, told about her childhood memories of the weir business:

I was always around when they were working on the weirs — tending them or building them. How they did — well, you know what a great big seine boat is? That's what they used to build weirs. At first you have to drive the stakes, and on the end of this scow was a "gin." You know what gins are: great big thing with a block you h'ist up 'n' really come down ker-bang!? That's the gin, and that's the way they drove the weir. And then they'd put

the binders 'round to hold them together — poles 'round the outside (small poles — 'n' nail 'em. And they had three "pounds": there was the fish pound where the fish come in, and then there was the "heart" (it was shaped like a heart) — they'd come around into that, and then the "keep" pound. Well, the keep pound was ... twine around it' and the other two pounds and the lead that went to the shore (the lead from the weir, you know), that was so when the fish come up against it they'd follow along and go int' the opening into the weir. And that was brushed, and the two pounds was brushed: they had two rows of binders 'round 'em, one down and another one up around higher up, and they'd nail the brush to both the binders. They would stick some brush down int' the water 'n' nail it; some would go up. Nailed 'em on one end (the heavy end) and in the middle. But one end would go down int' the water (that would stop the fish down under the water) and the next one would go the other side up: the brush up there ... and the brush down, so there'd be brush on the top and brush on the bottom. The brush was quite near together.

I remember one time in the cove up there: there was a shark in the weir, and we went out and stood on a binder. Well! We were just about that far from him, standin' on the binder, and he would swim around — roll that eye up at us. And there was a man there (I don't know who he was, now) went in with a dory with a flounder spear and speared him, and 'course he lost the spear. He was a big one — nine or ten feet long. I didn't want him to come up and bite my toes, sticking out through the binder, either. He could have reached me if he'd wanted to — heavens, they come right out of the water, you know. And then they caught one — and I've got a snapshot of it — on the beach (a big shark). And I can't remember of eatin' any of that, but I know where they'd catch porpoise and we'd tried some porpoise meat. Did you ever eat any? It was something like liver.

Every night, 'course, they'd have to go look in the weirs seeing if there was any fish. That was always a treat for us kids. Row, you know, from Marsh Cove clear around to the Pond holes to (that would be now) Watson's beach. We did the rowing — loved to do it, and then lotta times, 'cordin' to the way the tides were — they would be out late nights lookin' for fish. And then if you had fish already in there you would put the seine around the ones in the fish pound, open the gate, and keep haulin' in the net — purse the net in right up, you know — 'n' drive 'em right in. Lots of times there'd be mackerel in with 'em, and we'd have fun dipping in: catching mackerel with our hands. But it would be hard work, most times, for my father. I've seen my mother — he'd been up all night bailin' herring — and he would come to the house, and he'd call these different factories and tell them that he had fish, and he would be so tired that my mother would stand by his elbow and tell him what to say.

Perry Westbrook pointed out:

Weir operating is perhaps the greatest gamble in all the fishing on the Maine coast. The only mitigating factors are that the ante is not great and the winnings can be enormous. Unless he builds near some offshore islet or ledge, the weir operator doesn't even need a power boat. A couple of dories are sufficient to row out to the trap and seine it when a catch is made ... All along the coast are stories of weirs that in two or three nights have made fortunes for their owners. In the most impressive of these stories, the weir has been a dud for years. Then one morning the owner goes out to find the pocket bulging with squirming silver. The trouble with a catch like this is that the run may have been phenomenal elsewhere and a dozen other fishermen the same night may have made similar catches so that the market is flooded and prices depressed. But when such hauls occur in isolated cases, the fisherman makes a killing indeed.

When I was a teenager one summer I went to work in a sardine canning plant in Rockland. This was about 1946. I suppose the plant was pretty similar to the first ones which had been built along the coast about eighty years earlier. The plant was a large, barn like structure built over the water so boats could pull up along side to unload the fish. When a sardine boat arrived at the plant, a whistle notified the packers to come to work — no matter what time of day or night it was.

The packers (all women) would hurry in from all directions and sit at long tables with piles of fish in front of them and piles of empty cans at the side. With a large scissors they would snip off the head and tail of each fish and fill the cans "packing them in like sardines." They were paid by the piece and worked fast.

My job was to collect the filled cans, place them on trays on a rack and roll them into the steam room to be cooked. When cooked, after the cans cooled down a bit I would pack them into cartons for shipping. It was hard, noisy, messy work. One of the perks of the job was that I could have as many damaged cans as I wanted for my own consumption. On the pay I got, that was about all I could afford to eat after paying my rent. I don't eat sardines much today.

Alewives were a species of herring that lived in the ocean but returned to fresh water to spawn. Fresh Pond on North Haven was one of their spawning grounds, so every spring they could be harvested by dip net as they swam up the inlet from Pulpit Harbor. They were used for bait and chum and also were smoked and canned. Today the mackerel, herring, and alewives are all gone from Penobscot Bay along with many other species. There may be hope for reversing this trend, however. As I was writing this passage, my mailman delivered the latest issue of *The Working Waterfront*, a monthly publication of the Island Institute. The lead article tells of a project of the Maine Department of Marine Resources to restore the alewives by restocking Fresh Pond.

There were other seasonal opportunities to harvest fresh seafood: There was a little brook running along the edge of Benjamin's farm that emptied into Marsh Cove. We called it Clay Brook because it flowed through a deposit of clay pure enough to use with very little processing for making pottery. I had also heard my father refer to it as Smelt Brook and tell about how he and his buddies used to harvest those little fish when they made their annual trip up the brook to spawn just as the alewives did.

I had thought this was a phenomenon of the past, but I remember one year, when I was still quite young, I approached the brook and looked down to see a mass of silvery little fish. I excitedly ran home to get a dip net and a bucket and became the first of my generation to experience the joy of smelting. I rushed home with my catch and proudly presented it to my mother, who gamely, but not enthusiastically, agreed to cook it for dinner. My father explained that these little fish, about two inches long, are so small and delicate that they can be eaten whole — head, tails, bones, guts and all. This takes a little getting used to, even for a hardened carnivore.

One year when we were living in the farm formerly owned by Norwood and Hanna adjacent to the inlet to Fresh Pond, my father and I witnessed a run of eels headed for the pond to spawn. We rushed home to get some fishing lines and bait and returned to catch dinner. While it was easy enough to hook one of the strong, squirming creatures; having done so, I learned the meaning of the term "slippery as an eel."

My father's boyhood experience came to the rescue. He grabbed a handful of dirt first then grasped the eel just below its head and decapitated it with a knife. He then showed me how to skin it. You loosen enough skin at one edge to be able to get a good hold with the aid of some dirt to get traction and just pull — sort of like pulling off a sock. Again, my mother was a game but reluctant partner and prepared the eels for supper — they were very good.

The ocean provided resources other than fish. Seaweed was plentiful and could be harvested easily at low tide. It was used as fertilizer and mulch by the Island farmers. Various seaweeds have been and are used for food and medicinal purposes. Today kelp is harvested in Maine for industrial uses, but I do not know of uses for seaweed in Orris's time other than fertilizer with the possible exception of Irish moss (a species of protein rich red algae), which often washed up on the shore after a storm and was used as a nutritious thickening agent in food. I used to collect it and bring it home for my mother to use in her cooking — again, she was not enthusiastic about my efforts. I understand that in Ireland during the potato famine a diet of Irish moss saved thousands of people from starvation. I wonder if my Irish mother shared a collective historic memory of those times.

The salt water could also, of course, provide salt, essential not only for cooking but for preserving food, especially the cod and other products of the fishing industry. In 1860 salt was scarce and expensive, so some Island entrepreneurs found it worth the considerable time and effort to boil down huge quantities of sea water to produce a crude salt product which was adequate for the fish curing business. There is a place called Salt Works Point on the north side of Oak Hill. It takes about 400 gallons of seawater to make a bushel of salt. Just try boiling away one gallon of water and you will get an idea of how much effort is involved — remember you would have to cut the wood to keep the caldron boiling.

Clams were plentiful and available to anyone with a strong back and a clam fork. Today you also need a license. Clams live buried about a foot below the ground in mud flats which are covered at high tide but accessible at low tide. By Maine law private property ended at the high tide mark, so clam flats were theoretically available to anyone who wanted to dig. In practice, however, there was a common understanding about who could dig in which flats and this was for the most part respected, although physical confrontations were not unknown.

Because clams were so plentiful and available, at the time we are talking about, there was little or no cash market. Later on when there were more people who were unable or unwilling to dig their own clams and transportation to the mainland became more practical, a number of people made a living, or supplemented their income, by clamming.

When I was young the clam flats in front of the Point on the way to Little Island were very productive and only family dug there — except in the off season, when no one was there to defend them. Twenty minutes of digging would produce a good-sized mess of fresh clams for dinner. Twenty or thirty minutes of digging, however, were about all I could manage even when I was in good physical shape.

The author and his father digging clams for dinner.

To dig clams one must stand with feet spread far apart and bend at the waste to uncover the buried clams with a clam fork. One must then lean over to feel around in the mud and pick out the liberated clams. You can not kneel down to do this because you need the weight of your body to push the fork into the mud and you have to keep repositioning yourself as you dig a trench through the mud.

I suppose professional diggers get used to that kind of work, but back ailments are an occupational condition. Few clams are left along the whole coast now and those that are still there are often not harvestable because of a phenomenon called "red tide" — a bloom of phytoplankton which can make shellfish poisonous and not fit to eat.

There used to be a bed of scallops in Marsh cove. You had to drag for them. Uncle Albion did that when he was young using his catboat called Amy, but they were all gone by the time I came along. There were still plenty of scallop shells on the beach, however, and every cottage had a collection of them used for ashtrays, candle holders, dishes and decoration. They were the implement of choice for scooping lime after using the outhouse.

Neal Burgess told an amusing story on Uncle Al about his scalloping venture in the Amy:

Al and young Parker Stone who was 'round here at that time decided one winter that they'd go scallopin'. And they had what we always called a catboat. She was not very long but she was awful wide — bulky — and they had her up to the Beverage colony. They worked night and day on her, gettin' an engine into her and gettin' her ready to go scallopin'. They were goin' to do wonders! They finally got her ready and la'nched her down on the beach, so she would float. And I guess by the time she floated it was pretty near dark (they was goin' to bring her around to the Thoroughfare that night). So they la'nched her down on the beach, and when she floated they got aboard: and they had already had the engine goin', so that worked alright, and they started out. And she seemed to be workin' goin' along good, but awful slow. They couldn't seem to get any speed out of her. The engine seemed to run alright, but there was no speed.

Well, it got late and different ones, 'round — they knew they had started and they hadn't showed up, and they thought 'twas an awful while gettin' around. So they called down to the Little Thoroughfare where Mr. Gillis lived and asked him if he had seen or heard anything of 'em. And he told them that he had been outdoors and he heard this boat goin' up through the Little Thoroughfare; and he said the engine seemed to be runnin' fine — was doin' a nice job (seemed to be) — but it seemed to be goin' awful slow.

Well, they finally made it up here, and I guess she was leakin' some — and they thought it would be a good idea to put her on the beach (the tide was up). So they took her in and grounded her on the beach down where the parkin' lot is now — alongside of Phil Brown's wharf. The next mornin' they

went down to look — see how bad she was leakin', and so on; and there she was, settin' on the cradle that they'd la'nched her on up there just as pretty as could be!

Uncle Al's catboat *Amy* in its final resting place at boathouse beach.

Mussels were and still are plentiful, and can easily be gathered by hand at low tide. For some reason they were never considered by the natives to be fit for human consumption until recently. That may explain why they are still plentiful. I never tasted a mussel until I traveled to Europe as an adult and became addicted to them while visiting Belgium, where they are the national dish. Today mussels are about the only local seafood available to the casual hunter and gatherer, but even they are often off limits because of the red tide.

It used to be that one could row out a hundred feet from the shore, drop a baited hook to the bottom and pull in a good sized flounder every few minutes — you might also catch a sculpin or a dogfish neither of which were considered edible, but twenty minutes on the water usually produced enough fish for a meal. Nowadays you can sit for hours with a baited line and never get a bite.

That is about the end of the fish part of this story except for a few words about lobsters. Today the lobster is about all that is left of the former diverse and plentiful aquatic population of the Gulf of Maine. Over-fishing and environmental pollution has done in most of the other species, although efforts are being made to bring some of them back. The lobster has survived mainly through the unique cooperative efforts of the professional lobstermen — a story which has been written about often and at length. I will not repeat it here but refer the reader to among others *The Lobster Coast* by Colin Woodward.

Grandfather Orris on the way to tend his lobster traps in the *Olive A*.

Today a number of Island men and women make a living from lobstering in a good year, but it is full-time labor and capital-intensive work. Lobstermen tend to be constantly in debt and under pressure to produce in order to pay for equipment and supplies: boat, fuel, traps, buoys, lines, and bait. In Orris' day all of these items were made by hand or gathered from local materials with no investment other than labor. Lobsters were more plentiful and available in shallow water closer to land. Lobstering was one of several occasional occupations, not a full time profession.

Education

Amelia had many jobs and responsibilities, but the formal education of her children was not one of them. The town of North Haven provided this service. I am indebted to Seward E. Beacom, author of White Schoolhouses on an Island, published by the North Haven Historical Society, for most of what I know about this subject.

As was the case throughout New England, the citizens of North Haven took education seriously. In 1860 all but 7 of the adult population were literate — at least that is what was reported to the census taker. Of those seven, one was mentally challenged, listed in the census as an "idiot." Three were "from away" and three were very old — having come of age during the period of the Revolutionary war when education was disrupted.

In 1860 almost every child from the age of five to twenty attended school that year — a total of 368, but that did not mean the same thing back then as it does today. A school term was only eight or ten weeks and often there was only one term per year, sometimes two or three terms, so at the most there would be thirty weeks of school in a year. Furthermore the actual average attendance was considerably less than the total school census for each year.

I believe this high level of absenteeism reflected the fact that children's labor was needed at home. I doubt if a child could get away with playing hooky in that society without the knowledge and acquiescence of adults. Olive Stone Lermond, born in 1900, talked about school attendance in her day which would have been around 1905-1920:

You see, boys went in the winter long after they'd ceased to go in the summer. I don't know as they ever went much in the summer; that was girls' time. My own common school education consisted of just three ten-week terms a year, down here. And I stopped going down here in June 1914 (that was before I had my fourteenth birthday.) You went ten regular weeks: you went the fall term ten weeks, then you had probably a month vacation and then you picked it up again in January and you went ten more weeks. Then you had a vacation of about a month and you went ten more weeks: that

made your thirty. But you do know that usually the boys, when they got to be any age, stayed out.

Orris would have started school in 1865 or 1866 when he was five years old. At that time there were five school districts on the Island, each with its own one-room schoolhouse. Orris attended the Northeast district 5 School. It was located about a half mile from his home in a field near the house where Dalon Brown lived when I was a child; on the west side of the North Shore Road about opposite from where the Watson airfield is today. That school house was built in 1852 at a cost of $213.92. In 1872 a new building was constructed in about the same location at a cost of $525. That building was moved in 1904 to the south west corner of the intersection of the Middle Road and the North Shore Road where it still stands at this writing, but is no longer used as a schoolhouse.

Built in 1872, the Northeast District Schoolhouse was moved to the intersection of the Middle Road and the South Shore Road in 1904. This picture was probably taken in the 1920s when Nettie Beverage taught there.

There were about twenty five "scholars" from the age five to twenty attending District 5 with Orris. There were no grades. One teacher taught everyone in a single room, each child progressing at his or her own pace. The subject matter was limited to reading, writing and arithmetic. The only requirement to be a teacher was to be certified by the school agent of the local district.

When Orris started school the agent for his district was Otis Kent, the second cousin of his father Benjamin. Teachers were paid $5 a week. Most of them were young unmarried women. There was a lot of turnover. A list of teachers at district 5 from 1865 to 1874 shows that there were 13 different teachers for those ten years while Orris was in attendance. Two of them were teenagers and most of the rest were in their early twenties. School teachers were paid at the same rate as laborers, $5 a week plus room and board. The total school budget for all five districts was $657.87 in 1865; by 1880 it had increased to $1,037.38.

There was no high school level instruction available to Island residents until 1877 when a two year high school was introduced, but it was discontinued in 1878 and not started again until 1887. Orris turned 17 in 1877 and probably attended those high school classes for two years. They were held in the Middle District building which at that time was located south of the old Eleazer Crabtree house south east of the present junction of South Shore Road and Pulpit Harbor Road. He would have had to walk three and a half miles each way to attend classes there.

Even after the High School was established, there were still some students who lived too far away to attend, but they got some high school classes in the district schools. Winnie Burgess Ames who was born in 1891 and grew up across the Thoroughfare on Vinalhaven recalled:

I never went to High School; it was so far to go. But we took high school subjects right there in the district school. It wasn't really graded same as the regular schools now; we just kept going to that same school — I went till I was eighteen or nineteen years old — and the teachers would work in these extra subjects. We took them just the same as we would any; I know we took algebra and rhetoric and physical geography, American literature and ancient history, Socrates and some of those old ancient fellows.

Changing Times

Economic Decline

By the time Orris had exhausted the Island's educational opportunities in 1878, he may have seen signs that the old way of life was in decline, just as in the rest of New England and the rest of the country for that matter. In the fifteen years from the time of his birth in 1860 to his father's death in 1875 there was practically no growth in the family wealth. An inventory of his estate at his death showed that Benjamin's real estate had decreased by 20 acres and $500 in value. His personal estate had increased by $426 — this included four more cattle, and six more sheep, but two fewer hogs.

The Island population had peaked in 1860 just before the Civil War when it was 953. By 1880 it had shrunk to 755. The 1860 census listed 197 men on the Island born between 1829 and 1847; this is the cohort who would have been of prime military age during the war. By 1880 only 97, less than half, of these men were still living on the Island. In fact the loss of men and women on the Island between 1860 and 1880 was almost entirely in this age group — the group that in 1880 was in the prime of life between 33 and 51 years of age.

This age group had shrunk by over 50% as opposed to 20% for the population as a whole. There were several reasons for this: The Civil War was at least indirectly a cause for much of this loss of population. The people of Maine supported the Union almost universally and contributed to the cause more than any other state as measured by the percent of the population who served in the armed forces.

North Haven sent thirty three men to fight for the Union. All but one of these survived the war. This high rate of survival was partly good luck, but also reflects the fact that twenty of the thirty three served in the Navy which had a much lower casualty rate than the Army. By 1880, however, only twelve of the surviving 32 veterans were living on the Island. Those who did not return had obviously found more attractive opportunities off-island and had probably influenced others to leave also. There were some reasons to want to leave.

Commercial fishing, which had been the main source of cash for Islanders, was becoming problematic. The number of fisherman had decreased from 159 in 1860 to 131 in 1870. As early as the 1870s the supply of fish in Penobscot Bay and nearby waters had decreased from over-fishing, so longer trips to the offshore banks became more productive and the required larger ships and more expensive gear pricing this kind of fishing out of range for Islanders with limited capital unless they went as hired hands rather than as partners, which was more profitable.

The market for fish was also changing: in 1846 the Canadian Abraham Gesner had invented a way to extract lamp fuel from petroleum which he called kerosene. Until then, oil from fish and

whales had been the major fuel for lighting. By the 1870s this market for fish oil had been almost entirely replaced by kerosene. Also a major market for New England, salt cod, had been a cheap food especially for the southern and Caribbean slave population. This market was disrupted by the Civil War, and afterwards cheap beef and pork from the Corn Belt transported east by the new railroads made inroads on the fish market.

By the 1870s much of Maine and the rest of New England had evolved from an agricultural to an industrial economy. The area was well-endowed with rivers which supplied the water power to drive the industrial machinery and those rivers and the ocean provided means for distribution of the finished items nationally and internationally.

Textiles were the largest part of the area's industrial production, but it also included shoes, machinery, canned goods, firearms, jewelry, etc. During the Civil War the supply of cotton for the textile mills was disrupted as was the southern market for New England manufactured goods, but the wartime demands of the Union Army made up for the loss of markets and local wool replaced cotton in the textile plants. Manufacturing continued to increase after the war and the demand for labor was high, although there was a long, severe economic depression from 1873 to 1877.

Farther to the west free or cheap land was still available and the young settlements were magnets for the more adventurous or less well-situated families in Maine. The Transcontinental railroad was completed in 1869 and it was linked to Rockland, Maine, in 1871 so access to the western settlements was much easier than it had been in the earlier part of the century. Maine built boats and Maine crews were, however, still in demand for coastal shipping, for the long trip around Cape Horn to California and for trade across the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans. Workers who left New England left a vacuum which created a demand closer to home for labor in the still prosperous local industries.

Indeed the eventual economic decline of Maine as an industrial center was not evident at the time. Writing in 1875 in The History of Maine, John S. C. Abbott concluded,

All things considered, there is probably not on this globe a more favored, comfortable, and happy population than that of Maine. It is true that cold breezes sweep its surface in winter; but these blasts, with healing on their wings, drive all malarias exhalations from the land, give elasticity to the mind, buoyancy to the spirits, and invigoration to all physical energies. The soil is certainly not so rich as in some of the renowned prairies and valleys of the West; but the water is cool, and pure and clear as crystal. The forests afford an abundance of every variety of valuable timber; and the streams, born among the mountains, and rushing over their rocky beds, invite to all the branches of manufactures.

So the exodus from North Haven may not have been because things were bad at home, but that they were so much better elsewhere.

Decision to Leave

By September, 1878, at the age of eighteen, Orris decided to leave the Island in order to further his education. His father had been dead for three years. His two older brothers had both died — James at the age of four in 1863 and Theodore at the age of eighteen in 1874. So Orris, as the oldest surviving son, had been in charge of the farm since the age of fifteen.

His decision to leave home must have been a difficult one for the family. Although Benjamin had died leaving the farm clear of encumbrance with a bank account of $293 and plenty of livestock and farm equipment, Orris would be leaving his sixteen-year-old brother, Charles, to run the farm with the help of twelve-year-old James. The two older sisters, Harriet, age 22, and James' twin sister, Mima, could help Amelia run the house and take care of the younger siblings, Mae age 9 and Robert age 6.

In accordance with the custom of the time Orris was in line to inherit the farm and spend the rest of his life as one of a long line of subsistence farmers. I believe Orris loved that life, since he returned to it every summer even after he had established a successful career as an education administrator, so he was not running away from it. He probably thought that he could provide for his present and future family better by getting an education.

Orris' Sister, Great Aunt Mary "Mae" Beverage Bemis.

His daughter, Olive, writing about this decision years later said, "One of the itinerant teachers recognized the sincerity of the boy and urged him to fit himself to go to college." This may have been the deciding factor for Orris, if so, this unknown teacher, like so many others in that profession, had a profound and lasting influence on Orris and his descendants.

Another factor in Orris' decision may have been family influence. His mother, Amelia, had taught school before she was married and his father had served as superintendent of the local school board and, beyond that, an unusual number of his extended family had served or were serving as teachers or school administrators. Following is a list of over forty relatives that I know of:

Name	Date born	Relation to Orris	Position
Albert Glover Beverage	1827	Uncle	Teacher
Albert Glover Beverage	1827	Uncle	Superintendent of school committee
Amelia Beverage	1833	Mother	Teacher
Asa Dyer	1811	Husband of great aunt	School agent
Benjamin Crabtree Beverage	1822	Father	Superintendent of school committee
Benjamin Kent Beverage	1779	Uncle	School Committeeman School agent
Cora E (Beverage) Whitman	1869	2nd cousin once removed	Teacher
Dana Hanson Beverage	1847	uncle	Teacher
Edgar Beverage	1845	2nd cousin	Teacher
Edith Etta Beverage	1900	1st cousin once removed	Teacher
Ellen Beverage	1833	1st cousin	Teacher
Eva Alice Grant	1876	2nd cousin	Teacher
Fannie C (Beverage) Robinson	1868	2nd cousin once removed	Teacher
Florence M Beverage	1883	1st cousin once removed	Teacher
Franklin Beverage	1859	1st cousin	Teacher
Fremont Beverage	1856	1st cousin	teacher
Harrison Beverage	1825	Uncle	Superintendent of school committee
Henry A Beverage	1803	1st cousin once removed	School agent
Henry Alexander	1777	Husband of aunt	School agent
Hiram P Stone	1861	Husband of 1st cousin	School superintendent
James Beverage	1789	grandfather	School Agent
James Douglas Beverage	1805	1st cousin once removed	School agent
Jemima Beverage	1866	sister	Teacher
Jennie Olkin Beverage	1890	1st cousin once removed	Teacher
John White Beverage	1774	uncle	School committee
Joseph B Beverage	1821	Great uncle	Superintendent of school committee
School agent			
Linda Ellen (Beverage) Carver	1888	1st cousin once removed	Teacher
Lucy Etta Beverage	1894	1st cousin	Teacher
Maria Kent	1827	2nd cousin once	Teacher
Mary Eliza (Crocker) Beverage	1833	Wife of second cousin	Teacher
Nathaniel Beverage	1805	Great uncle	School agent
Nathaniel Weston Beverage	1776	Great Uncle	School Committeeman School agent
Nettie Ellen Beverage	1894	1st cousin once removed	Teacher
Nellie Frances (Carver) Brown	1865	2nd cousin once removed	Teacher
Olive Loadbetter (Carver) Beverage	1829	Wife of uncle	Teacher
Olive M Stone?	1900	Stepdaughter of 1st cousin	Teacher
Orrie L. Beverage	1879	2nd cousin once removed	Teacher
Rose Marie (Beverage) Lane	1884	2nd cousin once removed	Teacher
Sarita M Beverage	1891	1st cousin once removed	Teacher
Thelma Miriam Beverage	1915	Grand niece	Teacher
Thomas Beverage	1750	grandfather	School committeeman
Thomas T Beverage	1838	2nd cousin once removed	Teacher

Whatever his reasons for entering the field of education, Orris was doing so at a very opportune time when the field was rapidly expanding and the demand for trained personnel was very high. The new railroads, mines and industries in the rest of the country created a demand not just for common labor, but for skilled workers, clerks, engineers, chemists, inventors, and managers.

Prior to this time public education in this country had consisted almost entirely of the so-called common schools similar to the one that Orris attended in North Haven. These were usually supported solely by the local community. These schools had been supplemented in Colonial days by private Latin Grammar Schools which prepared a small number of upper class students for college.

After independence there was a rise in the number of college preparatory private Academies which charged tuition and were usually sponsored by religious groups. The acceptance of and demand for publicly supported high schools coincided with the rise of the industrial revolution and began in Massachusetts where the first one was opened in Boston in 1821.

The most prominent personality behind this movement was Horace Mann who was Secretary of the Board of Education in Massachusetts from 1837 to 1848. He established the first public normal school for training teachers at Lexington in 1839 and, during his administration, fifty public high schools were established in the state. According to educational historian Lawrence Cremin:

Horace Mann felt that a common school would be the 'great equalizer.' Poverty would most assuredly disappear as a broadened popular intelligence tapped new treasures of natural and material wealth. He felt that through education crime would decline sharply as would a host of moral vices like violence and fraud. In sum, there was no end to the social good which might be derived from a common school. (Lawrence A. Cremin, The Republic and the School: Horace Mann On the Education of Free Men)

Maine followed close behind Massachusetts with a high school opened in Portland in 1821, the same year as Boston, and two in Augusta and in Brunswick in 1835, but it wasn't until about 1870 that the movement really got under way. This development conveniently coincided with the beginning of Orris's career in the field of education.

Maine's high rate of literacy and tradition of free universal education in the local common schools was a good foundation for filling this new demand. Colleges and technical institutions were being established. Public high schools such as the one established on North Haven in 1877 and reopened in 1887 prepared students to enter these institutions of advanced education. These in turn created a demand for trained and qualified teachers.

The Road to Colby

Orris may not have been aware of all these developments when he made a decision as a teenager to leave the Island for a higher education. He may not yet have decided on teaching as a career, but the time was ripe and this first step led, inevitably, to that result for himself as well as for many of his descendants. Seven of his eight children and eleven of his sixteen grandchildren followed him into that profession.

In September, 1879, Orris enrolled in a three-year college preparatory course at the Coburn Classical Institute in Waterville, Maine, which had been established in 1829 as a preparatory school for Colby University (as Colby College was called at the time). According to his daughter, Olive's, memoir Orris "had never been on the mainland; he had never seen a steam train; he did not know that Latin was a language." This was the beginning of a nine-year period of working and studying which culminated in a Bachelor of Arts degree from Colby University in July of 1887.

Coburn Classical Institute in Waterville, Maine. A college preparatory school attended by Orris 1879-1882.

Colby was founded in1816 as the Maine Literary and Theological Institution by Baptist missionaries to train men for the ministry. At the time Bowdoin College, founded in 1794, was the only other institute of higher learning in the district of Maine. When Maine became a State, in 1820, the Institution became non-denominational and was authorized to grant degrees. It was renamed Waterville College.

During the Civil War, the college became troubled financially and was rescued in 1864 by a substantial contribution from Gardiner Colby, a wealthy Boston merchant. In gratitude it was renamed Colby University and, in 1896, became Colby College.

A few other highlights of its history are of interest to me:

In 1822 Elijah Lovejoy graduated as valedictorian. He later became a celebrated martyr to emancipation and to freedom of the press;

In 1833 students at Colby formed the nation's first college-based anti-slavery society.

General Benjamin Butler graduated in 1838. During the Civil War he freed slaves escaping behind his lines, declaring them to be contraband of war, thus emancipating more slaves than did Lincoln with the Emancipation Proclamation.

In 1871 Colby became the first all-male college in New England to accept female students.

Orris had to earn enough money to support himself and pay for tuition, books and supplies. Teaching and fishing were his sources of income during this period. Enough records survive to give some idea of the busy schedule he must have maintained.

In November, 1880, he was certified to teach at his alma mater, North Haven district 5, and taught at least a term there. In December, 1881, he was certified and taught at Vinalhaven district 8. The following June (1882) he graduated from Coburn and then enrolled in the Rockland Business College where he took classes for two years and received a certificate in Accounting. Apparently he had not yet decided on education as his profession.

To help pay for Business College Orris taught at least two terms in 1882 and 1883 at the school in St. George, District 19, which was located in the village of Tenants Harbor. This was Orris's first teaching job on the mainland. I am guessing that it was quite a culture shock for him.

Tenants Harbor was a seaport, and I gather it lived up to the reputation that such towns had in the days of sailing ships. Many of the male inhabitants were sailors and others worked in the granite quarries which had recently started operation there. In his History of St. George, Albert Smalley quotes Obed Andrews who was born there in 1845 as saying, "I had an advantage of the other boys as my father was a school

teacher, big and strong and was often called to a school where the teacher had been thrown out the window."

Obed's tales about these early schools bear out the statements of many others that they were quite rugged. "In later years Orris's reputation included that of being a good disciplinarian. This may have been where he first honed that skill. This may also have been the first time Orris came in contact with people "from away," that is anyone who had not been born in Maine with parents also born in Maine. St. George had a sprinkling of immigrants from Scotland, Ireland, England and Canada.

His sojourn in Tenants Harbor was also significant to his future life, because that is almost certainly where he met his future wife, my grandmother, Rose Emma Pierson, who was born in that town in 1865 and would have been only fifteen or sixteen when he first taught there. She was probably one of his students. More about that later.

If Orris did, indeed, first meet Rose in Tenants Harbor in 1882 or 1883, the romance did not blossom immediately:

On Christmas Eve of 1883, when Orris was about to begin his second term of teaching there, he married Ella Mae Thompson of North Anson, Maine. She was five years older than he. The marriage took place in Boston. Three weeks later on January 14, 1884, Ella Mae died at Cape Elizabeth, just outside of Portland, Maine. That is about all I know of this short and tragic interlude in Orris's life. North Anson is about twenty miles northwest of Waterville, where Orris attended Coburn Classical Institute. It is possible that she also was a student there and that is where they met.

In June of that same year, 1884, Orris earned his certificate in accounting from the Rockland Business College and he began his studies at Colby University in Waterville the following fall. He also managed to find the time to teach two terms of school in St. George districts 5 and 6, which were nearer to Port Clyde than to Tenants Harbor where he had taught the year before.

The following winter of 1885 he taught another term back at district 5 in North Haven. The winter of 1885-6 found him teaching two terms at Jonesport, Maine, a coastal township including Beals and other islands about 100 miles further down east from North Haven. The social conditions there were probably similar to North Haven. The school board wrote a recommendation for him saying, "We consider him an excellent disciplinarian and a good teacher."

The following summer Orris shipped out as a crew member on a fishing schooner on a trip to the Gulf of St. Lawrence. He probably made considerably more money that way than by teaching. I have some cryptic notes about that trip in his handwriting:

In the summer of '86, while a senior at college, shipped on schooner with a Capt. who had been my schoolmate, and among the crew were boys whom I had taught the multiplication table in the country school. [I went because of] a desire to see the country of which I had heard so much from boyhood [and] the need of money. [In those days] crews were made up wholly, in many cases, of men and boys who had known each other for years, and who spent the summers on board some favorite schooner and the winter, swapping fish stories, over the nail kegs of the corner grocery. Now nearly all fishing vessels are manned [by crews] who have no families or friends [on board].

Whitefield

In the winter of 1886 Orris taught High School for the first time — a ten week term at the Free High School at King's Mills in Whitefield, Maine. The Whitefield high school was one of the older ones in the state having been established in 1866. Orris was paid $125 for the term. He boarded with the family of Francis Bailey a farmer who was paid $30. Francis' seventeen-year-old son Sidney was paid $5 to build the fires and ring the school bell.

In the winter of 1887 Orris taught a term at the school at Cooper's Mills in Whitefield for which he was paid $104.25. Presumably he had to build the fire himself, because no expense was recorded for this function. Carlton Dow was paid $12.90 for boarding him. That year the Town Report published a positive evaluation of Orris's work:

Mr. B. brought courage, energy and perseverance to his work, and succeeded in having a profitable school, and established good order, despite the many obstacles which arise in the path of a teacher in this district. We must credit him with a good education and good executive ability. Those who visited the school were pleased with its appearance. Why not engage Mr. B. for another winter?

A member of the school board wrote that he was

a person of sober life and conversation, sustaining a good moral character; and has taught with marked success one term of Free High School ... and also one term of Term School with equal success; and I can conscientiously recommend him as being worthy of the favorable regards of any one to whom he may apply for the position of instructor.

School House at Coopers Mills, Whitefield, Maine. The town established one of the State's earlier Free High Schools in 1866. Orris taught here in 1887.

Whitefield was located inland about thirty miles south of Waterville. The Sheepscot River runs through the town and supplies power to run a number of mills including a grist-mill, two saw-mills, two shingle-mills, a planing, a stave and carding-mill, two carriage factories, a furniture and boot and shoe factory. However, the 1880 census reported that a great majority of the 1,500 population were still farmers. Whitefield, like North Haven, had suffered a loss of population — down 20% from 1,883 in 1860.

Orris's sojourn in this town may have brought him in contact for the first time with non-Protestants. There was a sizable community in town of Irish immigrants. They supported St. Joseph's Convent and an orphanage established there in 1875 which served about seventy children. They also staged an annual Irish Picnic which was a popular social event for all.

According to Olive's memoir, "During the four years of his college course, Orris spent less than half of the time in residence at the college. He was earning money to pay his expenses by teaching district schools, a term here and a term there. This aided his finances, but seriously interfered with his prescribed college work."

Apparently Orris was not the only student at Colby who earned money for tuition and maintenance by teaching in local schools. According to the college catalogue special arrangements were made for teachers:

Students, upon application to the President, are permitted to be absent for the purpose of teaching during the second term (eight weeks) and, in consideration of the intellectual discipline thus gained, are credited with attendance as if in college. They are, however, required to make up the work gone over during their absence by their respective classes. For making up back work they have the time between the closing of their winter schools and the opening of the third college term (usually four weeks), and the long summer vacation. The concession granted by this arrangement is intended only for such as are compelled to resort to teaching from lack of funds, not for those who may teach during this session for any other cause.

[Catalogue of Colby University, 1886-7, p.24].

In Orris's time the academic year was a little different from what we are used to today: each of the four academic years was divided into three terms: in the year 1886-1887 (for example) the first term ran from Sept. 8 to Nov. 24, followed by a recess of 8 days; the second term ran from Dec. 1 to Jan. 26, followed by a winter vacation of 7 weeks; the third term ran from March 16 to July 6, followed by the summer vacation of 9 weeks.

On June 6, 1887, Orris graduated with a BA degree from Colby. There were 30 other men in his class and four women. It is hard for me to

imagine how he was able to do this while carrying such a heavy load of teaching. Also on January 1, 1885, he was initiated into Phi Delta Theta fraternity. The Maine Alpha chapter had just been chartered the previous spring.

In addition he apparently found time to hone his athletic skills. A program for the Colby Athletic Association 7th Annual Field Day in June 1885 records that he finished first in four of the five events which he entered: the bar vault (6'1"), 120 yard hurdles (16 4/5 sec.), running broad jump (15' 1"), 17 pound hammer throw (75' 9½") He set a meet record in the vault and hammer throw. The following year at the 8th Annual Field Day he won the same four contests bettering his record in two of them: the Bar Vault (6' 6"), and the Running Broad Jump (16' 1½").

Cover of Colby Annual Field Day program Jun 1885.

Colby Field Day Program showing Orris' performance in hurdles, high jump, vault, and broad jump, and hammer throw.

He was a member of the Young Men's Christian Association and was managing editor of the student newspaper, The Echo, which was published every other Friday and sold for 10 cents. According to his year book he weighed 175 pounds and was 5 feet 9 inches tall (As of this writing, I am exactly the same weight and height.). He wore a size 9 shoe. He was a Republican, against capital punishment, a Baptist who planned on going into the Ministry.

His nickname was "Bev" and he named his favorite study, Human Nature. His favorite pastime was "coasting" (sledding). His favorite game was tennis, best drink "H2O" and his opinion of the opposite sex "A conundrum." His favorite literary work was Life of Buddha and his favorite expression was "Blame it all!"

Graduating class of Colby University 1887. Orris Beverage is standing in rear wearing a derby.

Orris Lyford Beverage, Colby University graduation picture, 1887.

Marriage and Career

Grandmother Rose

Orris may have considered the opposite sex a "conundrum," but apparently one that he spent time trying to solve — or resolve. A month after graduating from Colby on July 11, 1887, he married my grandmother, Rose Emma Pierson, at her home in Tenants Harbor. If he first met Rose when he was teaching in that village in 1882 or 1883, this was a four or five year courtship carried out mostly by mail, since he had little time to visit her there once he left his last teaching job in the St. George area in November of 1884.

Grandmother Rose Emma Pierson.
An original tintype probably taken before her father died
December 02, 1870, when she was four years old.

Rose came from a seafaring family with a tragic history as a result of which she had few close relatives. When she was married she was twenty years old living at home with her 47-year-old widowed mother, Olive Hart Pierson, older brother, Fred, (22) and younger brother, Bert, (17). Rose's father, Captain Albion Pierson, was returning from a voyage when he died of apoplexy on Prentice Wharf, Boston, on December 2, 1870, at the age of 30. Rose was only four years old at the time. A younger brother, Albion Jr., was born a month before the death of his father and died at the age of four.

Jesse Hart 2nd (1817-1878) Grandfather of
Grandmother Rose Emma Pierson Beverage.

Grandmother Rose's father, Albion Pierson as a young man.

Great Grandfather Captain Albion Pierson just before his untimely death at the age of 30 in 1870.

Captain Albion was an only child. His father, Captain Josiah Pierson, was knocked overboard and drowned at sea at the age of 26 before he had a chance to produce any more children. Rose's mother, Olive, was the daughter of Roseanne Thompson Hart and Captain Jesse Hart, 2nd (the namesake of my son Jesse).

Fan advertising the millinery shop of Great Grandmother Olive Hart Pierson, widow of Capt Albion Pierson.

Olive was the oldest of six children, but only one sibling survived infancy: William Frederick Hart, Rose's only uncle. He married Sophronia Clark and they had only one child, Fannie Hart, who was Rose's only cousin. Rose's extended family was limited in size also because both her grandfathers married a first cousin: Jesse Hart, 2nd and Roseanne Thompson were first cousins and Josiah Pierson and Sarah Wall were first cousins.

When Captain Albion died he did not leave Olive and her children destitute. He had an unencumbered estate which included a house in town and part interest in three ships. Following is the inventory of his estate:

Inventory of the Estate of Albion Pierson late of St. George, deceased. Taken March 20th 1871 by S.H.Jackson, Robt. Lang & Geo. W. Rowley, appraisers.

Real Estate	
Homestead One and one half story dwelling house & ell	$1,200.00
Personal	
1/16 share Jesse Hart 2nd	700.00
1/32 share Louisa Bliss	700.00
1/32 share Lucy A Orcutt	187.50
1 Parlor set furniture	75.00
1 Dining Room "	40.00
1 Chamber set 30 / do 20	50.00
4 Beds & bedding $30 each	120.00
3 Bedsteads $4 each	12.00
1 Dining Room stove $10 1 cook do $30	40.00
Dinner & Tea Sets Crockery	25.00
Miscellaneous cooking including Kitchen materials	25.00
Silver plated ware	35.00
1 carpet $40. 1 do. $20 1do.$15	75.00
3 mirors	10.00
Sewing machine	35.00
Miscellaneous Library	20.00
Kitchen Furniture	20.00
Total personal	$2,169.50
Total	$3,369.50
Homestead	212.00
TOTAL	$3,581.50

Olive's father, Captain Jesse Hart, was still alive when her husband died and, presumably, was able to help out his daughter and grandchildren. By 1883 Olive had opened up her own millinery shop in Tenants Harbor. I suppose Rose was helping her out at the shop before she and Orris were married.

My grandmother was a talented and creative needle worker. She taught me a great deal about the craft when I was a child. Her family also had enough resources for Rose to learn to play the piano, which she continued to do throughout her life and was, I assume, the first teacher for three of her sons who became professional musicians.

I believe that Rose was happy to get away from Tenants Harbor and had little attachment to the few family members she left there with the possible exception of her mother Olive after whom she named her first born child. She also gave each of her six sons the middle name of Pierson, presumably in honor of her dead father. Aside from that there is no trace of Rose's heritage in my family tradition. Her brothers, Bert and Fred, both left Tenants Harbor and settled in Quincy, Massachusetts, where they ran a haberdashery store. Her mother joined them in that city and married her second husband, Reuben Clark. Rose had very little contact with them. According to my father her brothers had a problem with alcohol. I did not learn of their existence until I started working on family genealogy.

I sometimes wonder if Rose's relationship with the town of Tenants Harbor was affected by the sensational trial of her mother Olive's first cousin, Captain Nathan Foster Hart, Jr. In 1878 he was convicted of the murder of Sarah Meservey. Alvin R. Dunton wrote a book called *The True Story of the Hart-Meservey Murder Trial* in which he argued convincingly for Nathan's innocence, but Nathan was never exonerated and spent the rest of his life in the Thomaston jail where he died in 1883.

Whatever the reason, I am quite sure that Rose never returned to Tenants Harbor after her marriage, nor did any of her children go there during her lifetime as far as I know. Apparently, however, she was not forgotten: Sometime after her death — I believe around 1945 — my father became interested in family history and visited Tenants Harbor in search of information about his mother's roots there.

As he describes it, he was walking down the main street and got to talking to an old timer, who, upon hearing that my father was from North Haven, said, "Oh, yes, I remember one time a man from that town came over here and carried off one of our girls." (presumably Rose). It was on that trip that my father found stored in an attic a photograph of Rose's grandfather, Jesse Hart, 2nd, which is now hanging in my living room.

When Orris took his new wife home to North Haven in the summer of 1887, there had been some changes since he had left to further his

education eight years earlier: In 1882 his oldest sister, Hattie, married Daniel Green, and moved out of the farmhouse. Brother Charles married Annie Leadbetter in 1883, but they were still living at the farm. Sister Mima was engaged to Fred Carver, and the wedding took place that fall in November of 1887.

So by the fall of 1887 Amelia's household consisted of herself plus five adults (or near adults) all able to help with the farm: Charles and his wife, Annie; James (22), Mae (19), and Robert (15). There were no children to take care of and next-door for additional help lived Hattie and Daniel as well as Mima and Fred. Orris could feel comfortable that his mother and his siblings could carry on the farm without him and he could pursue his teaching carrier off Island.

Orris and Rose spent the first summer of their marriage on the island of Isleboro, a short sail from North Haven, where he served as a temporary minister in the local Baptist church. I don't know if he was still thinking of the ministry as a career, or if it was just an opportunity to earn some money.

Today Isleboro is, like North Haven, primarily a summer colony, but at that time it was a community of about 1,000 people having not yet made the transition from farming and fishing. Orris's great grandmother, Catherine Lassell Grant was from Isleboro. I don't know if this connection had anything to do with Orris's appointment there, or if he had any relatives remaining in the town of Isleboro.

Hallowell

The fall of 1887 found Orris and Rose in Hallowell, Maine, a town located on the Kennebec River about 30 miles south of Waterville and just south of the state capital, Augusta. At that time it had a population of about 3,100. Although it was quite far from the coast, the river was navigable that far up. Hallowell's economic life had been based on shipping and ship building. By 1887 the railroads had made that part of its economy less important and a large part of the population was engaged in local granite quarries and mills. They were mostly from Maine with parents from Maine; but there were some from other New England states; and a few from Ireland and Canada.

George J. Varney writing in A Gazetteer of the State of Maine had this to say about the city:

The attractiveness of this picturesque village is further enhanced by old apple orchards at various points and shade-trees along the streets. The streams are the Kennebec, which forms its eastern boundary, and Vaughn's Brook. This brook is notable for its cascades and its historic associations... . The power on this stream is now made useful in running a wire-factory, saw and other mills, near its junction with the Kennebec. The other manufactures are the Hallowell Cotton Manufacturing Company,

running 17,000 spindles; two oilcloth factories -Sampson's and Wilder's — employing respectively 55 and 30 men; a brass and iron foundry, and the Hallowell Granite Company, which produces about $350,000 worth of wrought stone-work annually ... The number of men employed is about 120, and the monthly pay-roll of the company is about $5,000. [$10 a week]

According to a local paper the city authorities of Hallowell "decided to establish a city high school and have offered the mastership to Mr. Beverage of the graduating class of Colby. They will probably employ an assistant teacher also." The High School was located at Warren and Central Streets.

Until this time the city had contracted with the Hallowell Classical and Scientific Academy, a private institution, to provide classes for the city's public school students. It is surprising to me that the city of Hallowell would choose a recent graduate such as Orris for such an important position. This may be a reflection of the lack of willing, more experienced candidates available at that time. Miss Grace M. Thomas was hired as Orris's assistant. In 1890 only the two of them were listed as staff at the school.

This building at Warren and Central Streets, in Hallowell, Maine, was originally built for the private Hallowell Academy in 1795. It was taken over by the city of Hallowell in 1887 for use as its first public high school. Orris was the first Principal and served from 1887 to 1890.

Orris and Rose moved into a house about five blocks from the school on Summer Street. That is where their first child, Olive Amelia, was born at home on March 29, 1890. Dr. James B. Nutting, who lived two blocks away, was in attendance. Olive was named after her two grandmothers, Olive Hart Pierson and Amelia Beverage. In addition to work as headmaster of the high school, Orris had also been studying for a Masters Degree from Colby University which he received in June of 1890. That spring also saw the end of his three year career at Hallowell.

Attleboro

Orris's next assignment was as principal of a new high school in Attleboro, Massachusetts. In May of 1890, Orris and Rose moved into their new home at 51 Bank Street a few blocks from the school which was at Bank and Peck Streets. Attleboro was the birthplace of Orris' great grandfather Eleazer Crabtree. I do not know if that had any thing to do with his moving there, nor if he still had relatives in that area.

In 1864 Attleboro had finally opened two new high schools 18 years after the town had voted to do so. The city of Attleboro was a long way from home. It is in south eastern Massachusetts near the Rhode Island boarder about 25 miles from Providence.

In 1890 Attleboro and North Attleboro combined had a population over 11,000 — four times the size of Hallowell. It was an industrial city. When Orris moved there it was on its way to becoming the costume jewelry capital of the world. There were about 40 jewelry manufacturers in the town at that time.

High School in Attleboro, Massachusetts, at Bank and Peck Street built in 1869. Orris was Principal from 1890 to 1894.

Most of the residents in the district where Orris settled were from Massachusetts or other New England states, but there was a substantial minority of immigrants from Canada, England, Ireland and Sweden. Most of the working population was employed in some part of the jewelry industry, many of them were women.

Within a year Orris's youngest brother, Win, had joined him there and was boarding down the street at 27 Bank Street with Mrs. Loessa Chandler. He was 19 at the time and had completed eighth grade at the Island school. Win apparently liked it there, because he never left. He worked at a number of jobs as a laborer, a lineman for the electric company, a motorman, and a foreman at the waterworks. In 1902 he married Grace Fowler. She also had an 8th grade education and was the daughter of Frank and Susan (Blackenton) Fowler of Attleboro. Frank was a carpenter. Win and Grace lived there in Attleboro until he died in 1944. There were no children from that marriage that I know of.

Orris had two assistants — double the number he had in Hallowell. They were Miss Jennie M. Perry and Miss Helen W. Metcalf, who was 25 years old at the time and lived a few blocks away from Orris and Rose at a house at 12 Manchester near Ellis Street where she boarded with her sister Eldora L. Metcalf. Eldora was a music teacher and that, I suppose, gave her something in common with Rose.

Helen and Eldora were both graduates of the Mount Holyoke Female Seminary in South Hadley, Massachusetts, the alma mater of Emily Dickinson. Their father was a baker who died in 1892. This was the beginning of a life-long relationship between Helen and Orris's family. Helen moved to Cambridge, Massachusetts in 1895 where her mother Eliza and her brother Louis later joined her. She ended up buying property on North Haven from Orris and building a summer cottage there.

While living in Attleboro, Orris and Rose developed another long-lasting friendship with Herman and Sarah Regnell who lived a few blocks from them at Holden Street on the corner of North Main. Herman was a partner in the jewelry manufacturing firm of Regnell, Bigney and Co. In 1900 Herman bought two acres of land from Orris on North Haven and built a summer house there.

Apparently there was no Baptist church in Attleboro while Orris lived there. His ecumenical approach to religion my have allowed him to attend services at the Episcopal All Saints Church, which was occupying temporary quarters at a hall in the Crandall Building at 40 North Main Street a few blocks from where he was living. In any case the Rector there, Isaac T. Bagnall, gave him a nice letter of recommendation when he left saying:

During the entire period of his connections with the school here progress was made in all departments of study, his discipline was excellent, his work

was full of enthusiasm & devotion to the welfare of his pupils, improvement in the school buildings were made thru him, he secured the lasting esteem of scholars, teachers & public. Mr. Beverage has the heart & mind of a true teacher, as well as a record of unbroken success ... . His influence is preeminently manful & true. Every pupil under him will have an example of strong & noble manhood.

Orris's social circle also probably included Joseph O. Tiffany, the Superintendent of School, who lived two blocks away at 16 Hope Street. Tiffany also supported Orris in a reference letter saying:

As a high school principal Mr. Beverage is sturdy and progressive. He is a superior disciplinarian and possesses much executive ability. Largely as the result of his push ... , laboratories have been fitted and equipped and the standard of instruction in the scientific department raised so as to command the respect of the public. The popularity of the school is shown by the large percent of the grammar school graduates who seek admission and the small number of scholars ... who fall out of the classes. My regret at the thought of losing him is a stronger assurance of my faith in him than I can well put into words.

Brattleboro

In October of 1894 Orris moved with Rose and Olive to Brattleboro, Vermont, where he had been appointed Principal of the High School at a higher salary than he had at Attleboro. A year later, on January 7, 1896, their second child, Helen, was born there.

Brattleboro at that time was a fast-growing industrial town of about 6,000 people. Apparently Orris earned his higher salary at Brattleboro; there is, however, evidence of controversy about his tenure there. He spent only two years at Brattleboro, and by the spring of his second year he was actively looking for employment elsewhere.

Up until his appointment at Attleboro, where he spent five years, he had moved to a different school every year or two, and that apparently was not unusual at that point in his career and at that time in history when teachers had no tenure, little training, poor pay, and were subject to the whims of district school boards. By the time he had finished his stint at Attleboro; however, Orris was experienced and well established in his profession and should have been able to settle down in a community as he later did in Boston.

This School House at 230 Main Street, Brattleboro, Vermont, was constructed in 1883 and served as the High School until 1951. Orris was Principal 1895-6.

Something must have happened in Brattleboro to cut short his tenure there. This is what I know: Mary Rogers Cabot in *Annals of Brattleboro* states that Hobart K. Wittaker was principal of Brattleboro High School from 1894 to 1905 and does not mention Orris at all. I asked John Carnahan of the Brattleboro Historical Society about this omission and he informed me that Mary Cabot had "a way of overlooking people and things she didn't like." He found an article in *The Brattleboro Phoenix* of June 27, 1909, which confirmed Orris's tenure as principal of the school, but somewhat mysteriously said "little need be said of his career except that the school was not in sympathy with him and he accomplished little." Apparently the anonymous reporter shared Cabot's prejudice. He said of Orris's predecessor, James Horne, that he "ruled with an iron hand, again bringing the school back to a state of rest and quietude by means of the stick. Mr. Horne was a very efficient leader and the school prospered under his three year rule."

This evaluation is contradicted by a reference letter solicited by Orris from his pastor, Rev. P. J. Perry, who wrote, "When he went first to Brattleboro he found the school in a somewhat chaotic condition, and has accomplished there what seemed to me a very desirable reform in methods."

I would guess that Orris's difficulty in Brattleboro had something to do with conflicting pedagogical theories. The Phoenix reporter may have been in sympathy with Cabot's ideas when he wrote approvingly of the long career of one of Orris's predecessors saying:

Mr. Bingham, although he would not now be reckoned a highly educated man or scholar, was a born teacher and had the rare gift of imparting knowledge. He was a strict disciplinarian and spared neither rod nor muscle in the reinforcement of the rules... . In these days, when moral suasion is in vogue, the older residents still like to look back at the good old-fashioned days of floggings and although many of them can recall very vividly the smarts and stings, they still hold to it that the old method of treatment was best. Certain it is that never since that time has the discipline of the school been better than in those days. During Mr. Bingham's career the school made great advances in size, equipment and teaching force.

Many of his letters of recommendation which Orris solicited and preserved mention that he was indeed an outstanding disciplinarian, but not of the Bingham school of thought. For instance F. W. Childs, Post Master of Windham County, Vermont, wrote to him after giving a lecture to some of Orris's pupils:

I want to say that I was very much pleased with the excellent deportment and good order which was so manifest showing unmistakably a commendable degree of discipline and most thorough instruction in those things which contribute to character building. I want to offer hearty

congratulations on the evident thoroughness of your system of instruction and to express the thanks of a citizen and a parent for your untiring efforts in behalf of our children.

Keeping order in the classroom was a matter of importance and concern, maybe more so in those days than today because many teachers had inadequate training and experience. I have found only one source which indicates Orris's approach to discipline, which seems to be what we might call "progressive" today. In a speech at Brattleboro he was reported as saying:

He then criticized the public schools in regard to discipline. 'When we punish to punish it is wrong, for discipline in schools should mean the advancement of self-control. Many of our young men and women are being ruined for life by being restrained and watched. You cannot watch them into strength of character, but you can trust them into it. [Applause].

This quote from Orris sounds very much like the philosophy of John Dewey, the father of Progressive Education. Dewey believed that a child's education could not be furthered by either reward or punishment — least of all corporal punishment. Rather, a teacher's job was to present information and opportunities to guide a child's natural curiosity and interests.

The debate between Dewey and his followers on the one hand and the advocates of more traditional, conservative approach to education on the other hand began in the 1880s and is still going on today although, by 1950 or so, most of Dewey's ideas had become part of main-stream thought and practice. Dewey was on the faculty of Teachers College of Columbia University from 1903 to 1930 and that institution as well as the experimental Horace Mann Elementary School associated with it became the leading proponent of Progressive Education. I attended the Horace Mann Elementary School from 1937 to 1942.

Apparently Orris's approach was appreciated by some. He kept a letter among his papers from a grateful mother saying, "It seems as though God has sent you to Brattleboro for [my son's] benefit for he has always wanted to go to college and I have always told him he should go, if my working night and day would help him. He has had so many tell him that he could go, but no one seemed to do anything or in any way show him how a poor boy could go, but you and how can I thank you? I can not find words to express feelings and I do feel so grateful to you for your kind talks and great help you have given my son. Every time he comes to see me he has so much to say to me about you."

The Brattleboro Phoenix carried frequent items about Orris's many civic activities during his stay in that city, but makes no mention of

any controversy involving him. This does not mean that none existed. The Phoenix was a bland weekly with no editorializing or investigative reporting. Following is a summary of the notices about Orris published in The Phoenix during his twenty months as a resident of Brattleboro. They give a picture of a busy, civic minded citizen:

-About 200 people attended the reception given by the students of the High school in honor of Principal and Mrs. Beverage Wednesday evening.

-The Baptist and Congregational churches will hold a union meeting at 7 o'clock Sunday evening in the Congregational church ... The boys' meeting will be conducted by Principal O. L. Beverage.

-Principal Beverage ... is arranging for a series of addresses to be given before the members of the High school and their friends by representatives of the colleges for which the High school prepares

-The members of the choir at the Baptist church are: ... alto ... Mrs. Beverage.

-At the YMCA Principal Beverage gave one of the finest talks heard, at the meeting last Sunday, especially for the boys' battalion the subject being 'The Manliness of Christ'.

-Principal Beverage of the Brattleboro High school preached at the Baptist church last Sunday morning and also led the evening meeting.

-The YMCA boy's battalion presented an exhibition drill at the armory. On the reviewing stand were: ex-governor Holbrook, ex-Governor Fuller, Gen. Webster, Cols. Austine, Hannon, Hooker, Taylor and Miles, Major Bush, Principal Beverage, Revs. C.O.Day, A.J.Hough, E.S. Morse, and Mrs. Cobb, President of the Daughters of the American Revolution.

-O. L. Beverage was one of three judges at an oratory contest for the junior class of the Hinsdale High School.

-At Memorial Day exercises Principal Beverage received the flag for the schools, expressing their thanks and speaking especially of the duty of teaching patriotism in the schools ... . Principal Beverage closed the exercises with an earnest speech, in which he referred to his deep interest in the celebration of Memorial Day and appealed for a spirit of honor and truth in all the relations of life.

-Mrs. O. L. Beverage and little daughter Olive left Saturday for North Haven, on the Maine coast, where they will spend the summer. Principal Beverage will join them there after the school year ends.

-Principal Beverage left Tuesday morning for his summer house on the Maine coast.

-Upon completion of the [High school graduation] program Principal Beverage presented the class to Hon. E.W.Stoddard of the school board, who, with words of congratulation and counsel, gave the diplomas which four years of hard toil had won.

-In an ad for Johnson's Universal Encyclopedia: Local inquiry may be made of Principal O. L. Beverage of the Brattleboro High school

-O. L. Beverage has been chosen chairman of the committee on educational work of the Brattleboro YMCA

-Principal Patterson of the Hinsdale High school is arranging for a series of lectures before his pupils, and has invited Rev. H.D.Maxwell and Principal Beverage to be two of the speakers.

-The regular monthly business meeting of the [YMCA] association will be held at 8 o'clock Monday evening ... . Principal Beverage will read a paper on 'What the community has a right to expect from the association.' These papers will be followed by an open parliament on, 'How may we help to improve the moral condition of Brattleboro.

-The November meeting of the teachers' association occurred Wednesday evening, at the home of Principal Beverage on Bullock Street, and was an exceedingly pleasant occasion, assuming, as it did, a social form rather than the literary form which is usual. Games added to the enjoyment of the guests, and the serving of choice refreshments was a feature of the evening's program, which was not altogether without interest.

-The next lecture of the Christian Endeavor course [in Newfane] will be given Wednesday evening by Principal Beverage of the Brattleboro High school.

-O. L. Beverage has been elected a director of the American Institute of Instruction.

-Principal O. L. Beverage will give two addresses at the teachers' institute to be held in Townshend on Wednesday. Feb. 12. In the afternoon he will speak on 'How to interest pupils in good literature' with special reference to the needs of the country school. In the evening the subject will be 'Education as a social problem'.

-Professor O. L. Beverage of Brattleboro gave the third number in the High School lecture course Friday evening. If this lecture course continues to give such good things to the audiences it will prove the best ever given in Hinsdale and far the most profitable to the hearers. Prof. Beverage took as his subject a summer's outing on board a fishing schooner.

-At the teacher's institute at Townshend, Mr. Beverage presented two papers, the one in the afternoon being upon literature.

-At the evening session [of the teachers' institute at Townsend] Mr. Beverage gave an excellent paper, followed by remarks by Prof. Chapin and Superintendent Stone.

-Mr. Beverage hopes to have speakers for the first hour every Monday morning.

-Principal Beverage gave a reception to the junior class Monday evening at his home. Games were played, refreshment of ice cream, cake and cocoa were served, and all had a pleasant time.

-Principal O. L. Beverage of the High school will give his personal recollections of 'A fishing trip on the Gulf of St. Lawrence' at Academy hall Tuesday evening, April 21. The great favor with which this lecture has been received in other places leads the West Brattleboro public to anticipate an unusually interesting evening's entertainment.

-Principal Beverage attended a meeting of the head masters at Northampton Saturday. Dinner was eaten and a meeting held in the afternoon. Professors were present from Amherst, Williams, Holyoke and Northampton colleges, who gave their ideas of college preparation and its present deficiencies.

-At commencement exercises for the graduating class Principal Beverage then introduced the speaker of the evening, President W.J.Tucker of Dartmouth College, whose theme was 'The value and the limit of the principle of utility in education'.

I was amused to read of Orris's speech about his experience on a fishing schooner in the Gulf of St. Lawrence. He apparently had developed this presentation into a set piece which he gave on several occasions. The reporter described it in some detail:

The subject was so new, so fresh, and so interestingly treated as to impress most vividly all who heard it. Prof. Beverage was a junior in Colby when the offer came to him to form one of the fishing crew, and he went partly for the outing and partly for the money to aid himself through the senior year. A drawing of the schooner on the blackboard gave a good idea of a fishing vessel and on such a one he left for the Gulf of St. Lawrence and the stretch of Prince Edward's Island coast between East and North East Capes.

The first ascent to the lookout, the first sight of a school of mackerel and the doubt whether it might mean thousands of barrels or only a pod, then the exciting race of many of the fleet of from 50 to 200 schooners always gathered on the fishing waters, then the taking to the dory and the casting of the 220 fathoms of seine as the boat made the circuit of the fleeing school, the drawing of the "purse string," and the work of all night, all day and until 5 o'clock the next morning to cure and pack the fish, until the exhaustion of the weeks of constant watching and excitement, of the tremendous strain of the race, and the unceasing exertion that followed, often made the strongest fall fainting in their places; all these were vividly described by one who told no fish stories, excepting true ones. The fact that those things are found in no books, but only on the lips of one who had lived the fisherman's life, made the talk most valuable.

I wonder if the description of this trip as "a summer outing" was Orris's term or that of the reporter. The implication of the term being

that Orris was, in a sense, "slumming" on an adventure rather than doing what he and his cohorts on the Island had to do to make a living.

Was Orris trying to distance himself from his origins? Or did the reporter make up the term to fit his own idea of the nature of the undertaking, not being able to reconcile the persona of "Principal Beverage" with that of an eighteen-year-old deckhand on a fishing schooner?

I am unclear about how often and under what circumstances Orris went off with the fishing fleet. My father suggested it might have been quite often when he wrote:

He used to go off to the Banks, fishing (Mother used to talk about that). One thing that I remember about that was her telling about going over and watching. There was a whole fleet of ships, I guess, that went off — to the east'ard — and she spoke of watching the ships go out and how unhappy she was about the fact that he was going "off to the Banks." I'm not sure I have an idea it was after they were married. I remember a story from somebody that the first time she came to the Island (to visit him) he joined up with a crew and took off for the Banks!

The report that Principal Beverage was leaving town for "his summer house on the Maine coast" raises a similar issue. Around 1880 the wealthy, patrician families of Boston had begun to build elaborate summer houses on the islands and coast of Maine, many of them on North Haven. These "cottages" were a far cry from the humble farm house that Orris called home. Was Orris trying to give the impression that he was one of these "rusticators," or was it the reporter who was unable or unwilling to make a distinction?

The real reason why Orris left Brattleboro may be lost to history. He may have been thinking of leaving less than half a year after he arrived: The Brattleboro Phoenix reported on March 29, 1895, "Principal Beverage spent most of his vacation in visiting schools in and around Boston."

By the spring of 1896 he was making applications for a new job. He applied, among others, for a position as principal at New Britain, Connecticut, and Providence, Rhode Island. *The Phoenix* tersely reported on June 26, 1896, "It has become known since the close of the public schools that Principal Beverage will not return to the High school next fall. It is understood that he was offered an excellent position with a publishing house several months ago."

Apparently either the publishing job did not materialize or it was never real and Orris merely floated it to diplomatically explain his departure. Had there really been a job offer, it probably was with Johnson's Universal Cyclopedia. Olive mentioned that Orris had, just after his marriage, "spent two summers on the road, representing a

publishing house, but the work had been unprofitable and he had given it up to spend all his vacation at his cottage at North Haven." While at Brattleboro he was listed in The Phoenix as an agent for Johnson's.

In any case, Orris was without a job and had a wife and two young daughters to support. He did, however, still have a home on North Haven where he spent the summer of 1896 as usual. But Orris and Rose and their two young daughters would not be staying at the farmhouse. Instead they lived in a small cabin called the Red Cottage which Orris had recently built on 8 acres of land purchased from his brother James in August of 1893.

Dorchester

September of 1896 found Orris and his family in a rented home at 23 Pratt Street in Allston, a suburb of Boston. On the 24th of that month he passed an exam and received a Certificate of Qualification to serve as "master or sub-master of a Grammar School, or Principal of an Evening Elementary School, or assistant of an Evening High School" in the Boston school system. Orris's first assignment was in Dorchester, another suburb of Boston, where he moved the following year to a house at 24 Nixon Street.

According to The Dorchester Historical Society:

At the end of the 19th century, Dorchester was described as follows: Its close proximity to the ocean, with refreshing breezes throughout the summer months, superb views from its elevated points of Boston Bay, and harbor of unrivaled beauty, combining the freedom and delights of the country with the advantages and privileges of the city, pure invigorating air, good drainage, — all these features are steadily drawing the most desirable class of home builders. Most of its territory is occupied by handsome and attractive private residences, with extensive grounds, beautiful lawns, and shade trees around them.

The present residents of Dorchester would not recognize their neighborhood in this description.

The Boston Public School system was the oldest in the country and many said it was the best. The Boston Latin School was founded in 1635 and was the first school to be supported by public funds. At the time Orris passed his exam the eliminatory schools were organized in nine Divisions each headed by a Chairman. Each Division contained eight or nine Districts headed by a Master. Some of the districts contained a single school building, but many of them had more than one building each of which was in charge of a Sub-Master or 1st Assistant.

Orris received two appointments: one was as Principal of the Mather Evening School in Lyceum Hall on Meeting House Hill in Dorchester, a grammar school for adults who had missed out on a primary school education. According to Olive:

Public evening schools were just being organized in the city ... Pupils did not flock there, eager for knowledge; they had to be solicited by advertising and by house to house canvassing. Both Mr. Beverage and his wife entered the game with the best of spirits and succeeded in recruiting enough pupils to warrant the organization of the school. His executive duties as master of the winning school in addition to his regular day school duties were, of course, an additional tax on his strength. Many a day he would return from school just in time for supper, eat it quickly, and throw himself at full length on the sofa in the living room. Within one minute he would be fast asleep. After a ten or fifteen minute nap he would wake up completely refreshed, and would set out on his two mile walk to the evening school.

Orris's other appointment was 1st Assistant at the Henry L. Pierce School at Washington Street on the corner of Welles Avenue, also in Dorchester. A year later he was promoted to Sub-Master in charge of grades VI and VII in the same district, but in a separate building at Thetford Street at the corner of Evans Street.

In 1897 Orris was 1st Assistant Head Master in this Boston Primary School in the Henry L Pierce district at Washington and Welles Avenue in Dorchester.

Primary School students in the Henry L Pierce District, Dorchester about 1901.

In 1903 he was transferred to the Roger Wolcott School District, as Sub-Master in charge of Grades VIII, VII, and VI, in a separate building called Tileston School at Norfolk Street near Fremont Street. For fourteen years he worked two jobs, daytime and evening until in September of 1912 he was finally appointed Master of the Mary Lyon District at Norfolk Street near Fremont Street in Mattapan, next door to Dorchester. At that point he quit his night job at Mather.

Olive wrote that this school:

... was near a business square that was developing rapidly. The population was steadily increasing, and the community was fast becoming a center. Residents began an agitation to have a new school district created and to have a new schoolhouse built to take the place of the old wooden one. As the campaign progressed, there was considerable excitement in the community, while quietly in his home the submaster discussed his chances. It all worked out as he had hoped. The new [Edmond P. Tileston] district was organized, the appropriation for the new building was passed, and he received the appointment as master of the district. [On October 14, 1914, Orris participated in the dedication ceremony of the new Edmond P. Tileston School Building.] That was the event of his career. He served in that position for ten years, slowly building up his school and making his influence felt in the whole community.

Tileston School on Norfolk Street, Mattapan, built in 1893. Orris was Sub-Master there from 1903 to 1914. At that time a new school was build and Orris became Head Master.

Edmond P Tileston School class of 1919. Orris Beverage is third row center.

This was a period of rapid growth for the city of Boston and for its Public School System. From 1896, when Orris began working there, until 1913, when he was appointed Master the number of elementary school, buildings increased from about 380 to over 470. The total number of teachers in the system almost doubled from more than 2,500 to about 5,000 so he was in the right place at the right time in terms of his career development.

Intemperate Language

Beyond his teaching duties, Orris found time to be an active member of the Dorchester Temple Baptist Church located at Washington Street and Welles Avenue, adjacent to the Henry L. Pierce School where he taught when he first arrived in Dorchester. He became a Deacon of the church and a member of the Prudential Committee, which was like the governing body of the church, and chairman of the Executive Committee.

After ten years of membership and service to the church, something went terribly wrong in his relationship with the minister and some members of the congregation — so wrong that he was expelled from the church in January of 1907. This was so unusual that it was the subject of seven long articles in *The Boston Daily Globe*. The charges, as outlined in the press, seem mild and hardly calling for such extreme measures. *The Globe* reported on January 15, 1907:

Mr. Beverage ... a year ago was chairman of the executive committee. It was about that time ... that certain members of the committee held a secret caucus, neglecting to invite the other members, among whom were Mr. Beverage. At that caucus several important matters were decided upon, one being the discharge of the church quartet. When this was learned, Mr. Beverage and other members of the committee who had been left out of the caucus made a vigorous protest, but the minister stood by the action of the committee. Thereafter the committee took a decided stand against Mr. Beverage.

It is alleged, at one meeting where he arose to speak, they would not listen to him. It is also alleged that the Sunday School class of 40, which Mr. Beverage had been in charge of, was taken out of his hands. The latter action aroused the indignation of Mr. Beverage and his friends and the battle was on.

Those who voted against the expulsion of Mr. Beverage are standing loyally by him.... They say Mr. Beverage has been one of the best friends the church ever had and that a year ago, as chairman of the executive committee, he raised the biggest part of the $1,000 which cleared the mortgage of the church.

Temple Baptist Church in Dorchester
Orris was expelled from the congregation in 1907 after having been chairman of it Executive Committee.

A meeting was called for the following day. *The Globe* reported on January 18:

The news of the trouble printed in Tuesday morning's Globe created a sensation in Dorchester and a much larger attendance of members was noticeable at last night's meeting than at the previous one.

That meeting was cut short and adjourned until the following week when three separate meetings were held to hear testimony and debate the charges. According to The Globe of January 26:

There were about 13 charges against Mr. Beverage in all, some of which were as follows. That Mr. Beverage had not done his duty as a deacon in refusing to serve communion, that he had on one occasion told the minister that he had forfeited his right to be his pastor, that Mr. Beverage had talked in the vestibule during service, and otherwise annoyed the minister; that he had refused to take communion from the minister.

On February 3 it was reported:

Deacon D. O. S. Lowell testified in support of two of the charges against Mr. Beverage. He alleged that Mr. Beverage had impeded the spiritual progress of the church, but that during the last year the church had come closer together, and its subscriptions had grown larger.

— a puzzling contradiction. Deacon Lowell testified further against Orris at the following meeting, which was reported on February 8, where further issues and conflicting testimony were raised:

A sensational bit of testimony was offered by Deacon A. H. Curtis. When called upon to sustain the charge that Mr. Beverage had used intemperate language without provocation, he testified that the latter had declared that there was an adulterer at the head of one of the Sunday school classes, in a conversation which took place after Mr. Beverage had been deprived of his class. When pressed by Lawyer Allen, witness admitted that the statement was true.

Deacon Curtis testified that Mr. Beverage had also used intemperate language in objecting to the method by which the church had replaced the salary of the pastor, which had been reduced. He testified that the church had voted to cut the salary of the pastor and the music appropriation in December, 1905, because of the poor financial situation of the church. Witness admitted that the pastor's salary was again raised and $150 was added to the original amount. This, he testified, was made possible by the subscriptions of 50 members of the church for the purpose. The pastor objected to this plan, witness testified, with the result that the money contributed was placed in the treasury and a meeting of the church was called to fix the salary.

In the end the vote was 131 for expulsion and 7 against. It seems to me that one must read between the lines to figure out what the real problem was between Orris and Rev. Tillman B. Johnson and his allies. My guess is that Orris found out something about what happened at that secret caucus and that the Reverend was taking defensive action against him. Orris probably could be stubborn and undiplomatic when it came to matters of principal important to him. This character trait may have had something to do with his sudden departure from the Brattleboro job ten years earlier.

One item in this story is of personal interest to me. I once asked my father whom he was named after. My assumption was that he was named after Abbott Lawrence Lowell, who had been President of Harvard University, but my father corrected me and said he was named after a deacon in the church his mother belonged to with whom she was friendly and whom she admired. I assume this was Daniel Ozro Smith Lowell, the deacon who testified at length against Orris when he was expelled from the church. This must have been a great shock and disappointment to Grandmother Rose and to Orris.

After his eviction from the Dorchester Temple Baptist Church Orris, joined a neighboring Baptist church without apparent incident or protest, but his loyalty to that denomination was shaken and, a few years later, he joined the Congregational Second Church of Dorchester where he was a member when he died in 1921. Three years after his expulsion when Rev. Johnson had been replaced by Rev. Edward Braislin, Orris wrote to his former congregation on May, 19, 1910, as follows:

Dear Brethren,

In the early part of the year 1907, after an ecclesiastical trial prolonged and painful to all concerned, you saw fit to withdraw from me the hand of fellowship and to erase my name from your roll of membership. A few months later a sister Baptist church presumably with your knowledge and approval, certainly without your protest, admitted me into its fellowship.

Of my life and conduct since that time I leave it to others to speak.

At the present time I am a member in "good and regular standing" in the church and in the denomination, but against the good name of myself and of my family your action of dismissal still stands and is the cause of much sorrow of heart and spiritual loss not only to us, but, as I firmly believe, to the churches most vitally interested.

In view of all this I am about to ask you to do what I have long been convinced would go far toward undoing the past and what would, if done, bring comfort and help to all concerned in the days to come.

My suggestion is this: that you pass such motions or resolutions as will restore me to full membership in your body.

In the quiet and peace or these later days, when surely we are all willing to seek and to follow the guidance of the Spirit of the Master, I am confident that this course will appeal to you as it does to me; Yours Sincerely

(Signed) Orris L. Beverage

The Congregational Second Church at Codman Square, Boston, Orris joined this congregation after he was kicked out of the Dorchester, Temple Baptist Church in 1907. He was still a member when he died in 1921.

It took them a while to respond but ten months later on February 24, 1911, the Prudential Committee passed a resolution restoring Orris to membership in the congregation, from which he then formally resigned. The committee cited, among other reasons for doing so that,

Our brother's wife and children have suffered with keenest sensitiveness from the stigma resting upon all of them because of the withdrawal by a Christian Church of the Hand of Fellowship, from the husband and father. We can but feel that so far as any brotherly act on our part can relieve from them this painful condition we should please our divine Master by performing it.

Making Ends Meet

When Orris started working in 1896 as an assistant and then as a sub-master in the Boston School System his salary was lower than it had been as Principal of the High School in Brattleboro and the needs of his family were increasing with two growing daughters.

He did not know it at the time but his family was about to become much larger as Rose gave birth to six sons in less than eleven years starting with a pre-Christmas present when Lyford Pierson was born on December 22, 1900. So Orris took on two jobs, but, in addition, soon found other ways to increase his income and decrease his expenditures.

Grandmother Rose in front of 24 Nixon Street, Dorchester.
Orris is on the porch. Probably about 1920.

Grandmother Rose at the piano in 24 Nixon Street.

Grandfather Orris ready for work in his Headmaster clothes.

A year after moving to Alston he moved into the two upper floors of the three story house at 24 Nixon Street in Dorchester to be nearer to the schools where he was working. According to Olive it was

... a comfortable flat in a two-family house. The owner [Allen McLeod] was a canny Scotchman who had built the house to suit himself. It was devoid of all architectural beauty except simplicity, but it was substantially built of the finest materials. Within a year the owner died and Mrs. [Louisa] McLeod [who was from Maine] sold it to her tenant [in April 1899] ... . A man of less foresight would have declined the proposal that he buy the house, arguing that he ought not to incur obligations which would actually burden him, but Mr. Beverage's sound common-sense commended the purchase as a sound investment.

The family now had additional income from rental of one floor. For several years they also had at least one boarder living in their unit downstairs.

Olive described Orris's second real estate investment:

In 1911 a one family house on his street was advertised for sale [16 Nixon Street]. He bought it and moved in just after his sixth son [Norwood] was born. Living upstairs in a two family house and bringing up eight children had begun to tell on the mother's nerves and to both of them a house by themselves seemed the best solution. But this meant now two houses to keep in repair and to improve.

The first house had no hard wood floors when Mr. Beverage bought it. He had deliberately set to work to lay them in all the rooms on ... two floors. Beautiful oak floors they were; some were laid with borders and plain centers, some were laid in patterns of squares. Carefully fitted they were, nailed, planed, sandpapered, and puttied, then varnished and shellacked. What a difference they made in that house and with what honest pride he exhibited them to friends and callers.

It was the work of several years, during which he had worked on one room or one hall at a time, rising early to work for half an hour before school or staying up late on Saturday night to finish a weekly stint. With the purchase of the second house he had to begin over again, laying several floors, and then painting the woodwork, and building fences to keep the children out of the neighbor's back yards.

Orris obviously derived pleasure from this work and took pride in restoring and maintaining his property. He passed this passion on to his sons and daughters including my father who, in turn, passed it on to me. I spent many happy hours working with my father maintaining the cottage and farmhouse in Maine and redecorating rented apartments in New York City. As an adult I bought and renovated three different houses in Brooklyn.

Olive said of her father:

All thru his life he enjoyed manual labor. When a boy he had learned how to handle tools. He never forgot what he learned then, and as the years went on, he seized every opportunity to learn more about carpentering and other trades. He watched and questioned workmen wherever he saw them, if he had the chance. In this way he stored up many a useful fact about this procedure or that process, and thru almost constant practice he developed an almost incredible facility in the use of his hands.

Finding ways to save money were as important to Orris as earning money — maybe more so. While some might say he was a cheapskate, I prefer to refer to him as being thrifty, an attitude I also inherited from him through my father. Olive described his approach as follows:

He did all the marketing, and he did much, if not all, of the shopping for the children's clothes and for household articles, showing a shrewd knowledge of materials and always buying economically. He avoided all shops and stores of inferior reputation or doubtful reliability, patronizing instead such stores as Macullar Parker or Shuman's. He bought his own clothes regularly when these stores held their annual clearance sales and so managed to dress himself well at an incredibly low price.

He had a passion for good shoes and never waited, either for himself or for the children, to buy shoes just before they were needed. Instead, he would buy several pairs of different sizes when he found good shoes reduced and lay in a supply at home.

The same with suits for the boys. A fine suit, but too large for the oldest boy now. It ought to be just right next winter; the boy will grow like a weed this summer. A few wash cotton suits on sale in January, a dozen Turkish towels, a new harness bought at an auction, a can of varnish or a new paint brush. Any or all of these he might carry home and deposit on the middle of the dining room table on a Saturday afternoon. The harness he had been looking for, for over a year, it was just what they needed for next summer ... The varnish was needed for the front hall floor and the stairs.

My father added some colorful details to this aspect of Orris's not always successful method of acquisition:

Father tried his best to get a horse that would suit all our needs. He was in cahoots with one of the coal companies in Boston, and we shipped down over the years two or three horses that turned out to have serious disabilities and had to be shot and buried. ... Father had a genius, you know, for getting stuff second-hand or at fire sales, or something; and all the iron-work for that cart that we used to have ... came off one of the coal carts from the Neponset Coal Company, and I'll never forget the time they came and dumped this incredible collection of wreckage in front of our house in Dorchester, and how embarrassed I was ... And he proceeded to dismantle the whole thing and shipped it down here [to North Haven] by freight: the

tires and the axle and all the ironwork that went into this cart that Al Whitmore made.

Al Whitmore made the cart: wheels and all. He was really quite a remarkable workman. The only trouble was, the darned cart was too heavy for Kit. Kit was a thoroughbred, or something, from one of the stables on Chestnut Hill; and that's where Father got the buggy, you know. But she wasn't up to it. Poor dear, she just wasn't up to it.

I remember, in Dorchester, one time when he was building that damn garage out back of the house, I had to go haul the bricks with one of these misbegotten animals (from the Neponset Coal Company) with a rickety cart and the horse, and I had to go up on Washington Street. And I'll never forget — it was paved with wooden blocks and it was slippery as heck, and it was after a rainfall and the poor horse could hardly stand up. And here I was, driving the animal with a load of bricks! Finally made it to the house somehow or other by the grace of God. Unloaded the bricks by hand — and then took the horse and wagon back.

With all the effort Orris spent making and saving money, he still managed to find time for some recreation. Olive wrote:

For a few years photography was his hobby. He fitted up a dark room on the third floor, and there he developed his plates and 'fixed' his prints while his daughter stood by his side and silently watched the dim outlines mysteriously appear. He bought a stereopticon lantern which he could use in school and learned how to make lantern slides, and gave his children and their friends illustrated lectures up in the big open chamber, where an old sheet was fastened to the wall for a curtain. Sets of slides on Greece or Rome or Alaska, borrowed for use in school, were taken home and shown to the children before being returned. Picture framing was another hobby. He bought the wood by the foot, bought great squares of glass and cut them up, and framed picture after picture to hang on the walls both at home and at school. But Mrs. Beverage discouraged this hobby, for her husband insisted upon working in the kitchen, which was littered from one end to the other with his materials and tools." Many years later my father set up a temporary dark room in our New York City apartment and introduced me to the mysteries of photography which he had learned from Orris.

In spending so much time talking about Orris's activities, I may be accused of ignoring or minimizing Rose's contribution to the family enterprise. Rose gave birth to six sons and was either pregnant or nursing or both during the more than twelve years beginning in the spring of 1900 when she conceived her oldest son, Lyford, to some time in 1912 when, at the age of 46, she weaned her youngest son, Norwood.

I remember what it was like to raise one son in the 1960s and it boggles my mind to imagine what it must have been like to raise six sons at the beginning of the century. True, Rose had the good sense to

give birth to two older daughters prior to embarking on her marathon of male births, and I assume they were of some help, but the responsibility and the major workload fell on Rose. There were three meals a day to be served for up to ten family members plus boarders and guests; weekly laundry and housecleaning; repair and alteration of clothing; plus the mothering and nursing of eight growing children who, I am sure, had frequent emotional and physical crises needing attention.

More Changes

The Rusticators

Orris and Rose were both raised, and indeed started their married life without amenities like running water, indoor plumbing, central heating, electricity and telephone. By the time they moved to Dorchester they had acquired these modern conveniences, which made everyday housekeeping and life a little easier, but this was for only nine months out of every twelve.

Every year of their married life they returned with the children to North Haven for the three months of summer vacation. During those three months of each year, Orris endeavored to live, or recreate, the lifestyle and values of his youth and to indoctrinate his children. Thomas Wolfe has made a strong argument that "you can't go home again," but Orris came close to accomplishing this. Important changes in Orris and in the society of North Haven occurred over time and to understand the dynamics of what came to be known on the Island as The Beverage Colony one must look at these changes.

In 1882 Tucker Daland and James Murray Howe purchased land on Kent Hill in the Village of North Haven from Amelia's cousin Andrew Kent and his partner Lewis MacDonald. This was the beginning of the "summer colony" on the Island. They called themselves the "Rusticators."

Daland and Howe had been introduced to the island by their friend William Weld and his brother Charles. William frequently cruised in Penobscot Bay from his home in Boston. He became familiar with North Haven and the Thoroughfare and introduced his friends to the Island through frequent cruises on board his yacht, the schooner Gitano.

The friends in his circle were for the most part children of Boston merchants who had made a fortune in clipper ships, railroads and manufacturing. They had in common great wealth which allowed them the option of not working for a living; a common educational and social background from New England prep schools and Harvard College; a love of sailing; and an aversion to the more staid and tradition-bound summer watering holes for Boston elites such as Bar Harbor and Newport.

Howe and Daland were both involved in land speculation and development in Boston. Their interest in North Haven was financial as well as social and recreational. They soon took in Francis Chandler, an architect as a third partner.

Their first building was The Paralyso, a clubhouse with rental rooms built on the waterfront in the village to accommodate visiting yacht parties. The name was a reference to the condition of the young visitors after consuming alcoholic beverages available at the club, but not elsewhere in a dry state which Maine was at that time. The second building was The Palace atop Kent Hill, a cottage for rental use.

North Haven appealed to this group. The thoroughfare offered a large body of protected water ideal for sailing and racing small boats. The Island was easily accessible from Boston by private yacht and by commercial steamship service. The overnight ferry from Boston to Bangor stopped at Rockland early in the morning and from there one could transfer to the Bar Harbor ferry which stopped at North Haven.

The Island's natural beauty was unspoiled by the industrialization which had by that time ravaged much of the New England countryside. The recent decline of the Island's farming and fishing economy had resulted in an exodus. Land and houses were for sale at reasonable prices. Furthermore, the remaining population was knowledgeable and skilled in the crafts and services required by the new arrivals.

Gradually the colony of Summer People, as they came to be called, grew. They married, had children, bought land and built houses. By 1900 there were18 new summer cottages on the Island; by 1910 the number had doubled to 36; in 1920 there were 50, and by the time I was born in 1930 there were at least 60.

Most of the Island Natives, as the year-round residents came to be called, belonged to families that had settled there after the Revolutionary War in the 1790s and thus had been there for four or five generations. They came from the same stock as the newly-arrived Rusticators, in fact if one looked back far enough there were common ancestors.

Aside from that, the two groups had little in common except for a loyalty to the Union, the Republican Party and free enterprise. A divergence of economic status, culture and lifestyle had grown with the passage of those few generations. They still spoke the same language and even shared a broad "a" and a tendency to substitute "h" for "r" at the end of a word, but there was no confusing a Boston accent with that of a "down east" native.

Both worshiped a Christian God, but the Natives were for the most part Baptist while the Summer People tended Episcopalian or Congregationalist. The Summer People were college educated; the Natives were products of the Island schools. The Natives ate dinner at noon; the Summer People ate dinner at night.

For many years the natives eschewed "Roosevelt Time" and stubbornly stuck to Eastern Standard Time while the Summer People ran on Daylight Savings Time. Most importantly, however, the Natives had to do for themselves and work for a living while the Summer People did not. The natives provided the labor and services; the Summer People paid for them. It was sort of like colonialism without racism.

Olive Stone Lermond told a story revealing of the relationship between the two groups:

Ed Mills had a nice fish market; I worked for him in 1904 and 1905. He had two men "fished out in the Bay": Jim Young and Bill Dyer, great-uncle of Herm and Hal Crockett. And so those two men supplied Mr. Mills most of the time with all the fish he needed. And the thing that could hardly be believed now those men received one and a half cents a pound for the catch: and sold to the natives for three cents a pound. I dressed hundreds of fish; when they were paid for I entered in the book "George F. Lewis, ten pounds of codfish, thirty cents."

And one interesting little thing: Mr. Mills charged the natives three cents a pound (a man took home a ten pound fish — he'd have a dinner and he could have fish hash for supper, thirty cents), but he charged the summer people five cents. And he was always sort of nervous that somebody would find out, and say, "Well, Mr. Mills, we understand that you are discriminating. You're selling fish for three cents, but you're charging me five!" And even at that, my guess was that if he charged them ten they'd still think it was a good price.

There was a symbiotic relationship between the two groups based on mutual acceptance, if not actual respect. Each group needed the other and each was quite certain of its own superiority. There was peaceful coexistence in the market place and in public areas, but absolutely no social mingling at the private and family level — at least not until quite recently when the line between the two groups has become slightly blurred with some Summer People becoming year-round residents and some Natives moving off-island at least for the winter months. There have even been a few cases of intermarriage.

A radical change in the economy and lifestyle of the North Haven community began about the time of the arrival of the first Summer People and the transformation continued for several decades. That the two trends coincided does not necessarily imply cause and effect.

North Haven was changing before the Summer People arrived and no doubt would have continued to do so without the new influx, although probably in a different way. Neighboring Vinalhaven took a slightly different route, although one might call it a detour, since the two communities are today quite similar: Vinalhaven had granite, which North Haven lacked and at the end of the nineteenth century, before the widespread use of reinforced concrete and steel for buildings, granite was in great demand.

The business of the Vinalhaven quarries boomed, especially on Hurricane Island, and many foreign craftsmen came to work there. A sharply different economy and lifestyle was the result. Indeed without the advent of the Rusticators, North Haven would have had a different future or possibly no future at all. Many island communities just ceased to exist during this period.

Significant Changes in North Haven 1889 to 1930

Year	1880	1900	1930
Number of people	755	553	476
Number of families	167	147	144
Average age	28	33	35
Number of houses	152	142	135
Number of fisherman	135	41	8
Number of farmers	85	32	18
Number of self employed	232	100	51

The Table of "Significant Changes" summarizes how the year-round population had by 1880 decreased to 755 from a high in 1860 of over 900 and continued to decline until it stabilized at around 400. The number of families also, of course, decreased but not as much, so the size of families decreased and the population aged from an average of 27.8 to 35. The number of independent farmers, fishermen and craftsmen dropped from 232 self-employed in 1880 to only 51 in 1930. Seasonal employment by summer people became the norm — working as caretakers, boatmen, laborers, construction workers, boat builders, store clerks, and housekeepers.

Caretaking of summer estates became the most sought after work for Island breadwinners. Winnie Ames described the job of her father, Zenas Burgess:

Papa said he started to work for Tucker Daland in nineteen hundred [Tucker had a house on the Vinalhaven side of the Thoroughfare], and Alice Lamson and Elliot Daland were the two children; and of course he had to look out for them. I think Alice, he said, was fourteen years old at that time, and I think Elliot was a little older. He had to look out for them because they liked to go 'round the water and 'round boats and everything, and they weren't old enough to look out for themselves, you know. That is, they wanted somebody older with them, and, 'course, he had to go ... come over to North Haven to get their order for their food. They would give their order, 'n' I guess that's what he had to do when he first got down there in the morning: go over to North Haven and get it (those things) and take 'em back — and then he used to have to go with the children. Of course in the spring he used to have to fix the boats. He'd have to scrape 'em and paint 'em and get 'em all ready to put overboard when they came in the spring, and all such work as that. And they had to mow lawns — though I don't think they did keep the lawns mowed down same's they do now. I don't know but they mowed 'em with a scythe or something like that, you know ... after they got up; but all that kind of work he had to do. He was the only one on the place, as far as I can remember. And then as the kids got any age on them they all wanted sailboats, 'n' like that; 'n' of course he used to take them out and teach 'em to sail. And there was a couple of years that, well, Tucker and his wife went abroad ... over to Europe or somewhere over around there. They rented the cottage to Saltonstall — Leverett's father, you know — and papa worked for 'em, just the same. He always said he taught Leverett Saltonstall to sail a boat. And ... he was kind of proud to think that after he got to be Senator Saltonstall — that he could say that he taught him all he knew about boats.

For about the first quarter century the Rusticator colony on North Haven remained a close-knit society of Bostonian Brahmins, but their hideaway was too good to be kept a secret, and eventually the social

fabric began to unravel. Thomas Lamont, a partner with J. P. Morgan, & Co., in New York City, was one of the first of the non-Bostonians.

Jetson Dyer, who was for a long time caretaker on the Lamont estate, told the following story which probably has some truth to it. He said he was in a Boston hotel and came upon Amy Peters, daughter of one of the original Rusticators, and she was crying. He asked her, "What is the matter? Can I do anything for you?" And she said, "No, no-one can, another one of our lovely Boston girls has married a New Yorker."

Jetson also claims to have overheard two men, talking about the New Yorkers: "What are we going to do? We can't let this go on. This is going to ruin North Haven." And the other man said, "Well, don't invite them to dinner, don't let them into the Casino and just let them understand that we don't want them."

Jetson commented, "Yes, there was much sentiment against their coming here. And they were perfectly aware of that, but they were big enough, mentally and intellectually to say, 'Well, this thing will pass away.' you know; and it did. And then, of course, Lamont was bringing in three eligible sons here, all of which were very well-off and that was an inducement (we won't go into that detail). But they were very nice people."

Actually Lewis Herzog had broken the barrier a few years before the Lamonts arrived. Herzog had a few other things going against him besides not being from Boston: he was Jewish, German and an artist — not necessarily in that order. But he established his family on the remote western end of the Island at Crabtree Point and, I gather, the family stayed pretty much to itself — at least in the early years.

Ethel Thornton Haskell, who worked for the Herzog's starting out as a kitchen girl, observed this about that family:

They'd come up from New York on the train: he'd have a special car bring him from New York to Rockland. He'd bring his help with him, you see. And then he'd come over on his own yacht. He very seldom ever used the steamboats around here. Walter Greenlaw was the Captain of the yacht, and he lived there all the year 'round, like we did. They didn't socialize at all with any others on the Island — just their own people, and his brother used to come 'n' his father 'n' mother used to come. I guess his aunt used to come over once in a while, too, from Isle au Haut. They went boating, and they had a tennis court down there. 'N' he had the two ridin' horses down there; he'd ride around (just on his place). He didn't go 'round the island much. I guess he thought the people didn't like him, and so he didn't bother. (They didn't like him — they wouldn't associate with him — 'cause he was Jew, you see: a German Jew). But he wasn't personally unlikable, no; I don't think so.

There was one notable exception to his isolation: Herzog was the first person to bring an automobile onto the island. Ethel explained,

of course he could only go on the Town roads — at certain times. When someone else wanted to go with a horse that might shy, you know, they'd let him know so he wouldn't. 'Cause I know that at Cyrus Carvers' they used to go downtown every Saturday afternoon shoppin', and their horse, of course, wasn't used to an automobile; and they'd have to call Herzog's and ask him — tell him that they wanted to go downtown, and that meant that Herzog had to stay home. If they wanted to go, he'd stay home.

Charles Dyer Norton, a vice president of First National Bank from New York City, led the invasion of the non-Bostonians. Jetson Dyer gave his impression of Norton's affect on the Pulpit Harbor community:

You know, there was quite a little Village at Pulpit Harbor at one time. You see, on the west side of the road from where the Nortons live now there were these little houses — just had house lots — along the road. And the Nortons bought house after house over there in that little community until they got 'em all. And then they began tearing 'em down, and they demolished all of them except the one that is there now which one of their relatives lives in. Mr. Norton demolished at least ten houses, and they were practically all of them along that road. Yes, this was a real, functioning community at the time — it was a going concern. I think it was fishermen, most of them that lived there. There was a school there, just back of the Corliss Lamont house there. They weren't just on the way out — no, not at all: they just liked the idea of the money offered. Of course, I think Mr. Norton wanted to eliminate them (I don't mean that in any vicious sense of the word); he wanted the territory and he didn't want the small houses there, and the noise and the activity. Yes, you might say they got, sort of, crowded out. It was gracefully done, but that's what it amounts to.

Norton was apparently trying to buffer his original investment and with that in mind invited his friend Thomas Lamont to visit the Island. A Belfast paper of 19 December, 1917, reported the results of that visit:

The announcement was made Wednesday of the biggest real estate deal in eastern Maine for some time, the transfer of the 100 acre farm of John H. Beverage at Pulpit Harbor, on the North Shore of North Haven, to Thomas W. Lamont of J. P. Morgan Co., New York. Mr. Lamont will improve the property and make it his summer home. The farm lands purchased by Mr. Lamont have been in the Beverage family since 1810, and although the price was not made public, it is understood to have brought a fancy figure.

John Beverage was First Cousin to Orris' father, Benjamin. Jetson Dyer chronicled Lamont's further acquisitions:

They bought John Beverage's farm first, and their total when they got through was about four hundred acres. They bought next Charles Dyer's place and then they bought Enie Piper's place and then they bought Charles Brown's place. And then they bought the place which belonged to Sanford Cooper. And then they bought the Waterman house. It belonged to Frank Waterman at the time they bought it and there used to be a store there which was run by Witherspoon. Well, the Lamonts came down the year after the War for the first time. And of course they had eight maids and Mr. Lamont's secretary when he was there, and Mrs. Lamont's secretary and Mrs. Lamont's maid.

Although they brought most of their staff with them, the Lamonts also provided employment for many Island people. My father, when he was a teenager, earned money for college by digging ditches on the Lamont estate. I think he told me that his pay was twenty five cents a day. In spite of Jetson's rather jaundiced view of these real estate predations, he had good things to say about Thomas Lamont:

He was a very kind man, and very sympathetic with people and had a great understanding of human nature. And Mrs. Lamont was a lady at all times — under all circumstances. And the entire time that I spent there I can honestly say that they never said an unkind word to me nor did they ever lift their voice, or was there any inflection in their voice that wasn't just fine. (I'm sure I didn't always please them, you know!) But, we got along very well.

Jetson's praise of the Lamont's "inflection" indicates to me that there may have been other "summer people" about whom he was not so approving.

Back at the Farm

The destinies of Benjamin's children and their families reflected what was happening to other Island families: some left in search of a better life away, some stayed and adapted as best they could to the new economy, some tried to continue the old ways of subsistence farming and fishing, but none succeeded in that for long. A picture of Amelia and her twelve oldest grandchildren posing in front of her farmhouse captures a moment at the beginning of this new era.

Great Grandmother Amelia Beverage with her grandchildren about 1901. rear l to r: Hazel Green (13), Vernon Beverage (10), Constance Carver (11), Amelia (68) holding Carl Beverage (5 months), Rose Carver (13), Maynard Bemis (6). Front row: Vernita Beverage (2), Ray Beverage (4), Helen Beveridge (5), Ralph Carver (6), Olive Beveridge (11) holding Lyford Beveridge (9 months)

For many years this picture sat in an album of old family pictures I inherited from my father. As it was unlabeled, I had no idea who the subjects were, so it meant little to me. Once I began research for this book, I found a slip of paper with names that seemed to match this picture and revealed what a historical treasure it was.

The picture was probably taken by Orris, since he was the photographer in the family and must have been taken in the summer judging by the clothing and the fact that three of Orris' children are in the picture and they only visited the Island in the summer. The year must have been 1901, since Carl, the infant in Amelia's arms was born that year in March and it was probably August, since Carl looks more like a five-month-old, than a three- or four-month-old child. Everyone is dressed up; Amelia has taken off her apron and put on a necklace, so it must have been a special occasion, maybe Orris' birthday which was August 11, or perhaps it was just Sunday dress.

Amelia, the matriarch, is holding her youngest grandchild firmly but gently in a relaxed manner that reflects a lot of practice handling infants. From the little I know about her, she impresses me as a serious woman, but I detect a slight upward turn of the corners of her mouth, maybe a smile of pride or, possibly, it is just that she has survived.

She is sixty eight — well past the national average life expectancy for women at that time which was fifty years. Her husband, Benjamin, had died twenty five years earlier when her youngest child, Robert, was only three years old. She had given birth to nine children. When this picture was taken, four of them had already died: the first James in 1863, age 4; Theodore in 1874, age 18; Mima in 1894, age 28; and Hattie just the year before the picture was taken at age 44.

The children, especially the older girls, appear surprisingly mature for their ages. It may be that children grew up faster back then, although they did not marry at a very early age. Most couples were in their mid to late twenties when they married. The average age at marriage of Amelia's grandchildren was twenty five.

Children then may just have been given more responsibility at an earlier age. That was certainly true of the Carver girls, Constance and Rose, who pose in pride of place on either side of their grandmother.

Their mother, Orris' sister Mima, had married Fred Carver. He was the son of Hanson Carver, a Civil War veteran who ran a prosperous farm adjacent to Benjamin's on property now owned by the Thomas Watson family.

Mima and Fred married in November of 1887 and moved to the Hanson Carver farm. Mima was 21, had graduated from high school, and was teaching school at the South East District 4 the year she married. Fred was a farmer and fisherman; he ran the weir located

between Hog Island and Oak Hill. They had three children: Rose, Constance and Ralph.

The Deacon Ira Carver family at their home on the North Shore circa 1890. The house was incorporated along with the barn into the summer estate of the Zimmerman family in the 1920s. Cousin Vernon Beverage was the caretaker. Later it was bought by Tom Watson and torn down. Ira Carver was the Uncle of Fred Carver, husband of Orris' sister Mima.

Mima died at the age of 28 shortly after giving birth to Ralph in 1894. Fred was left to raise the three children. He never remarried. Olive Stone Lermond, who was a little younger than Ralph remembered:

These girls were keeping house by themselves while their father was working. Fred told me he had to leave the little girls and go to work (I think he was building weirs then with his brother Ellie Carver) and he said how it worried him because they were little, and how he used to tell them, "Just don't touch fires, and just don't do anything like that when I'm gone." 'Course he had to trust them, because he didn't have anybody to leave them with. When you do have to put dependence on children (and he was the kind of man that I'm sure would be able to teach it and enforce it even if he weren't there) it wasn't by noise, or bluster — it was just because he was that kind of a person. He was such a very nice person. Quiet, but he could be funny, too.

Constance graduated from the Island high school. She never married and lived out her life on that farm next door to Benjamin's homestead. After her father died in 1939 she lived alone. In the 1940 census she reported an income of $229. I don't know how she supported herself.

Constance's older Sister, Rose, graduated from high school and went on to earn a BA from Colby College in 1911, following in the footsteps of her Uncle Orris. She was the only one of Amelia's grandchildren other than Orris' eight children, to earn a college degree. She married Harold Lee Tilley in 1914. He had graduated from Ricker's Classical Institute, a high school in Houlton, Maine; had trained as a surveyor; and owned a two hundred acre farm in Ashland, Aroostook County. That is where they settled and raised two children: Roger and Constance, who both, like their mother, graduated from Colby College.

Roger was in the Quartermaster Corps in Europe during World War II and later served in Naval Intelligence in Washington and the Philippines. In 1956, he was appointed to the State Department Foreign Service in Belgium. He was head of the procurement and processing division of the Library of Congress Law Library when he retired in 1973.

Constance, like her aunt and namesake never married. After graduating from Colby she did graduate work at Boston University. Her field was social work and her 30-year career was with the Washington, DC, Metropolitan Police Department. She was assigned to the Women's Bureau, and retired with the rank of lieutenant in 1973.

In this picture Ralph, the younger brother of Rose and Constance, is sitting in the front row next to his Cousin Helen. When his mother died a few months after he was born he was taken in and raised by Amelia. He was probably still living with her when this picture was taken.

When he was a teenager, he went back to live on the farm next door with his father and sister, Constance, to help on the farm. He served in the Army in WW I, after which he married Bernice Crockett of North Haven at the age of 28 in 1923.

Bernice was the daughter of an Island farming couple, John and Nellie (Witherspoon) Crockett. She graduated from high school, had two additional years of teacher training and taught at the school in the Thoroughfare for three years prior to her marriage. The couple settled in Plainfield, New Jersey where Ralph worked as a forester and landscaper for the Park Department and a private nursery. They had one son, Ralph, Jr. born in 1925.

Maynard Bemis is sitting slightly apart on the right side looking uncomfortable as though he wasn't quite sure he belonged there which is understandable since he was born and raised up north in the town of Kenduskeag, Penobscot County, and his visits to the Island to see his grandmother were probably few and far between so he is a relative stranger to his cousins.

His mother, Orris' sister Mae had married Lamont "Mont" Bemis in 1893 and moved off-Island. Mae was 24 years old at the time and had attended school only through eighth grade.

Mont was a farmer from Penobscot County with one year of high school. He and Mae were living there in Kenduskeag when their first child Maynard was born in December, 1894. Mae's sister, Mima, had been visiting them there and died in the same town after the birth of her son Ralph. Mae and Mont eventually settled in Staten Island, New York, where he founded a contracting business, specializing in brick and masonry work. He also worked for the Procter and Gamble soap works at Port Ivory and for W. O. Coburn as a carpenter and millwright. At the end of this period he again went into business for himself. Their son Maynard, the boy in the picture, graduated from Corinna Union Academy in Penobscot County. His career included positions as general superintendent of the Colgate-Palm Olive-Peet Company in Mexico City and superintendent of a Lever Bros. plant in Cambridge, Massachusetts.

Amelia's oldest grandchild, Hazel Green, is sitting stiffly on the far left wearing glasses and a stylish middy blouse. She was the adopted daughter of Orris' oldest sister, Hattie and her Husband, Daniel. She appears to be a little aloof or separate. One would think, given her seniority, she would be in a more central and inclusive pose. Her adoptive status may account for this anomaly.

Hazel's mother, Hattie, was the oldest surviving child when her father, Benjamin, died in 1875. She was nineteen at the time. She never went to high school, but stayed on the farm seven more years helping her mother run the farm and raise the younger children. In 1882 she married Daniel Green in a ceremony conducted by her Uncle Harrison, a

Justice of the Peace. Daniel was the son of a fisherman from Vinalhaven. His father was the master of a fishing vessel and his mother was a tailor.

Hattie and Daniel started their married life living in the farmhouse with Amelia and Hattie's six siblings. Three years later, in 1885, they had been able to buy 20 acres of the original farm from Hattie's family. On it they built the house located at the foot of Middle Road where it meets the North Shore Road.

The farm house at the head of Middle Road built by Daniel and Hattie Beverage Green, later bought by Hattie's brother Charles and his wife Annie Leadbetter Beverage. This is where their Son Vernon grew up.

Daniel farmed and also went scalloping with James F. Brown out of Marsh Cove where they had a little shack by Wharf Rock. The couple was childless and adopted Hazel who was born in Massachusetts in 1888. I don't know anything more about her or Harriet.

The census of 1900 shows Hazel living in Kenduskeag with Daniel who was working as a day laborer. Aunt Mae and Uncle Lemont Bemis were living in Kenduskeag at that time. I can find no further record of either Hattie or Hazel. I am assuming that Hattie died before then.

Daniel moved back to Vinalhaven and married Cora Smith in 1906. He lived there the rest of his life until he died in 1924.

Next to his Cousin Hazel is Vernon Beverage, the only child of Orris' brother, Charles, and his wife, Annie Leadbetter Beverage. Charles was 20 years old when he married 19-year-old Annie in 1883. Annie was an Island girl, the daughter of Xenophon and Rebecca Carver Leadbetter.

Xenophon was one of the more prosperous farmers on the Island. The marriage was just a year after sister Hattie married Daniel Green, so presumably there were two newlywed couples in the old farm house until the Greens moved out sometime in 1885. Later, when Hattie and Daniel moved away, Charles bought their house and moved his family there. By 1900 the young family owned the property free of mortgage. Charles lived there and farmed the land until his death in 1938. Annie continued to live there alone until her death in 1960.

Great Uncle Charles H. Beverage.

Great Aunt Annie Leadbetter Beverage about 1936
on one of her rare visits to the Point.

Their son Vernon finished high school and in 1915 married Nellie Ames, the daughter of a farmer from Kenduskeag. Nellie had two years of college and in 1914 she taught at the North Haven Center School — the old High School Building. She was boarding with uncle Fred Carver who lived down the road from Vernon who was still living with his parents. Vernon farmed his father's land and later rented a farm on the South Shore. He also worked as a Caretaker for the Zimmerman's (later the Watson estate) on the North Shore. For many years he was a town Selectman. Vernon was my boss one summer when I worked as a yardman on the Zimmerman's estate. For several summers I worked as a farm hand for Tonny Calderwood who, along with Vernon, was one of the last fulltime working farmers on the Island and, in that way, a competitor of Vernon's.

Tonny did not think much of Vernon as a farmer, saying he got so far behind that he was haying in the winter and cutting wood in the summer. Vernon was one of those who worked around the Island dry laws. This may have accounted for some of his problem.

Orris' three oldest children, all future college graduates, are in the picture. They would have been summering in the Red Cottage next door to the farm. Helen is front and center and Olive, looking very mature for her eleven years is off to the right holding her infant brother, Lyford, the future headmaster of Scarsdale High School — but more about them later.

In July of 1888 Orris and his other siblings had sold their interest in the remaining 160 acres of the family farm for $1,000 to their brother James. On Christmas day of 1895 James married his second cousin, Arleta "Lettie" Thayer. She and James were both Great Grandchild of Solomon Grant. Lettie's father, Dighton Thayer, was an Island fisherman. James and Lettie lived out their lives in the house that Benjamin had built. They farmed the land and raised eight children all of whom survived to adulthood. The oldest of their eight children are the three other children in the picture.

Ray completed high school and in 1916 married Leah Young when he was 20 and she was 18. Leah, also a high school graduate, was the daughter of Charles and Isadore Young of North Haven. Charles was a boatman.

Ray and Leah raised 4 children. In 1940 they owned their home valued at $2,500. Ray was one of the last farmers on the Island, but finally gave up shortly after the war. I remember him as running the freight operation for the North Haven Ferry. His Wife, Leah, told about what it was like trying to make a living as a farmer at the end of that era:

There was good years and there was bad years; Ray was a born-in-the-bone farmer. He loved farming, but I didn't care for it. So for years he worked at Hopkins' store. Every store had a span of horses that went out to

work, and after Waterman's went into business, why, he worked for them eight or nine years. Because then they had a team of horses, and groceries were delivered by horses, and there was the ice and coal to handle, but he always wanted to go farming.

So first he rented the Lewis place, next door to me — the barn and the field here, and the pasture — and he farmed that for a while. He had two or three cows and we had a milk customer or so. And then he branched out and rented the Waterman farm and we rented that all through the war years. Because during the war beef was what we called poor boloney — was graded as utility beef, and people were going out of cows around here, so one thing that we did would be to buy up two or three cattle and put 'em out and pasture 'em and fat 'em up; and then you could ship meat to Rockland — and he used to ship calves to Boston.

Because always North Haven calves went for a premium price in Boston; they was always graded as "North Haven veal," and it was extra fine. And they used to send them to Chapman and Adams in Faneuil Market; evidently Chapman and Adams catered to Maine customers, because on the island here everybody shipped their meat there. And we had a flock of sheep (we never went in for hens except a little small flock at home) and we always raised a good pig to eat on through the winter.

Well, in the beginning there wasn't any inspection, and then they begun. They begun to tighten up on the meat inspection. Where it was butchered you had to have a regular butcher — abattoir and everything and so we went out of business. We never had a meat inspector come, because we got out of it; we saw the writing on the wall, and got out of it. I don't know if the inspector ever came over.

Of course, we butchered at the Waterman farm and Tonny Calderwood butchered down at his barn, and you were not supposed to butcher unless you had running water, concrete floor, and so forth. And I guess Tonny still butchered a little; and then it come out — you couldn't butcher on the island at all: If you had an animal to kill you had to send it to the mainland.

That was up in the nineteen fifties; this all came in after the war. Why, if you even wanted to put off your roosters you had to have them killed at a certified butcher place; and that is why so many sheep disappeared off the island.

We got rid of our sheep; I guess Tonny kept a few for a while, but the big flocks went then. It was due to the meat inspection, because none of us had the facilities that they required.

Ray's sister Vernita finished three years of high school and married Walter Joyce in 1919 at the age of 20. Walter was a WW I veteran and worked as a laborer on the roads as did his father, Frank. They had two children: Virginia and Harold. Walter died at the age of 46 in 1939 and Vernita married Florent "Flo" Arey from Vinalhaven a year later. Vernita and Flo had no children. Flo worked as a laborer and cut wood for a

living. My father hired him on several occasions and called it "cheating," since he felt he should be cutting his own wood. In 1940 Flo owned a house worth $600. Vernita died when she was 56.

Carl (1901-1976), the infant in Amelia's arms, finished two years of high school and married Frances Young of Vinalhaven in 1925. The marriage was childless. Carl married, second, Alice Nutt of North Haven, the daughter of Samuel, a farmer, and Gertrude (Crabtree) Nutt. They had one daughter, Gertrude. Carl was a deacon in the Baptist Church. He worked as a laborer. In 1940 he paid $5 a month rent and earned $364.

Orris' Sister, Great Aunt Jemima "Mima" Beverage Carver.

Orris' Sister, Great Aunt Harriet Beverage Green.

The Beverage Colony

The Red Cottage

At about the same time that the Rusticators started buying property and building near the Village, Orris had begun his own modest little development project on the northeast end of the Island, but with a slightly different clientele. First he had bought eight acres from his brother James in 1893 and, two years later, finished building the Red Cottage. It had two rooms in about 200 square feet with an open porch along one side, a sleeping loft upstairs, a little wood-burning stove, and an outhouse. A few years later, when his family started to grow, he added 150 square feet in the form of two bedrooms in the rear.

The Red Cottage on The Hill built by Orris in 1895.
Picture taken about 1900.

In 1900 Orris sold off two acres on the shore to Herman and Sarah Regnell, his friends from Attleboro. Herman built a large cottage on this property. It was a clapboard house with a footprint of about 800 square feet, four bedrooms upstairs and a wide-open porch across the front with a beautiful view of the Bay and the islands.

Early members of The Colony on Wharf Rock, about 1895:
l to r Sophia Regnell (Herman's mother), Mrs. Regnell's sister,
Rose Beverage, Herman Regnell holding his Daughter Irma,
Herman's Wife Sarah, on the boat, the Olive A: Olive Beverage,
Herman's son Ralph, ?, Orris Beverage, Rev. Purvis.

We know the Regnells visited North Haven some time prior to this land purchase because we have this picture of them on Wharf Rock with Orris's family taken about 1895. While I am unsure where they stayed on their earlier visits, possibly at the farmhouse, I have trouble trying to picture that. Perhaps Herman built the cottage prior to 1900 before actually purchasing the land from Orris.

Herman Regnell was the first of five of Orris' friends who bought property in what came to be known as the Beverage Colony. Unlike all the later members of The Colony, Herman Regnell was neither a teacher nor a New Englander. He was a jeweler and a first-generation American whose mother was from Sweden and whose father was from Denmark.

He and his family were probably considerably better off financially than Orris. In this picture, the hats and dresses of the Regnell women — Herman's wife, sister in law and mother — contrast with the wardrobe of my grandmother, Rose, in this picture and of Amelia in the picture of her with her grandchildren.

Shortly after their new house was built, about 1905, a national recession occurred and Herman's firm went bankrupt. He took what assets he had left and immigrated to Hood River, Oregon, where he invested in an apple orchard. The crop failed leaving Herman destitute once again. Summers in Maine for the Regnell family had become impractical financially and geographically.

Cottage built for Herman and Sarah Regnell about 1903,
later used as a summer home by Orris and his family.
In 1925 it was bought by Aunt Helen Barclay.

By 1905 my Grandmother Rose was pregnant with my father, her fifth child, and the family had outgrown the little cottage on the hill, so Orris moved his family into the Regnell cottage. While I don't know what the financial arrangement was, a deed dated 1922 shows the property transferring from Herman and Sarah to my Aunt Helen Beveridge (later Barclay). Herman had apparently concealed his ownership of the cottage when he declared bankruptcy in 1905. Orris may have been paying him rent to help out during his financial difficulties.

By 1918 this little colony of schoolteachers and their families had grown to over thirty people plus occasional visitors and boarders who Orris and Rose took in for a little extra money. Although these colleagues of Orris's were "Summer People" they did not belong to the same social and economic circle as their counterparts on the rest of the Island. On a schoolteacher's salary, they could afford a summer vacation and a modest cottage on the Island, but they lacked the yachts, servants, estates, money, wardrobes, and — I suppose — the inclination to be a part of that other society. They were, however, a large enough group to form a critical mass of their own.

By preference and economic necessity, this was a do-it-yourself kind of lifestyle. A considerable amount of time was taken up with housekeeping and maintenance of buildings, boats, gardens and grounds. Recreation was boating, swimming, and picnicking — and reading. Some had hobbies. I remember Charles Gates building a rowboat with meticulous care summer after summer. Even if he never finished it, he certainly enjoyed doing it.

Members of The Colony in 1918.
Bottom Row: Philip Howe (10), Norwood Beverage (7), John Lathrop, Miner Patton (7), Bob (Carl) Patton (13), Douglas Gates (13), Allen Lathrop, Temple Patton (14), Betty Howe (6), Richard Patton (11)
Middle Group: Margaret Howe (9), Margaret Hicks (16), Dorothy Patton (17), Mrs. Thompson, Addie Carver, Miss Frances Patton (15), Priscilla Gates (12), Lind Lathrop, Alice Hicks (41), Ruth Howe (12), Margaret Stuppel (70), Helen Metcalf (68), Mary Gates (42), Miss Walsh, Mrs. Frances Patton (43)
Top Row: William T. Howe (15), Arnold Beverage (14), Jeannette Howe (41), Helen Patton (43), William W. Howe (48), Rose Beverage (52), Orris Beverage (58), Lowell Beverage (14), Everett Hicks, Lyford Beverage (17), Charles Gates (42).

Even within the boundaries of Benjamin's original farmstead, there was a social divide. Orris's brother, James, and his wife, Lettie, still lived in the farmhouse with what, by then, was a family of eight children; brother Charles lived with Annie and their son Vernon just down the road, and sister Mima's widower, uncle Fred Carver lived in the farm house next door across the brook with his daughter, Constance.

A subtle social distinction started to emerge. Elsie Carver Brown (Uncle Fred Carver's niece) remembered:

My mother [Alice Quinn Carver] used to do [Amelia's] washing when they come here summers. And they had the surrey with the fringe on top, and they used to bring the washing over in that, you know, and Helen [my Aunt] would be with them a lot o' times. Well, Elmer 'n' I would be out there, you know, and s'pose because my mother did their washing, well, we were kind o' beneath her, you know, and she wouldn't pay any attention to us. I never would forget that! And as we got older, you know, why — we was together all the time.

The social divide seems to have taken place by the time this picture was taken in 1918. Someone wrote on the back: "On Big Rock, all the Colony save Leonard Patton who took the picture and Albion and Eliot Beverage — 1918." Orris' siblings and their families who were still living on the farm are not included in "The Colony."

I can identify most of the people in this picture and know something about their destinies:

In the rear are William W. and Jeanette Howe. In 1913 they built a large shingle style cottage on a lot purchased from Orris. It was next to the Regnell house. William was, at that time, the Sub-Master and later Head Master of the Henry L. Pierce School where Orris had taught when he first moved to Dorchester. William and Jeanette had six children: William, Ruth, Philip, Margaret, Elizabeth, and Barbara. They are all in this picture, except for Barbara who was born in 1919 too late to be included.

Cottage built in 1913 for William W. Howe, Head Master of the Henry L. Pierce School where Orris had taught. It stands next to the Regnell Cottage in The Colony.

In the rear on the left is their fifteen-year-old son, William T. Howe, who graduated from college, married Hazel, also a college graduate, and served as Pastor of The Broadway Winter Hill Congregational Church in Somerville, Massachusetts from 1937 to 1973. He later bought the North Haven property from his father and left it to his three children, Richard, Marjorie and Allan when he died in 1991.

Leonard Patton took the picture and his wife, Helen, is standing in the back row. In 1916 Leonard built a cottage adjacent to the Howe place on land he purchased from Orris's brother, James. Patton, a graduate of Brown University, was sub-master, later Master of the Edward Everett District in Dorchester. He and his wife, Helen, who was also a college graduate, had three children: Dorothy, Temple, and Minor who are all in this picture.

Cottage built for Leonard and Helen Patton about 1916.

Cottage built for Charles and Mary Gates about 1916.

Dorothy graduated from Pembroke in 1923 and married Edson Lockwood, a Brown graduate, who was commissioned as a missionary at the First Church of Christ, New Britain, Connecticut. He served for many years in India and Ceylon and was on the faculty of Jaffna College, India.

Temple graduated from MIT; he married Helen, also a college graduate. He taught at MIT and later at Worcester Academy in Massachusetts.

Minor was class of 1932 Brown. He married Constance Candee, also a college graduate, and taught public school in Belmont, Massachusetts. During WW II he was a Lieutenant in the Navy and served as an Anti-Submarine Warfare Officer.

Leonard Patton's brother, Carlton, and wife sometimes shared the cottage with him. Carlton was a Brown graduate and taught public school in Brooklyn, New York. Frances was a normal school graduate and a teacher. They are in the picture along with three of their four children: Carl, Dick and Frances.

Carl graduated from Brown and became a salesman. He married Claranell from Alabama who had a high school education and they moved to Texas.

Robert, who is not in the picture, was about twelve at the time. He graduated from high school, but did not go to college. He apparently did not marry. He had a career as a musician on passenger ships and traveled widely including to Chile, Bermuda, Hamburg, Trinidad, Bahamas, Cuba, Mexico, Jamaica, Panama and Brazil. He later worked as a commercial artist.

In the rear on the right is Charles I. Gates. In 1916 he purchased a shorefront lot from James Beverage adjacent to the Patton cottage and built a shingle-style cottage, similar to the one built by William Howe. Charles was born in Hopkinton, Rhode Island, the youngest of six children born to Israel and Phoebe Gates. Israel was working in a cotton mill at the time. Charles and his wife, Mary Randall Gates, were both college graduates. Charles went to Brown. He was a sub-master at the Edward Everett District in Dorchester. His daughter, Priscilla, was about the same age as my father and I have been told that there was some romantic interest between them as teenagers, but I don't know anything more about that.

Priscilla married Kenneth Hinds, a Columbia Graduate, who became an investment analyst and worked for Standard and Poor's — one of the few non-academics in The Colony. Priscilla's older brother, Douglas, graduated from Brown and worked as an illustrator. He died in 1929 of tuberculosis. He was only 25 years old.

In 1917 Orris sold a small lot on the hill behind the Red Cottage to Helen Metcalf, who had been his assistant at the Attleboro High School

back in 1890. She built a cottage there, which was later bought by my Aunt Olive. Helen was 67 at the time she bought the property, but not yet retired. She was living in Arlington, and teaching at Rindge Manual Training School, a public school in Cambridge.

Cottage built for Helen Metcalf about 1917, bought by Olive Beveridge and Florence Budlong in 1926.

Helen grew up in the town of Franklin, Massachusetts, where her father had moved shortly after she was born. The town, at that time, was known as a center for the manufacture of straw hats. In 1869 the town of Franklin produced 1,500,000 hats worth $1,000,000. Helen's father was one of many hat-makers in town and she worked for him sewing straw until she went to school.

From 1869 to 1873 she attended Mount Holyoke Female Seminary which, at that time, offered a four-year teacher training course. In 1888 it obtained collegiate status and was named Mount Holyoke Seminary and College. In 1893, the seminary curriculum was phased out and the institution was formally named Mount Holyoke College, taking its place as one of the prestigious seven sister colleges for women in the North East. From its founding by Mary Lyons in 1837 "It instituted rigorous academic entrance requirements and a demanding curriculum conspicuously free of instruction of domestic pursuits."

Of historical interest, this picture of The Colony was taken in the summer of 1918, two or three months before the end of World War I, on November 11 of that year. Apparently the war had not interfered with the summer holidays of the members of The Colony. As far as I can tell none served in the war. Those in Orris' generation were too old and those in my father's generation were all too young.

Beverage Colony northeastern North Haven.

Orris was the link between the two social groups. His restless nature kept him always busy with various enterprises which involved not only his children and wife, but his relatives on the Island, particularly brother James. This probably involved no actual exchange of cash; perhaps all was by barter and exchange of services.

For one thing the Colony Orris had created provided a ready-made captive mini-market for James's dairy and other farm products. Orris had his own cow, which James kept over the winter, and Orris and his children, in return, helped James with the haying.

James had several horses which Orris and his family were free to use pretty much as needed. In return, Orris's cart and carriage were available for James to use. Orris used James' plow and harrow. Other tools and equipment were traded back and forth.

Orris always had a vegetable garden; he planted a large orchard — many of the trees are still producing. For several years he grew and sold strawberries — a first on the Island — an enterprise which involved the whole family as pickers during the season.

James had a dory which he and Orris used for fishing and lobstering. Around 1890, Orris bought a little sloop called the Olive A, said to have been built by James F. Brown. It was named after his first daughter and he used it for excursions and fetching goods from the village and from Camden. Later he sold it and had a twenty-six foot open-motor launch built to his specifications. The boards from which it was made were milled at Cyrus Carver's sawmill from logs cut by Orris in his cedar swamp. Orris also had a rowboat from which he hauled lobster traps that he had made himself including the knitted heads and the buoys.

For Orris, summer vacation was a time to get back to his roots, but also to improve his family's financial position by continuing to find ways to make money and to save money and in the process to acquire discipline and knowledge. My father's description of the family enterprise during that time is colorful and gives a much better picture than I can recreate:

We always had a cow when we came in the summer, and our cow was put to pasture in Uncle Jim's pasture. And the cows usually came along back to the barn at milking time by themselves, but on stormy nights they invariably stayed out in the woods and we had to go find them and drive them home. Their favorite hiding place was over in the swamp by Uncle Fred's line, and many's the time I've had to find my way over there in the dark and the rain to bring them back. There was a woods road, or cow-path, through the swamp — though it's hard to tell now where it went — and I don't know whether it was established by long tradition or if somebody just cut the alders, or what. But there wasn't any problem of how to get through

there; it was fairly clearly marked, one way or another. And there was no difficulty under foot. I think we most always went barefoot.

We used to farm the animals out in the winter. We had the horse and the cow, and quite often Father would pick up some other animals — pigs and chickens — and he'd feed them all summer and have them slaughtered in the fall. We had a cow named Clarissa for at least five years. One winter she was left with Owen Grant down by the Morrow place [about four miles away], and I remember when we got back here in the spring, Mother said, "Well, you'd better go get Clarissa." So I walked down to Owen Grant's and led the cow home. That was a day's work! "Led" isn't the right word. She was pretty obstinate — had to keep pulling — pulled her all the way home by main strength!

We had to provide the winter's hay for the cow. My earliest recollection was, we hayed the Cyrus Carver place — hayed it on shares, and I remember going down there with Father and working with that crew. We had our own hayrack and our own horse. And we'd go down there day after day and I got seventy-five cents a day for helping with the hay.

I think Father paid me, but at least we got one decent meal in the middle of the day. And I'll never forget that dining-room table with — gosh — ten or fifteen people 'round it, and about fifteen courses.

Gosh! The family, hired men, everybody. He had hired men, sure, because that was a big enterprise. That was one of the biggest farms on the Island. But the other place that we hayed quite regularly was the Webster place; we did that two or three years.

I remember Father and I doing that all alone. And I can remember one or two famous occasions when I was leading the horse and nearly tipped the whole thing over because I cut the hayrack too sharp. I can never forget the look on Father's face when he came dashing over just in time to keep the whole business from upsetting. I couldn't have been more than twelve years old.

And I'll always remember the lunches we used to have consisted of a loaf of bread and a salt cod and a bottle of milk. Very refreshing!

The hay was for our own use. Possibly some was for the people who kept the animals over the winter, as a reserve, but we always gave the animals hay morning and night, and some would be used for bedding. But after all, we were here for more than four months, and there wasn't a great deal of pasturage over there.

We made quite constant use of the horse, and there wasn't any time for the horse to be out to pasture. In fact, there wasn't any fenced pasture, and I don't think we ever tied the horse outside. The horse was always busy. The horse was always working. Poor horse! Oh — It was wicked!

Well, we used the horse cultivating, haying, and hauling lumber, chiefly. No, we weren't out on the road a great deal, although of course we

had the carriage and the buggy and the cart. We used to go to town once in a while, but mostly by boat.

Father, I think, was something of a pioneer on the Island in raising strawberries, and that was the reason he was able to sell so many at the store. We had at least an acre, I'd say, or two of strawberries and the whole family got into this act. It over-shadowed our lives — still does! Father planted a hundred fruit trees as well as the strawberries. We'd start pretty early in the morning — soon as it was light. And I remember the record picked for one day was eight crates — two hundred quarts! So there were a few berries over there. We just picked right along, all through the day (when they were at their height) and took them down to the store when we could. And we used to sell some to the summer people, and even the people in the colony bought some.

Well, of course everybody grew oats at that time — even we did. I can remember planting a whole acre of oats up there where that birch forest is now! Sure, we planted oats every year: partly to use for bedding and partly for feed. Yes, the garden was all for family use. Oh, we may have sold a few peas or beans: I doubt it. One summer Arnold and I raised a so-called Victory Garden there; and I think we may have sold vegetables, 'cause a lot of the colony here was in the market to buy stuff.

The thing that Father sold in Boston was lobsters. All I remember is that he'd put together a barrel of lobsters and send them to Boston on the Boston Boat. But I remember his telling about the canning enterprise down in the Village, and he sold lobsters for one cent apiece. I s'pose he took them down in the boat, or maybe he carted them down there. But that apparently was a flourishing industry. He lobstered by rowing, I suppose, and I've heard it said you could even pick up lobsters on the beach.

Sheep were a big factor in the Island economy. People ate lamb and mutton, the wool was sold, and we've always heard about the excellent market for North Haven Lamb shipped to Boston. I wonder how many Uncle Jim had at one time. I know he had at least a hundred and fifty, but it may have been even more than that. The sheep pasture — their range — was the important feature here, and yet this is pretty vague in my mind — and theirs too, I guess. Because sheep are hard to keep in one place, I really don't know how the fencing was maintained. But, no matter how good the fence was, my gosh — the sheep could jump over it. A lot of it was stonewall with a rail along the top, and my gosh, you know, when you get these big junipers growing up they grow over the fence! There's no way of building a fence that will hold them.

Uncle Jim's sheep ranged all over this end of the island. The reason they were over in the Mullin Place was that you couldn't keep them from going there! Well, who cared? Nobody really cared much: there wasn't anybody around who cared anything about the Mullin place, or even further — and even over to Uncle Fred's.

And nobody really cared much, because the sheep were all marked. They either clipped their ears and their tail, or painted them. Nobody cared where the sheep went 'cause when it came shearing time everybody trusted everybody else, and they'd sort them out and you'd get your own sheep back. So it didn't make any difference where they grazed.

My recollection is that Uncle Jim's sheep had the full run of the Banks place and the Mullin place. I guess they must have rounded them up in the wintertime. I'm sure they must have: put them in the barn for the spring, for lambing time. The only other time there was any concern was when it came time to shear them — which was where we came in: chasing sheep. Uncle Jim's kids and we all — quite a lark — and Uncle Jim would lead the chase; and 'course Ray was always a very competent person, and he was — early in the game that I can remember — more in charge than Uncle Jim, 'cause I don't think Uncle Jim was well. Generally we'd — well, there was a minimum of strategy, when we'd be told not to do certain things; and when one sheep or a few sheep tried to backtrack or break through the net we were to do a good lot of yelling and go chase them. And of course we'd go lickety-split trying to outrun the sheep through the junipers. Aside from that there'd be a line of us, sort of beating the bushes — like a net, over through the woods; because after all, there weren't that many trees and bushes at that time.

My God! — when I think of the stuff he shipped back to Boston: barrel after barrel of potatoes and canned raspberries and canned strawberries in these barrels. Well, I think there'd be eight or ten barrels of stuff, maybe more, down cellar in the storage room in Nixon Street. And Mother always kept a barrel of flour and a barrel of sugar — both down here and in Dorchester. Yes, she'd leave it over the winter.

How many pounds of sugar are there in a barrel of sugar? About three hundred and fifty: three hundred and fifty pounds in a barrel of sugar. They were enormous; you couldn't lift them. And a barrel of flour would weigh two hundred pounds; I know, because I carried one upstairs in Dorchester once. I can remember some of the preserves spoiling — blowing up — down in the cellar. I think it was only the peas we had bad luck with. That didn't work at all — canning with a wood fire. I don't know how you'd ever get it hot enough canning with a wood fire, in summertime.

The raspberries spoiled sometimes, too (wild raspberries, yes). Well, Father had a large patch of cultivated raspberries, and black raspberries, but I think he only sold them. I don't think we ever kept them: I think we always sold them, 'cause they were sort of special. (I wouldn't give you two cents for them though, compared to the wild raspberry.) We used to go over to the Mullin Place. There'd be six or eight picking, and we'd get over there (and back) in the motorboat. We'd have two or three pails full, at least. I don't know that we went raspberrying anywhere else, though of course Big Hill was always a pretty good place — and Wharf Rock. And then we'd go

up to Cape Rosier for blueberries. It was kind of a community enterprise: there'd be several boatloads of people that'd go up and spend the day picking blueberries.

Mother made a lot of cottage cheese; I don't know whether Aunt Lettie did or not. When we were here in the spring with this Holstein cow which gave us an incredible amount of milk — thirty or forty quarts a day — just that one animal! You just took a scallop shell and skimmed the cream off the top, and that's what you used!

Well, Mother made a lot of cottage cheese, and she made Indian pudding and did all kinds of custards. But time and time again she'd have to throw it away, because what else could you do with it when it got sour?

And even my sweet wife had a hard time curing me (some people never get cured) of smelling the milk before you drink it! Well, could you blame us? You'd think you'd get used to it after a while. Some people like buttermilk, but sour milk somehow was just unpalatable: I don't know why. I could never quite become reconciled to it. And it was always just at that turning point — was it or wasn't it?

Father and Uncle Jim were very close, and I have a nostalgic recollection of our two families sort of growing up together here, and of our being on an equal basis. In and out of the house at all times, and before we had our own animals (before the barn was built over there) we were very dependent upon Uncle Jim for milk and eggs, and stuff like that. We kids were always playing together. I don't know whether it was just milking time, or what, but we'd help to round up the cows and stand around in the barn while the cows were being milked — and all the happy sounds of farm life — the chickens and the pigs — and so forth.

The buildings were in excellent condition, as I can remember. All kinds of equipment: several horses (oh, I don't know) — six or eight cows, half a dozen hogs, a lot of chickens. And my recollection is that they lived very well. 'Cause after all, they had all the milk and eggs and butter and chickens and meat and vegetables that they could want.

The cellar was generally full of root vegetables — and apples — that I can remember, and so forth. I don't remember Grandma [Amelia], but I remember Aunt Lettie, and you never came into the house but what you were offered something to eat. Oh, boy! Oh, those wonderful fresh doughnuts. I swear she always had a kettle of doughnuts on the stove. Made them every day — oh, I should say so. And oh, those biscuits — just a dream! — with this marvelous lamb's liver concoction with gravy. Not for a meal, no! — just for a snack. Food, after all, that was what made life worth living. Well, you can remember Aunt Lettie's size (gee, that's what she lived for — was to eat). And sugar cookies, and of course they had all the butter and eggs they wanted, and I guess they used a lot of molasses; but there was always stuff to eat around, and you were always being offered something.

They sold milk to the colony. It was always sold fresh; because it wasn't pasteurized (they had no ice then). They had six or eight cows. Well, they'd probably have a couple of calves, you know, weaning at the time and they'd always feed what was left over to the pigs and the chickens. They were always dumping sour milk or whatever was left over into the pigs' troughs and feeding it to the chickens, too; so it never went to waste. They made, of course, plenty of butter; but whether they put any down I don't know. I think they just lived from hand to mouth.

I don't know what kind of financial arrangement Father and Uncle Jim had, but it did seem to me there were a number of enterprises that were on a cooperative basis. For example, somewhere in the transitional process we used to get apples from Uncle Charles and Uncle Jim and ship them to Boston (that kind of thing).

Winter apples that would last us well into the winter. And he may have swapped labor for some of the potatoes and root vegetables that we shipped back to Boston. They were often working — helping one another. In retrospect, I get the feeling that Father had a little more know-how.

Well, I'd say the obvious — that he knew how to get things. Harnesses, for example I remember. I think he'd go to fire sales in Boston, and buy up incredible amounts of hardware. (And that's where all that stuff for the Point house came from; all the door-knobs, the hinges, the latches — the whole business). He'd go to a fire sale and buy up a whole car-load of stuff — for nothing! And he just had that ability, to know where to go to get things. I remember his getting these beautiful harnesses: work harnesses, and driving harnesses, for the horses; which if he went out and bought them would cost a fortune. Even in those days a good harness would be an expensive proposition, and I can remember his bringing them home and washing them — shining them up and taking meticulous care of these things. And then, of course, they'd come down here and go to hell. And I can remember a wheelbarrow, for example, that got mixed up in this "cooperative" thing and got broken, and Father saying, "Oh, well, let it go." Things like that. He just had that incredible instinct about how to get things for little or nothing. (He passed it on — right!)

At some point in time before 1916 Orris started thinking about expanding the size of the Colony and building a bigger house for his family of eight children. He may have been thinking ahead to a future time when they would all be grown up with families of their own and would want their own cottages — in any case that is what eventually happened. In 1916 Orris bought an additional thirty acres from his brother James — an undeveloped area to the south of the Colony in an area known as "across the brook." He then made plans and prepared to build his crowning achievement which came to be known as "The Point Cottage" My father's childhood memories of this enterprise give a better idea of what this was like than anything I could write:

It was 1918 when the big cottage on the Point was finished and first occupied. Father had planned the operation and assembled the lumber over a period of years, and I had had a part in that, too! I remember hauling lumber in the cart from the sawmill over at the Cyrus Carver place; driving the horse, loading the lumber, yes, and sticking it! — all alone. I was twelve at the time. All the rough lumber for that cottage came off the place — here and Wharf Rock, and Father got out the logs himself — with the boys — and hauled it off in the winter time, I guess (when they could use sleds) down to Cyrus Carver's sawmill.

In order to cut that much lumber they would have had to have more than one Christmas vacation. The rough lumber, this was: the framing and the siding and the flooring (you know, the first flooring) — all the framework, every bit of it. And I remember one summer — one whole summer, practically — I spent hauling stuff with Kit [the horse] and the cart from the sawmill — almost single-handed, loading and unloading it. And they had a planer down there, too, and the lumber was nicely dressed.

There was a big crew — oh, my gosh — It was a gigantic operation. But, when you think of the amount of building that was going on about that period (after the First World War), it was a pretty sizable business. And it would have been a heck of a lot cheaper to do it that way than to haul it onto the Island, Father did it on shares, I suppose — got back the equivalent of what he took over. Must have been that way, because only an expert can tell by looking at a tree what he's going to do with it. But, as I remember, it was mighty nice stuff. And I think all of the framework was planed (funny, I haven't thought of that in years) — maybe not the sills, but I think the rafters and the joists were — must have been.

That was just the rough lumber. The finished lumber and other supplies were brought over from Camden by boat from the Hobbs lumber company, and unloaded right on the beach. Father would get the boat (this was in the days of the old Knox engine), go over to Marsh Cove, take the old seine boat in tow, get it over there and load it right down to the gunwales with everything you can imagine. All kinds of lumber — finished lumber — like matched boards and flooring, shingles, bricks, nails, cement, and so on.

The return trip was always a question mark. It's never like a millpond coming across the bay in the afternoon: I don't recall ever having a really smooth crossing. That southwest wind in the afternoon is always right there to meet you, and sometimes it would be north or northwest, which would be even worse.

But the one trip that I remember best was when the lashings, (you know, that tied the lumber down) came loose, and they began to slide all over the place. The thing that I remember was Father going up alongside in the launch and jumping up on top of this mess of boards sliding all over the place and lashing them down again! Everybody holding his breath, because I don't think Father could swim. I'm sure he couldn't. Out there in the

middle of the Bay rolling around in the trough of those waves. Oh, brother! And just a bunch of kids in charge of the motorboat. Oh, gee! Well, Lyford must have been seventeen or eighteen. I know I wasn't big enough to know much about a motorboat.

On the end of the thing we'd run the seine boat up on the shore at high tide and wait for the tide to go out, of course, and then come down with the cart. That is — for some of the building that was done around here. I think for the Point house everything was carried up the beach by hand over on that beach. For the Metcalf cottage we'd come down to the side shore beach on your road, here. Yes, even before the Point house was built we went through the same process as far as lumber was concerned, for the barn was built a long time before the house was even started. So there was a heck of a lot of lumber sawed down at Cyrus's. He sawed all the rough lumber for the barn too; I think some of the material for the Gates's house came from there, too, and I think the same thing was true of the Metcalf cottage that was true of the Point cottage: I think the rough lumber came from that mill.

Of course, Father was in charge — full charge: there was no question about that. He was the "contractor" sure enough. 'Cause he had a set of blueprints that were fairly reliable, you see. Although I think Mr. Blake was here part of the time, 'cause he was the architect, but there was certainly no contractor other than Father. Of course he had help. I can remember Uncle Jim doing some of the carpentry. You see, those floor timbers were all mortised — I mean, the main joints were mortised. I don't know why I remember that particular feature, because that would have been a familiar thing, taking into account the kind of structure these barns and houses had. You mortised the joint rather than just overlapped.

And Ray, I know, did a lot of work on it, and I think Uncle Charles, Harry Whitmore I think may have, and Al Whitmore certainly had something to do with it, because Al and Father had that kind of relationship. I assume all the construction was done and completed in a single season; I really don't know. I suppose it could have been left open if none of the partition and flooring was in — it's barely possible. I don't know if you could get all that done in one summer, I really don't. It would take some doing, you know, with all those windows and, doors, and the roof and the sides. As I remember it, the foundations were done one summer; they were done ahead. Yeah, I can sort of see them there; this is one of the things that was inconsistent with my impression of Father's judgment, that he didn't make any real foundations — except for the fireplace (thank God he did!). Apparently his theory was that these were all rock-piles that would settle at the same rate; and it didn't work out that way.

Sadly, Orris only enjoyed three seasons with his family at the Point Cottage. After a short illness, he died of cancer on May 4, 1921. His death was unexpected, least of all by him, since he died without leaving a will — an uncharacteristic oversight given his reputation for careful

planning and administration in both his personal and professional life. Orris' Colony, however, continued on without him. Each of his eight children established and used a summer residence there and one, Eliot, settled on the Island and lived there year-round.

The Point Cottage built by Orris first occupied in 1918.

Death of a Farm

As long as the two brothers, Orris and James, were alive and healthy their partnership worked well to keep Benjamin's farm a going concern and to support Orris's Colony and family during the summer, but James' health began to fail around 1921, Orris died in May of that year and James died a year and a half later in December of 1922. In 1929 James' widow, Lettie, married George Thurston, but he apparently had no interest in farming. In fact, according to Lettie's nephew, Vernon, George was a misguided gold-digger with no interest in her welfare at all. I don't know how much truth there is in his story, but this is what Vernon recorded.

Did you ever hear the real story of Aunt Lettie and her second husband? Well, it appears that this old gentleman ... got into a fracas up in the Rockland area and he had to go into the hospital for something, and he got acquainted a little bit with Lottie Beverage [wife of Fremont Beverage, Orris' first cousin]. And he went back down there [near Bar Harbor] and he found out that Lottie Beverage's mother left a big estate down there. Oh, yes, Lottie's mother and father [Nancy Lyman and Henry Smith] run quite a hotel down there; 'n' for a time Uncle Fremont used to send down a lot of stuff — garden produce — to sell down there.

But time went on and he thought this thing over, and ... he was real interested in Aunt Lettie, and he told me that he had two pieces of property up there in Dorchester, Massachusetts, 'twas worth around five thousand dollars apiece (open land) and so on; and so he used to come on over here and talked with me, and I s'pose that he talked with Lettie, and finally he married her.

And she told me (that was one time I wished she'd done what I told her) — she asked me what I thought about her marrying him, and I told her.

"Why," she said, "he's got all kinds of money; he tells me that all I got to do is marry him and I'll find out I won't have to put my hands in dishwater again."

And I says, "Well, I tell you, Aunt Lettie, I really don't like to tell people what I'd do, but if I was you I'd get my eye on some of them bankbooks. I question it."

Well, finally things went along, and I went in there, and she told me — she says, "Well, I guess I made an awful mistake not paying any attention to what you said." she says, "It turns out now that the old man didn't even know who he was marrying. He come to me yesterday or day before, and he said, "Things ain't going good here, really, and we ain't got all we need." and then he says, "You better let me sell that piece of property for you that's laying down there to Bar Harbor."

I says, "What the devil are you talking about, anyway? I never owned anything down there." "Well," he says, "ain't you the woman that I got partly acquainted with over to the hospital there in Rockland?"

Whether it is true or not that George Thurston thought he was marrying the rich widow Lottie Beverage when he married Lettie Beverage, it makes a good story and gives some indication of what the family thought of him. James and Lettie had eight children, and they all survived childhood: Ray, Vernita, Carl, Robert, Theodore, Edward, Alton and Dorothy. Most of them lived out their lives on the Island.

None of them, however, were able to or interested in keeping the farm going. This is not a reflection on James and Lettie as parents or on their children. The fact is that, by 1940, there were only nine households on the island that made more than $500 from farming. By 1950 there were maybe one or two. Many young people were leaving the Island, and those who stayed were, for the most part, working for or providing services to the Summer People.

Orris' brother Charles and his wife, Annie, lived down the road from Lettie. They weren't much better off than Lettie. I suppose their son, Vernon helped them out some. Charles died in 1938, but Annie lived on alone there until 1960 when she died at the age of 97. Vernon and his family were living at home with them until about the time Charles died when he moved to the farm on the South Shore which had belonged to Charles and Orris' cousin Fremont Beverage, his widow, Lottie having died in 1938. My father gave his impression of the gradual decline of Benjamin's farm:

The old place was well kept up as long as Uncle Jim was alive. You could tell from the pictures that you've seen of Grandma sitting out in front of the house that things were well cared for. And the orchard was in good condition and large plantings of fodder corn; and in those days they planted several kinds of grain: oats, and a kind of grain they called "Hungarian." It's a very rich green kind of thing; there were sizable plantings of this sort of thing. But things changed. Well, of course Ray married and went off. He was always the mainstay; the rest of the kids didn't really pull their weight in the boat, and that may have been one reason.

And then Uncle Jim's health began to fail quite seriously, and he had to be sent away to a convalescent home. And, of course, poor Aunt Lettie she was just one of the good-hearted. Mother used to try to come up and give her moral support but, without Uncle Jim's help, and without Ray, the whole thing got just absolutely hopeless. I don't know whether Ray lost interest. He used to come up once in a while and try to do a few things around. After all, he had to raise his own family. He didn't have an easy time of it, 'cause he had nothing to go on but his own ability.

And once I went down alone in the spring and stayed here at the farm. It was the year Father died (that was the year I was supposed to graduate from

Latin School). Father died the eleventh of May, [1921] and Mother and Olive brought Father's body down here. And the funeral was here shortly after, of course, and I guess they decided that I ought to come down and try to get something started for the summer.

So I remember Olive taking me — going in with me to the boat (at fifteen! that was the summer before I went to college) and I came down and lived here, in this house. Aunt Lettie was here all the time, of course, and I think Dorothy [2] and Alton [4] and Eddie [5] and maybe Ted [12]. Most of us slept up in the open chamber. Funny, I can't remember what I really did, except I began to work on the woodpile, and I got some of the garden planted and I got the Cottage opened (because we had already started taking in boarders) and I guess I had to do some painting and the annual ritual of shellacking the floors, and so forth.

But nobody had anything to eat, much, except potatoes; and there was a case of Campbell's Soup which was down cellar — left over from the summer before — 'cause whenever anybody around here had canned stuff left over after the summer they'd always bring it up here and leave it here so it wouldn't freeze. So that was our main source of supply this case of Campbell's Soup. And for years afterward that was a standard joke between Aunt Lettie's family and me — was the fact that we lived on Campbell's Soup. Not very nourishing, but I think we had some potatoes, yeah. I don't know what else — maybe some eggs. And a cow. I guess there was a cow — and the makings for bread (must have been). I think by that time Aunt Lettie was living on the Town. I didn't spend much time thinking about that sort of thing. Oh, poor dear!

I don't know when the turning point came; I really don't. 'Cause at one stage of the game Father began to be a little more independent and had his own horse and cow; and we kept a couple of pigs one summer, and. we had a chicken coop. After all! Up 'til that time Uncle Jim would just let Father use a horse either for plowing and cultivating, or for driving. Because there were plenty of horses around, and there wasn't any problem. If you wanted a horse you went out in the pasture and got one!

They cooked and heated with wood at Uncle Jim's, of course. I can remember there was always a gigantic woodpile out there; and there is that one snapshot, you know, of Father standing in front of it that we have in our scrapbook. Gigantic woodpile oh! Incredible. When it was fitted and dry ready for the stove, they put it in the woodshed, near the house. Yes, there was a woodshed there: I think it was used almost exclusively for wood. And, of course, in the later unfortunate days, when they began to run out of wood they began tearing the shingles off the wood-shed! And that's what happened to that poor building — the shed, itself, was thenceforth used for firewood. God save the Mark!

So in the end, after Alton enlisted in the Army in 1943, Lettie was living in the farmhouse with only her son Robert, his wife, Ellen, and

two young children. Robert's weight and heart condition made working problematic. He was occasionally employed by the town to drive the steamroller for road paving, but that is about all he was capable of. Aunt Lettie sold the content of her gravel pit to the town for, I believe, fifty cents a load. This was hardly enough for the household to survive on so they were getting support from the Town, a matter of some embarrassment for the rest of the family. Lettie died in 1949, and then when Robert died in 1952, his cousin, my Uncle Eliot, bought the property and Benjamin's farm was reincarnated for another sixty years.

Beveridge relatives and friends on the front steps of the "Point Cottage," North Haven, Maine, July 4, 1936. (last name is Beveridge/Beverage unless otherwise noted)
6th (top) row: LaForrest, Ralph, Robert, Edward, Theodore, Vernon, Walter Joyce, Lowell, Harold Joyce
5th row: Nellie, Dorothy (Howard), ?, Milton, Virginia Joyce (Brown), Carl, Frances, ?
4th row: Vernita Joyce, Alice, Lawrence, Arletta "Lettie," Ruth, Robert Barclay, Lyford
3rd row: Charles, Albion, Ida, Grace, Ella, James, Olive Barclay, Helen Barclay, Eliot
2nd row: Dorothy, Charles, Florence Budlong, Olive, Mrs. Patton, Rose, Annie, Mrs. Gates, Charles Gates
1st row: Nancy, Patton Lockwood, Lowell "Pete," Ann, Norma Barclay, Polly.

This picture taken on the Fourth of July, 1936, marks an occasion which was unusual and possibly unique. It shows the summer residents of The Colony together with their "native" neighbors, the descendants of Orris' brothers Charles and James. By this time there was little social interaction between the two groups.

Yes, I frequently dropped by to see Aunt Annie when I picked up the mail by her house, and occasionally stopped by Aunt Lettie's to enjoy one of her homemade donuts. Since Aunt Lettie had the only telephone in The Colony a rare emergency required a visit to her house, but there was not the daily intimate sharing and socializing that characterized the life of the Summer Colony.

This picture illustrates the divide between the two groups in that, for the most part, the "natives" are on the top two rows and the "summer" people are on the bottom two rows, with a little mixture taking place in the two middle rows. A notable exception is my father standing on the top right in what seems to me an effort at integration.

Following is some of what I know about the people in this picture: Orris' brother Charles is sort of hanging off the end of the third row on the left looking as though he wasn't sure he belonged there. He was still living in the farmhouse down the road which he bought from his sister, Hattie, and her husband, Daniel Green. He died two years after this picture was taken, the last of Orris' living siblings, with the exception of youngest brother Robert who was still alive in Attleboro and, as far as I know, never visited North Haven after he left in 1891.

Charles' wife, Annie, is sitting uncomfortably in the second row next to my grandmother Rose. Annie, for some reason, hated to have her picture taken. Charles and Annie's only son, Vernon, is in the back row on the right with the glasses. His wife, Nellie, is on the far left of the fifth row. At this time they were still living in the farmhouse with Charles and Annie and their four sons, who are also in the picture.

Forrest, the very tall man in the back on the left was born in 1916, finished four years of high school, volunteered to serve in the army during WW II, and reached the rank of master sergeant. He was seriously wounded and lost a leg in the battle of Leyte Gulf. After discharge he married Shirley Foss, whose father owned a laundry business in Lynn, Massachusetts. She was a graduate of the English High School in that city. She was divorced from William T. Evans by whom she had two children, Sharon and Gary. Forrest worked as a watchmaker. He and Shirley had a daughter, Linda.

The second son, Milton, attended the North Haven High School and went on to get a law degree at Suffolk Law School in Boston. He then volunteered to serve in World War II. He was a 1st Lieutenant in Army Intelligence. While in the Army he married, in 1942, Barbara Perry of Rockland. Her father was a cook at the state prison in Thomaston.

She had finished high school and was working as a stenographer in a lawyer's office in Rockland at the time.

Three years after their marriage Barbara tragically died while giving birth to her daughter Barbara Jill. Barbara Jill was raised by her grandparents, Vernon and Nellie, on North Haven. In June of 1948 the widower, Milton, married Ruth V. Duran of Bangor. She was a graduate of the University of Maine, Orono, and at the time of her marriage was working in the office of her father's trucking company, Border Express, Inc. of Bangor. Milton and Ruth raised three sons: Clarence (born 1950), Peter (born 1953), and David (born 1958).

Ralph, the third son of Vernon and Nellie, was killed in a hunting accident on North Haven at the age of seventeen just three months after this picture was taken.

The youngest son, Lawrence, was born in 1921. He completed high school and finished one year of college. In May of 1942, at the age of 20, he married Dorothy Louise Thayer. Five months later he enlisted in the army. Dorothy was 17 at the time they married. She was from the Island, the daughter of Raymond and Florence Thayer. Raymond was a carpenter.

Lawrence and Dorothy lived in Lynn, Massachusetts, as well as in Maine and Connecticut. He worked as a grocer and dairyman, among other things. They raised seven children: Lawrence, Jr., Gary, Ralph, Paul, Raymond, Bonnie, and Wayne. Four of them married someone from the Island and three of them settled on North Haven: Larry, Paul and Bonnie. Garry settled in New Jersey; Raymond had a career in the military and also settled in New Jersey; Ralph lived in Florida and then in Bath, Maine. Wayne lived in Florida and a short time on Island and then back in Florida.

Aunt Lettie is sitting proudly in the middle of the fourth row. Six of her eight children are in the picture: Robert (on the top row third from left) was 22 years old and living at home. He had completed 2 years of high school and a year after this picture was taken, married Ellen Parsons of North Haven. Ellen was the daughter of Herbert, a fisherman, and Ruth (Dole) Parsons. Ellen had previously been married to Maynard Pierce, an automobile mechanic from Appleton in Knox County. In 1940 Robert and Ellen were still living with his mother, Lettie, at the farmhouse.

Robert made $252 working as a laborer on the town road. They had four children: Thelma, Roberta, Frances and Hugh. Thelma died in infancy and their youngest child, Hugh, was adopted by Ellen's sister, Thelma, and her husband, Paul Start, who were living in Camden. Robert, like his mother, had a serious weight problem which affected his heart. He died young at the age of 48. Ellen remarried to Gerald Mossman, a machinist from Vinalhaven, and they settled in Rockland.

Next to his brother, Robert, is twenty-year-old Edward who had completed high school and later in the year married Norma Howard of North Haven. Norma was 14 at the time and pregnant with their first child, Edward, Jr. Norma was the daughter of Freeman, a yachtsman for a summer family, and Ethel (Small) Howard. Eddie worked as a laborer and was the butcher at Hopkins' Store. In 1940 he made $700 and was paying $10 a month in rent. Eddie died when he was 45.

Next to Eddie is his older Brother Ted, 28 years old. He was married to Florence Ella Brown (known as Ella), of North Haven, in 1932. She is in the third row holding their young son James. They both had completed two years of high school. Ella was the daughter of Corydon and Frances (Dole) Brown. Corydon was a farmer and caretaker and boatman on a summer estate, Florence took in laundry. In 1940 Ted earned $600 working as a farm hand for his Brother Ray, and paid $10 a month for rent. That year they moved to Stafford Springs, Connecticut. The couple had four children: James, Barbara, Ted, Jr., and John. Ted suffered from asthma and died at the early age of 56.

Lettie's youngest child, Dorothy, is sitting next to Nellie in the fifth row. She was 18 at the time and still living at home. At the age of 20 she married Wendell Howard of North Haven. They both graduated from high school. Wendell was the brother of Norma, the wife of Dorothy's brother Edward. In 1940 they had no home of their own and were living with Norman Morrison and his family. They had five children: Merton, Leslie, Faye, Delbert and Ray. Wendell worked as a laborer; he died at the age of 50 in 1964 before the three younger children had left home. Dorothy worked at many jobs to support her children. In later years she worked at the North Island Design Shop where she also sold her knitting. She also operated a bed a breakfast in the village.

Not in the picture is 21-year-old Alton. He had finished one year of high school and lived at home working as a laborer until he enlisted in the Army at the age of 25 in 1943. He married Regina Idczak from Falwark, Poland, in 1946. I assume they met when he was in Europe with the Army. They settled in Hartford, Connecticut. In 1949-51 he was working as a checker at UCorp, a financial service company. They raised two children: Mary and James. Alton died at the age of 48.

The three oldest siblings, Ray, Vernita and Carl were in the earlier picture of Amelia and her grandchildren, and I talked about them there. Ray is not in this picture, but Carl and his wife Frances are as well as Vernita and her husband Walter Joyce and their two children: 16-year-old Virginia and 13-year-old Harold.

Orris' Legacy

Second Generation

This picture of Grandmother Rose surrounded by her children and their partners was taken the same year as the previous picture of the extended family sitting in front of the Point Cottage in Maine. The contrast in dress and setting is striking. The two pictures together have always represented to me the double life lead by Orris, his eight children, and the sixteen cousins in my generation.

Rose Beverage with her children and their spouses, Christmas 1936, at home of Arnold and Priscilla in Lexington, Massachusetts. rear l to r: Albion, Lyford, Norwood, Arnold, Bob Barclay, Eliot, Lowell; center: Ruth, Helen Barclay, Rose, Olive, Florence Budlong, front row: Priscilla, Jimmy, Grace, Ida and Dorothy.

Eleven of us cousins had already been born when this picture was taken, ranging in age from new-born to eight years. I wonder where we were when this picture was posed. It must have been quite a production under the direction of Uncle Eliot, whose hand you can see on the light switch next to Lowell's shoulder on the right. That indicates the picture was taken, not with a timed flash, but by posing everyone in the dark and than turning on the room lights to make the exposure.

Grandfather Orris Lyford Beverage.

Olive Amelia, the oldest daughter attended Girls Latin High School and earned an AB from Radcliffe College in 1911, and an MA from Brown in 1916, After working as a nurse during World War I in a Boston City Hospital, she embarked on a career as a high school teacher in the Boston public school system, teaching English for many years at the Hyde Park High School. Sometime prior to 1930 she met Florence Budlong, also a teacher, and they became lifelong companions, living together for the rest of their lives. Florence's family was from Providence, Rhode Island. Her father was a partner in a jewelry manufacturing business as was her Brother, Frank.

Boston Latin School on Warren Avenue where five of Orris' sons attended high school.

Aunt Olive Beveridge at Radcliff graduation 1911.

Aunt Florence Budlong, Aunt Olive's life partner.

In 1926 Aunt Olive bought from Helen Metcalf the land and cottage she had built behind the Red Cottage on the hill. She spent summers there with Florence until she sold it to her Brother Arnold in 1947.

Helen was valedictorian of her class at Girls High School and captain of the basketball team at Radcliffe where she gradated cum laude in 1916 at the age of 20. She taught at Girls High School in Boston and in Spencer, Massachusetts, New Britain, Connecticut, and Barre, Vermont, where she met her future husband, Robert Barclay. His mother, Isabella Maywood, had emigrated from England in 1885 and his father, also Robert, came from Scotland in 1879 and had settled in Barre, where he worked as a stonecutter in the granite quarries.

Helen Beveridge at Radcliff graduation 1916.

Robert studied engineering at Norwich Military Academy and earned a degree in education from Boston University in 1929. There were no jobs for a young engineer during the depression in the early 1930s so he entered into a career in education administration eventually becoming Superintendent of schools in Grafton, Massachusetts, and later in South Kingstown, Rhode Island.

Uncle Bob Barclay about 1933.

In 1922 Aunt Helen bought from Herman and Sarah Regnell the land and the house they had built in North Haven in which Orris and his family had lived until the Point House was built. She called it "Kenjockety." She married Uncle Bob in 1925 and they spent summers there with their two daughters. She retired from teaching in 1930 to raise her two daughters, Norma and Olive. Robert died at the early age of 49 in 1947 and she returned to teaching to support herself and her daughters. The subjects she taught included English, French, Drama and Glee Club.

Lyford, the oldest son, attended Boston Latin School where he was an outstanding athlete and graduated from Harvard College in 1922 at the age of 21. For most of his career he taught Latin at Scarsdale High School and later became head master there.

Uncle Lyford married Ruth Reynolds in 1925. Aunt Ruth had a difficult childhood. She finished high school, but did not go to college. Her father, a store superintendent in Boston where she was born and brought up, died when she was a teenager. Her mother, a native of Canada, had to move in with her sister and her sister's husband.

Ruth had talent and ambition as a popular singer, but did not pursue a career in that profession. Daughter Ann was born in April of 1928 — she was Rose's first grandchild. At first Lyford and Ruth stayed at the Point House during the summer; then they moved into the Red Cottage in 1932 after my father vacated it.

Lyford then started planning and working on his own cottage on a promontory just north of the Point Cottage. I believe it was 1935 when it was finished enough to occupy. It must have been at least 1937 by the time he got around to putting shingles on it, because I can remember "helping" with that work although I was only seven at the time. The basic cottage was about the same size as the one my father built, but it had two bedrooms on one end.

Aunt Ruth, Cousin Ann and Uncle Lyford about 1936.

Lyford's cottage occupied about 1935.

Arnold also attended Boston Latin and graduated cum laude from Harvard in 1924 at the age of 20. He became a CPA and spent most of his career as a Director and Treasurer of the Foxboro Company, a manufacturer of precision control instruments. He was the only one of Orris' children who was not in the teaching profession.

Uncle Arnold married Priscilla Delano in 1926. She had a relatively privileged childhood and graduated from college. She was brought up in Rockville Centre, Long Island, where her father was a physician.

When Arnold first brought Priscilla to the Island they stayed in the Point Cottage with Grandmother Rose. Priscilla continued to spend summers there with their two children, Irene and Frank, and Arnold joined them when he could get away from his business for a week or long weekend from time to time. When Rose died in 1939 there was an informal agreement among her children that Arnold and his family would continue to use the Point Cottage as their summer home in return for which Arnold for many years paid the taxes on the entire property and took responsibility for maintaining the Cottage.

Uncle Arnold and Aunt Priscilla at their wedding in 1926.

Lowell, my Father, attended Boston Latin School and received an AB from Harvard in 1925 at the age of 19. A year later he married my mother, Ida Louisa Gattrell, who grew up in Newburyport, Massachusetts. Her mother, Eliza, was from County Cork, Ireland, and her father, Charles Gattrell was from the Isle of Wight, England.

Lowell Beveridge, class picture Harvard 1923.

They emigrated when my mother was less than one year old, and Charles spent the rest of his life employed as chief caretaker for the estate of F. S. Moseley, a Boston Stock Broker. My mother and her two sisters all graduated from the town high school, trained as teachers at the Bridgewater State Normal School, and taught school prior to getting married. Lowell went on to earn an AM in 1928 and a Ph.D. in 1943.

He was a professor of music at Wellesley College when I was born in 1930 and then moved to Columbia University where he was professor of music and director of the university choir for many years. He changed careers at midlife when he enrolled at Virginia Theological Seminary and eventually was ordained an Episcopal priest in 1952. He served on the faculty there until he retired.

Ida, Lowell and Pete Beveridge on Oak Hill about 1936.

After my father and mother were married in 1926 they spent their first few summers together at the Point Cottage with Grandmother Rose and his unmarried siblings. When I was born in 1930 they occupied the Red Cottage on the Hill. He decided to ask Rose for permission to build a cottage on the family property, which she granted. This was the first new building on the property since the completion of the Point Cottage in 1918.

He started construction in the spring of 1931 and by the end of the summer had completed enough work so that the structure was weather tight. The following summer they lived in the cottage while he built the fireplace and chimney and the partitions. The next year the kitchen cabinets and the loft over the kitchen were constructed. In 1934 he added the screened in piazza on the north side. That August he also built the "bath house" which also served as a tool shed and work shop.

Lowell Building his cottage.

Lowell's cottage occupied in 1931.

Lowell had advice from his older brother, Lyford, but did most of the work himself while Ida took care of her infant son and kept house as best she could living in a perpetual construction site. He had some help with the masonry and finish carpentry work from local craftsmen, Bill Lobley and Ernest Whitmore, a distant cousin.

Lowell and Ida slept on a double bed on the piazza protected from the elements by canvas shades. I slept on a bunk in the dressing room over a bank of built-in drawers which I outgrew when I was six, so in 1936 Lowell built a platform for an 8' × 8' canvas tent where I slept on a cot and was later joined by my brother, Tom, born in 1938.

Once the basic construction was finished in 1934, Lowell started work on landscaping the area. He cleared space to the east of the cottage for a lawn and badminton court, planted fruit trees and an extensive flower garden. For several years he also maintained a vegetable garden further up the road to the Barn. In 1936 the furnishing of the cottage was completed when Lowell moved in a beautiful rosewood Chickering square piano he bought from Cousin Frank Beverage for $35. For entertainment there was also a wind-up Victrola with wooden needles.

Albion Beverage family on the Point about 1940. l to r: Grace holding Albion, Jr., Nancy, Polly, Albion, Sr. holding Rosie, (Lyford was not yet born).

Lowell dug and curbed a well at the bottom of the path to the beach, but the water was not potable and it sometimes dried up. He installed a large galvanized iron tank on a concrete base to catch rainwater from the roof. He mounted a wooden copper lined box on top of this tank and a hand-operated pump. The pump made filling the box with water from the tank possible and, from there, water could be gravity-fed into the kitchen sink.

Drinking water was hand-carried across the beach from The Spring adjacent to the Patton's property and kept in a large crock on a shelf in the kitchen. Cooking was done on a kerosene stove which was kept filled from a five gallon can kept out behind the bath house. Cooling was provided by an icebox kept filled with ice from a sawdust pit by the side of the road filled every spring by Elmer Hopkins with ice harvested from Fresh Pond.

Albion did not follow the pattern of his siblings. For reasons lost to history, he did not attend Latin School but, instead, attended Cushing Academy a boarding school in Ashburnham, North Central Massachusetts, where he finally graduated at the age of 19 in 1926. He made a reputation there as the famous Boston Schoolboy athlete starring in football and hockey. After graduation he had a brief carrier as a professional wrestler, he also fished and built boats for a while.

Her father, Robert George Reed, was born in Newfoundland. He made a living as a salesman and later owned and operated an upholstery shop in Boston. Her mother, Annie Sarah. Mackinnon, was born in Nova Scotia.

After his marriage to Gracie, Albion tried a number of jobs in Boston, but then the depression hit in 1929. He took Gracie and his two oldest daughters to North Haven where we joined the islanders for a year just trying to survive by fishing. In the spring of 1933, he had a new plan: Reverend Henry Huse, pastor of the North Haven Baptist Church, was a friend and mentor. His college roommate was President Gray of Bates College and with some calls and arrangements Albion enrolled at Bates, and also became student pastor of the Oxford Maine Federated Church. In the fall of 1933 the family left the island and drove to Oxford where they moved into the parsonage. Albion took over the duties of the parish, and drove weekdays to Lewiston to the Bates' campus for a heavy load of classes and study. He was the first to graduate in three years from Bates College. Gracie helped with parish duties like Sunday school and afternoon calling.

Following graduation from Bates, Albion moved to Boston in the fall of 1936 where he enrolled in Divinity School. His family lived at the family house, 24 Nixon Street, on the third floor and he attended classes at Andover Newton. In 1937, he moved to new Gloucester Maine where he became pastor at the Congregational Church. He preached every

Sunday, conducted the choir and performed all parish duties. Weekdays he took off for Boston to attend theological classes.

From 1938 to 1942 he served as secretary of the Maine Christian Association at the University of Maine where he also coached football and wrestling, taught in the Arts College, and organized and conducted the famous Men's and Woman's Glee Club, In 1940 he received a degree from the non-denominational Bangor Theological Seminary and became an ordained minister.

In 1943 he was appointed Legislative Secretary for the National Council for the Prevention of War. In the summer of 1948 he campaigned on an anti-war platform against Margaret Chase Smith in the Republican primaries for the United States Senate. His activities brought him to the attention of the inner circle of the Republican Party. He worked for Senator William Langer of North Dakota, and later for William Jenner of Indiana before his untimely death of a heart attack in 1951 at age 43.

In 1928 Uncle Albion and his new wife, Aunt Gracie, laid claim to the family barn, and over the years made substantial renovations and improvements to house their five children there, Nancy, Polly, Rosie, Albion, Jr. and Lyford. Their daughter, Rosie, recorded her memories:

Our family moved into the family barn, I am told, sometime in the Roaring Twenties, when my young father arrived from Boston with his band, to play for some dance here on the island, and our grandmother decided they should stay "at the barn" rather than in the Point Cottage. We've been going there ever since.

I don't remember when the stalls were removed. I presume that after our grandfather's death, the family no longer kept a "summer" cow and horse, but my earliest memories of the barn were when the floor joists had already rotted out and the floor boards sat on the bare ground, with tufts of grass growing through.

One of the Uncles stored a car there in the winter, which always had to be removed through the big sliding barn door when we arrived and, for years after that, one or more boats was stored there during the winter. The sills were rotting out, and it became more and more impossible to get the big sliding door to open at all. Then our father died, and there was no one to do the jacking and blocking and repairing, and no money to do it with!

Albion, Jr. was eleven and Lyfie was seven! But still, we wanted to be at North Haven, and we kept coming. There was no water, either. Then we had no car. Still, we wanted to be at North Haven and we kept coming!

I watched my mother haul water from the brook and wash clothes my hand, and cook fish by candlelight on a smelly kerosene stove that we were delighted to get "second hand." I watched my young brothers learn by themselves how to jack up a building and replace a rotting sill! I watched my mother, throughout her entire life, guard her meager resources until there

was something WORTHWHILE to spend her money on, like drilling the first well on the whole point, installing a pump and inviting everyone to use the water!

I hope I may be forgiven for being less than tolerant of the prevailing modern attitude that everything we've always "made do with" is so substandard that it's not worth saving or using now.

Uncle Eliot and Aunt Dorothy "Jimmy" Gattrell Beveridge in front of Eastern Bay Farm.

Eliot attended Boston Latin and earned an AB at Harvard in 1930, an AM in 1931 and an Ed.M. in 1934. He taught art at the State Normal School in Johnson, Vermont, from 1935 to 1946, and in the public schools of the Camden-Rockland area from 1944 to 1946. Thereafter he earned his living through private art lessons and the sale of his craftwork and watercolor paintings of New England landscapes and scenes.

In 1935 Uncle Eliot married my mother's sister Dorothy, otherwise known as Jimmy. That same year he started to work building a stone "castle" on a rocky outcrop off the Point called Little Island. It was an island only at high tide. Low tide exposed a sand bar across which one could walk to access it. As he worked alone, carrying each rock up the steep slope and setting it in place with mortar, it grew very slowly — too slow for its intended purpose as a home for the new family which, by 1935, included my double-cousin, Charles.

The Castle on Little Island built by Eliot with local stones.
Picture taken before it was completed with a roof.

Eliot's creative imagination hit on an alternate solution, which he may have intended to be temporary, but turned out to be quite permanent. He purchased an old lightboat and hauled it up on shore, cut a hole in the hull for a front door and fitted out the interior as a cozy living space. His family was able to occupy it in 1936 and he went on to finish the castle, which was never used as originally intended but stands today as work of art and tourist attraction.

The retired lightboat boat that Eliot hauled up on Little Island and converted to a summer house for his family.

Eliot and Jimmy continued to summer in the house-boat until 1954 when he became the first and only one of Orris' children to return to the Island as a year round resident. He and Jimmy bought Benjamin's original farmhouse from the heirs of his Uncle Jim and Aunt Lettie. They did extensive renovations and installed modern conveniences such as running water, a flush toilet, electricity, insulation, and central heating. They named the property Eastern Bay Farm.

Eliot became an early enthusiast and advocate for organic farming. They grew food, raised livestock and generated cash income by selling crafts, Eliot's paintings, and numerous other enterprises. Shortly after his move to the Island, Eliot added one more structure to the property. He designed and built, entirely out of recycled materials, a charming little cabin named "The Doll House" and moved it to its present site by the edge of the water down by Wharf Rock. I have spent many pleasant nights there listening to the gentle lapping of the waves and the calls of the loons and gulls, smelling the salt marsh and the spruce trees and looking out over the islands in the bay.

Uncle Eliot, an early advocate, was featured in Organic Gardening in 1980. Shown here tending his compost pile at Eastern Bay Farm.

Norwood graduated from Boston Latin, earned an AB from Harvard in 1932, and an MA a few years later. He embarked on a carrier teaching Latin and music, among other subjects, in high school. He taught at a day school in Utica and in private schools in New York City, Camden, Maine, and Washington, D.C. After all that experience he went back to school to qualify to teach in public school in Maryland where he taught until he retired.

For several years in the 1940s Norwood ran a boys summer camp at the farm owned by Cousin Constance Carver. He retired to Camden, Maine, where he wrote a column for the local paper and articles for Down East magazine and wrote The North Island: Early Times to Yesterday, North Haven, Maine.

Uncle Norwood married Dorothy Woodrow in 1932. Dorothy's father, James, emigrated from Nova Scotia and settled in Cambridge, Massachusetts. He was the proprietor of a drug store and later of a radio store.

Dorothy was born and grew up in Cambridge and graduated from Radcliffe College. Dorothy and Norwood had three children: Deborah, Norwood, Jr., and Arthur. Debby was born the year the new cottage was occupied. She shared her memories:

The cottage built by Norwood was done in stages with the largest room complete and inhabited around 1935. When Norwood asked his mother, Rose, for permission to build she told him to go as close to the Mullin line as possible and so he did. It was not on a site he would have chosen himself due to the cliff and inhospitable beach. However, we, his children, love the location with its gorgeous sunrises, island views and variety of beach life.

There are photos showing me as a toddler in front of the main room with my mother and older brother. The earliest memories I have are that a section of the main room was curtained off for the two cots for Bro and me. A sink was at the far end of the room and presumably a stove. The first room to be added was the kitchen, possibly around 1941. We had an icebox and a three-burner kerosene stove on which I baked my first cake. The last room to be added was a bedroom, attached at the doorway where we used to exit the cottage, possibly around 1942.

The earliest road I remember went past the Point Cottage, and hugged the shore past Boat House Beach and up to Birch Point at which point it went inland and ended where we currently park. ... Sometime in the 1930s Norwood dug a spring a short distance up the hill in back of the cottage and for a time it provided drinkable water. Sometime in the 1960s a hose was connected to the spring and we were able to siphon "running" wash water to the kitchen sink.

The Doll House built by Eliot and moved to the water front near Wharf Rock.

Cottage built by Norwood completed about 1935.

Uncle Norwood and Aunt Dorothy Beveridge.

That all eight of Orris and Amelia's children survived childhood was unusual for that time and place. They not only survived but thrived and went on to graduate from college and have successful professional careers. This was an amazing tribute to the parenting of Rose and Orris.

Rose, in addition to all her motherly duties, inculcated a love of music and was, I believe, the first piano teacher for at least four of her children who taught or performed music in their professional lives. The educational opportunities available free or at reasonable cost in Boston at that time also played a role in this remarkable family accomplishment.

Tuition at Boston Latin and Girls Latin High Schools, two of the best schools in the country, was free. Tuition at Radcliffe and Harvard College was $200 a year when my father graduated in 1925. Orris' two jobs and careful husbanding of resources enabled him to supplement money earned by each of his children at odd jobs to pay for tuition, books and supplies.

In 1940, a few years after this picture was taken, 24% of the adult population of the country had graduated from high school and 4.6% had a college education or higher. All eight partners of Orris' children were high school graduates and five of them were also college grads. This was indeed an unusual family for the times.

A review of the 1940 census of the district in Dorchester where they grew up indicates that 54% of the adults had graduated from high school, almost twice the national average, but college graduates were only 3.75, slightly less than the average. The comparable statistics for North Haven were not much different: 2.8% college graduates and 43.1% high school graduate or higher.

It is interesting to note that six of the eight children from this family whose roots in New England go back many generations married partners who were first generation Americans, whose parents had been born abroad. A rough survey of the 1920 Census for the Dorchester district in which they grew up shows that this was pretty much the norm for that neighborhood: of the roughly 400 contemporary heads of families and their spouses, about 90% were native born, but half of their parents were born abroad, mostly in Ireland, England, Scotland, Canada and Germany.

Third generation

When Grandfather Orris was born in 1860, only two out of ten people in this country lived in a city. By 1905 when my father was born the figure was four in ten; in 1930 when I was born it was six in ten and by the time I became a father in 1963 seven in ten people were living an urban life. In that period of time the country had changed from a nation

of farmers to a nation of city dwellers. I had the rare good fortune to participate in both the rural and urban life.

I lead two lives: for three months out of each year I was immersed in a rural life-style similar to that of my grandfather's early years, although certainly not identical. The other nine months I lived the life of an urban middle class child in Manhattan's upper west side. I consider this to have been a rare and unusual privilege not available to my private school classmates who were otherwise, for the most part, more privileged than I economically.

View from Birch Point toward Boat House Beach.

I look back on those summer seasons of my first eighteen years with pleasure and recognition that they were a major influence during my formative years. As the oldest male in my generation, I do realize my treatment may have been more privileged than some of my cousins. It was a carefree time, but structured by the constraints of the natural world, the mentoring of my uncles and aunts, and interaction with my cousins.

The beach in front of the cottage which Benjamin built comes to a point, which gives the cottage the name of the Point House. At that spot is a large, flat rock about the size of a small living room. It is called Flat Rock and is a perfect place for a picnic. Ever Saturday night, for as long as I can remember, it has been a family tradition to gather there for a picnic supper. The menu was usually hot dogs cooked over an open fire supplemented by shared baked goods and dishes prepared by those who wanted to show off their cooking. These occasions are among my fondest childhood memories.

A favorite place for us cousins to play was Boathouse Beach. This was south of the Point on the way to Norwood's Cottage. It is the only place on the colony's shoreline where the terrain slopes gently down to the water and a large boat can easily be hauled directly onto land. Orris built a boat house at this site to shelter the family launch over the winter. The structure stood there until I was grown up. It finally collapsed due to lack of maintenance.

Other family-owned boats were often beached for the winter and left in this vicinity. The boats were hauled out with the aid of a large winch that had an arm long enough for four or five people to push at one time. Putting the boats in the water in the spring and hauling them out at the end of the summer was a group project involving the entire family. When it was empty of boats it made a wonderful arena for all sorts of childhood games.

A small shed near the boathouse built for Grandmother Rose by her sons, as a personal retreat, was appropriated by her grandchildren as a playhouse. The proximity of a number of abandoned boats made it an ideal site for games of dress-up and pretend. While she was alive Rose helped us make costumes and puppets for games and performances. The wonderful trunk full of dress-up clothes and props lasted long after her death in 1939 as a source of inspiration and creativity. A memorable puppet show re-enacted the Plymouth Colony story of John Alden's wooing of Priscilla Mullins with the help of Miles Standish.

Pete with Grandmother Rose under the big spruce tree in the front yard of The Point Cottage, 1934.

The lawn and the beach in front of the Point House, the house itself and the surrounding woods were the setting for childhood games of hide and seek, kick the can, king of the mountain, and blind man's bluff. On rainy days we moved these activities onto the wide porch or inside the house where we were encouraged, not always successfully, to indulge in quieter games of Parcheesi, Chinese checkers, tiddlywinks, jacks, and endless games of Monopoly.

A collapsing structure on the old Mullin's farm taken about 1940 where the Town Park is now a favorite destination for raspberry picking.

Pete with Shiny, our family rowboat, tying the painter to the running line prior to pulling it out to the mooring.

We played on a swing hung from a branch of the large spruce tree in front of the house and on a monkey bar, a trapeze and a seesaw up in the woods behind the house. When we got older we organized games of badminton, horseshoes, croquet and softball. Sometimes the adults would join us. Uncle Lyford was unbeatable in horseshoes — he must have perfected his skill as a young man. Aunt Olive put me to shame shooting hoops with a basketball.

We spent endless hours swimming and playing in the cold, cold water. Every year we made a raft out of driftwood and anchored it offshore as a swimming destination and diving platform. Then there was beach combing — not just for firewood and lumber, but everyone had collections of interesting shells, stones beach, glass and driftwood.

Boating was a major pastime. From an early age we all learned rules of safety on the water and how to handle rowboats, sailboats and motorboats. The family fleet varied from year to year, but we all had access to at least a basic twelve-foot rowboat. These were moored offshore attached to running lines and used for trips to nearby island and shore points as well as for access to the larger boats moored further off shore.

Pete with Lowell in Aunt Olive's punt getting an early lesson in rowing.

Eliot, Lowell and Lyford hauling in the family launch.

A popular day-trip was to Mullins cove to pick raspberries which grew wild around the ruins of the old Mullin house where pulp wood cutters had left a large cleared area with a tangle of treacherous underbrush under foot. On occasion, we would dig a mess of clams for bait and go fishing in the bay for flounder.

These recreational activities by no means occupied all of our time. The maintenance of the buildings, boats, equipment and land was a time consuming-communal responsibility. My father and his siblings had been doing this since childhood and I enjoyed doing it with them and learning from them. The roads needed constant attention — digging and clearing the ditches, cutting back the growth on the sides, clearing away fallen trees and branches, filling in potholes and ruts. The bridge over the brook needed constant repair. The woods had to be cleared of fallen trees and underbrush and paths kept clear and opened up. Fields and lawns — such as they were — needed mowing and trimming. Firewood had to be cut and bucked and split.

Uncle Lyford finishing up work on making a mooring stone.

Buildings constantly needed painting, repairing the shingles and flashing on the roof, glazing the windows and occasionally replacing a sill or pile. Every year the boats had to be scraped and sanded and painted. The large boats had to be hauled on shore for the winter and launched at the beginning for the summer.

The moorings had to be brought in for the winter and set out again at the beginning of the season. Occasionally a mooring would be lost and have to be replaced. To make a mooring by hand out of available material one would cut a log about five or six feet long, drill a large hole in one end for the hawser and attach a chain to the other end with shackle (you would have to buy or recycle the chain and shackle). Then you find a big stone, drill a hole in it with a stone drill bit and hammer, insert an eye bolt with a long shank (also bought or recycled) into the hole, heat the end of the shank and bend it by banging with a hammer so that it can not pull out of the hole. Be careful not to bang too hard or you may split the stone. Attach the chain to the eyebolt with another shackle and you are ready to set the mooring.

If you were smart you worked on that big stone down below the high water mark so, when the tide came in, you could lift it by attaching the mooring to you boat, then row the boat out to where you want to set the mooring and let it drop. Be careful not to get tangled up in the chain when you drop it.

My daily chores included fetching drinking water from the spring, filling the kerosene stove and lamps, filling the icebox with ice from the ice pit, bringing wood indoors from the wood pile, building and tending the fire in the fire place, sweeping out the cottage and my sleeping tent.

Music was an important part of our life. Every cottage in the Colony had a piano or organ in it. Almost everyone could sing and most played an instrument. Grandmother Rose, my father, Norwood, and Albion all played the piano. I played the flute, Ann played the Clarinet, Norma the trumpet, Frank the saxophone, Arthur the trumpet, Charles the French horn, and others played the recorder.

Sometimes on Saturday evenings after the traditional family picnic everyone would gather at the Point house for an old-fashioned songfest singing hymns and folk songs. So there was much music making — and dancing. Each house had a wind-up Victrola. The one at the Point Cottage got a particularly heavy workout evenings when I and the five girl cousins near my age would dance away the evenings occasionally joined by Aunt Helen doing a waltz or polka. It was the era of swing — jitterbug and lindy hop. We worked hard at developing sensational steps and moves. We were completely oblivious of African-American origins of the music and dance.

When I became a teen-ager, I found myself in need of earning some money. My parents kept me comfortably supplied with food, clothing,

shelter and education, but not much else and my allowance of twenty-five cents a week did not go far in meeting my other expenses which were mainly related to girls and dating.

In those days boys were expected to pay for everything in that category. So I set about marketing the skills I had learned. My first job was working for my father's cousin, Vernon, Orris' nephew. He was caretaker of the Zimmerman estate and hired me as the gardener and grounds keeper. Cousin Norma was the upstairs maid, so I had company on the job.

The next summer I worked as a house painter for Forrest Adams and spent most of the summer working on the houses of the Pettit and Lewis estates on the North Shore Road. The following year I went to work for Tonny Calderwood as a hired hand on his farm — one of the last working farms on the Island. I worked for him three seasons in a row.

Postscript

That Orris died intestate was, in some ways, a fortunate accident. He might have left his property to his oldest son, as was often done in those days, or he might have divided it among his children. Instead, The Colony became a de facto cooperative venture with his heirs being tenants in common, an arrangement which has worked reasonably well for over ninety years since his death in 1921. This ephemeral entity with no formal charter, administration or membership has managed to pay the taxes, maintain the roads, and, for the most part, maintain peace and harmony among the heirs.

Several years ago, however, some fault lines began to appear: the taxes have increased over the last twenty five years by a factor of more than six to over $20,000 a year putting a strain on some family budgets; the market value of the property has increased over the same period and is now worth several million dollars — a tempting asset to some families who never or seldom visit and would prefer to cash out their inheritance; members of my third generation are now all past retirement age and the rugged life style is no longer as attractive or manageable as it used to be; some of our spouses were never all that enthusiastic about it even when younger.

A division of the property had always been supported by some of the heirs. Eventually all of the second generation came around to accepting that concept, but they never could agree on the details. I believe it was 1994 when the third generation held the first formal meeting to discuss the future of The Colony with some favoring division and some favoring some more formal cooperative structure. Every few years another meeting was called with further discussion, but no concrete results. Finally some of the heirs decided to go to court. Several years and many thousands of dollars in lawyer fees later in March 2014 a judge of the Maine State Superior Court handed down a ruling dividing The Colony into eight roughly equal parts. No one is happy with the decision, but all are reconciled to it.

The new owners of four of the eight lots intend to sell them thus reducing the area of Benjamin's Colony by half. There are thirteen surviving heirs in my third generation, 40 in the fourth generation and 89 in the fifth generation. I have lost track of the sixth generation but I suppose eventually they will number about 200. About a third of these heirs will no longer have the right of access to the property. For the remaining two thirds it will be a different place. It remains to be seen what will happen. Some will probably continue to spend an entire season in The Colony, others will visit occasionally, some have never visited there, and never will, but I hope that every Saturday night during the summer season all present will gather for a family picnic at Flat Rock on the Point.

Acknowledgements

My father, Lowell Beveridge, was an enthusiastic and conscientious archivist and recorder of family history. I owe to him my similar interests as well as most of the original documents of Orris' life now in my possession. When my Uncle Eliot Beveridge moved back to the Island in 1953 he helped to establish the North Haven Historical Society, and researched Island genealogy which he then recorded on index cards. These are now in the possession of the Society and are a major source for my data base of Island genealogy. Eliot also recorded and transcribed a number of oral history interviews which are also deposited with the Society and from which I have quoted extensively. My Uncle Norwood did extensive research in Island history which he published in The North Island: Early Times to Yesterday, North Haven, Maine. I have relied heavily on his work. My cousins Barbara Beverage Reeves and Allan Dale Beverage have contributed from their extensive knowledge of family history through private correspondence and their privately published James Beverage Descendants: A Family History. My third cousin Samuel Hiram Beverage, one of the founders of the Historical Society, has generously shared his vast knowledge with me on many occasions. I am indebted to the research of cousin Rosie Beverage Christensen for information about the family of our grandmother Rose Emma Pierson Beverage. Thanks also to cousins Deborah Woodrow Beverige and Charles Eliot Beveridge for information and access to material. Descendents of other members of the original colony have also contributed information: Merrill Budlong, Donald Regnell, Richard Howe, and Scott A. Brown. The good people at North Haven News have helped me keep up to date with Island births marriages and deaths through the monthly feature "Along the Road".

New England has a remarkable corps of professional and volunteer librarians, archivists and historians. I was preveleged to benefit from the help of several of them and offer my thanks to: John Carnahan of the Brattleboro Historical Society; John M Falla, Town Manager, St George, Tenants Harbor; Bryan Finnemore, Resident of the Redington Museum, Waterville, Maine; Yvonne Gloede, Director, Jackson Memorial Library, St. George, Maine; Libby Harmon, Archivist, Whitefield Historical Society, Maine; E. Bruce Kirkham, Librarian, Historical Society Library, Augusta, Maine; Julie Macksoud, Director, College Relations Research, Colby College, Waterville, Maine; James Merrick, Special Collections, Miller Library, Colby College, Waterville, Maine; Bill Plaskon, Membership and Data Manager, Jonesport Historical Society, Maine; Laurie J. Rosenberger, Assistant to the Executive Vice President, Phi Delta Theta Fraternity, Oxford, Ohio; Tracy E. Smith, Director of Alumni & Parent Relations, The Boston Conservatory; Jeanne Walsh, Reference Department, Brooks Memorial Library, Brattleboro, Vermont; Cheryl

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For Caro, my love, you may have come from a different Island, but that has not diminished your understanding, patience, and love for which I am grateful and thankful.

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Appendix

Ancestors of Orris Lyford Beverage

Generation 1

1. Orris Lyford Beverage, son of Benjamin Crabtree Beverage and Amelia Beverage, was born on 11 Aug 1860 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 04 May 1921 in Dorchester, Suffolk, Massachusetts. He married Ella May Thompson on 24 Dec 1883 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts. She was born on 31 Mar 1855 in North Anson, Somerset, Maine. She died on 13 Jan 1884 in Cape Elizabeth, Cumberland, Maine. He married Rose Emma Pierson on 11 Jul 1887 in Tenants Harbor, Knox, Maine. She was born on 27 Nov 1866 in Tenants Harbor, Knox, Maine. She died on 04 Oct 1939 in Orono, Penobscot, Maine.

Generation 2

2. Benjamin Crabtree Beverage, son of James Beverage and Jamima Crabtree, was born on 02 Oct 1822 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 17 Dec 1875 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Amelia Beverage on 19 Feb 1854 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

3. Amelia Beverage, daughter of Norwood Beverage and Hannah Grant, was born on 04 Feb 1833 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 12 Feb 1908 in North Haven, Knox, Maine (Age: 75).

Amelia Beverage and Benjamin Crabtree Beverage had the following children:

i. Theodore E. Beverage was born on 03 Jul 1855 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 28 Jun 1874 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

ii. Harriet N. Beverage was born on 02 Sep 1856 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 06 Mar 1900 in Kenduskeag, Penobscot, Maine. She married Daniel A. Green on 18 Feb 1882 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born in Dec 1854 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. He died in 1924 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine.

iii. James Beverage was born on 05 Aug 1858 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 30 Jul 1863 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

iv. Orris Lyford Beverage was born on 11 Aug 1860 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 04 May 1921 in Dorchester, Suffolk, Massachusetts. He married Ella May Thompson on 24 Dec 1883 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts. She was born on 31 Mar 1855 in North Anson, Somerset, Maine. She died on 13 Jan 1884 in Cape Elizabeth, Cumberland, Maine. He married Rose Emma Pierson on 11 Jul 1887 in Tenants Harbor, Knox, Maine. She was born on 27 Nov 1866 in Tenants Harbor, Knox, Maine. She died on 04 Oct 1939 in Orono, Penobscot, Maine.

v. Charles H. Beverage was born on 13 May 1862 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 26 Apr 1938 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Annie Ursula Leadbetter on 02 Jan 1883 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 09 Jun 1863 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died in 1960 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

vi. Jemima A. Beverage was born on 06 Nov 1866 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 08 Dec 1894 in Levant, Penobscot, Maine. She married Fred S. Carver on 30 Nov 1887 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 18 Sep 1860 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 30 Dec 1939 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

vii. James Norwood Beverage was born on 06 Nov 1866 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 17 Dec 1922 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Arletta Gertrude Thayer on 25 Dec 1895 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 13 Apr 1878 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died in May 1949 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

viii. Mary E. Beverage was born on 27 Feb 1869 1952. in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died after 1930. She married Lamont E Bemis on 30 Nov. Knox, Maine. He was born on 27 Feb 1869 in Wellington, Piscataquis, Maine. He died on 16 Nov 1952.

ix Robert Edwin Beverage was born in Jul 1872 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died about Aug 1944 in Attleboro, Bristol, Massachusetts. He married Grace Louise Fowler on 28 Nov 1901 in Attleboro, Bristol, Massachusetts. She was born on 16 Sep 1882 in Attleboro, Bristol, Massachusetts. She died about Jun 1945 in Taunton, Bristol, Massachusetts.

Generation 3

4. James Beverage, son of Thomas Beverage and Mercy Kent, was born on 03 Oct 1789 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 05 Dec 1850 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Jamima Crabtree on 10 Jan 1822 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

5. Jamima Crabtree, daughter of Eleazer Crabtree and Lucy Train, was born on 15 Jun 1792 in Watertown, Middlesex, Massachusetts. She died on 12 May 1837 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

Jamima Crabtree and James Beverage had the following children:

i. Benjamin Crabtree Beverage was born on 02 Oct 1822 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 17 Dec 1875 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Sarah W. Loveland on 19 Oct 1848 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born about 1831 in Camden, Knox, ME. She died after 1910 in Camden, Knox, Maine. He married Amelia Beverage on 19 Feb 1854 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 04 Feb 1833 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 12 Feb 1908 in North Haven, Knox, Maine (Age: 75).

ii. Harrison Beverage was born on 04 Sep 1825 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 16 Apr 1901 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Eldora M. Brown on 23 Jan 1870 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 12 Jan 1853 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 09 Mar 1909 in Union, Knox, Maine (Age: 56).

iii. Albert Glover Beverage was born on 31 Oct 1827 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 25 Dec 1888 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Olive Leadbetter Carver on 02 Dec 1851 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 12 Aug 1829 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine (Leadbetter Isle.). She died on 17 Oct 1909 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

iv. Lucy C. Beverage was born on 01 Jan 1830 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 07 Dec 1850 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

6. Norwood Beverage, son of John White Beverage and Rachael Lucy Crosby, was born on 16 Feb 1810 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 28 Mar 1868 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Hannah Grant on 02 Sep 1832 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

7. Hannah Grant, daughter of Solomon Grant and Catherine Lassell, was born on 04 Apr 1811 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 21 Dec 1875 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

Hannah Grant and Norwood Beverage had the following children:

i. Amelia Beverage was born on 04 Feb 1833 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 12 Feb 1908 in North Haven, Knox, Maine (Age: 75). She married iv.

ii. Robert Beverage was born in Jan 1835 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 06 Jul 1850 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

iii. Orris Beverage was born in Dec 1836 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 06 Jul 1850 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

iv. Lyford Beverage was born on 30 Sep 1841 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 20 Jun 1908 in Hammonton, Atlantic County, New Jersey. He married Mary Medora Verrill on 03 Feb 1867 in Atlantic County, New Jersey. She was born in 1848. She died on 25 Mar 1897 in Hammonton, Atlantic, New Jersey.

v. Thomas Beverage was born on 24 Oct 1845 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 25 Nov 1845 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

vi. Dana Hanson Beverage was born on 06 Feb 1847 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 25 Nov 1909 in Camden, Knox, Maine. He married Mary Margaret Barrett on 26 Apr 1868 in Camden, Knox, Maine. She was born on 01 Apr 1842 in Camden, Knox, Maine. She died on 07 Aug 1924 in Camden, Knox, Maine.

Generation 4

8. Thomas Beverage, son of James Beveridge and Jean McKinney, was born on 28 Nov 1750 in Topsham, Sagadahoc, Maine. He died on 04 Oct 1834 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Mercy Kent on 13 Apr 1774 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts.

9. Mercy Kent, daughter of Ezekiel Kent and Susanah Winslow Bryant, was born on 02 Oct 1754 in Marshfield, Plymouth, Massachusetts. She died on 28 Feb 1819 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

Mercy Kent and Thomas Beverage had the following children:

i. John White Beverage was born on 15 Aug 1774 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 01 Jun 1839 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Rachael Lucy Crosby on 02 Feb 1800 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 25 May 1778 in Edgartown, Dukes, Massachusetts. She died on 30 Nov 1863 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

ii. Nathaniel Winslow Beverage was born on 17 Jan 1776 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 20 Nov 1864 in Camden, Knox, Maine. He married Diana Daggett on 17 Jan 1802 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 31 Dec 1780 in Edgartown, Dukes, Massachusetts. She died on 22 Feb 1856 in Camden, Knox, Maine.

iii. Benjamin Kent Beverage was born on 19 Sep 1779 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 20 Dec 1851 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Betsy Douglas on 25 Jan 1802 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 26 Sep 1784 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 22 Nov 1854 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

iv. Mercy Beverage was born on 15 Oct 1782 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 04 Apr 1817 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She married Henry Alexander in 1804 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 04 Apr 1777 in Topsham, Sagadahoc, Maine. He died on 04 Dec 1854 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

v. Sarah Beverage was born on 20 Mar 1787 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 28 Nov 1844 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

vi. Lydia Winslow Beverage was born on 01 Apr 1787 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 24 Nov 1791 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

vii. James Beverage was born on 03 Oct 1789 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 05 Dec 1850 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Jamima Crabtree on 10 Jan 1822 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 15 Jun 1792 in Watertown, Middlesex, Massachusetts. She died on 12 May 1837 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

viii. Josiah W. Beverage was born on 10 Jul 1793 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 20 Dec 1857 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

ix. Lydia W. Beverage was born on 11 Apr 1796 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 19 Feb 1829 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

x. Abigail Beverage was born on 21 Feb 1803. She died on 22 Feb 1803 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

10. Eleazer Crabtree, son of Benjamin Crabtree II and Jemima Briggs, was born on 04 Feb 1733 in Attleboro, Bristol, Massachusetts. He died on 03 Jul 1824 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine (North Island). He married Lucy Train on 11 Apr 1776 in Weston, Middlesex, Massachusetts.

11. Lucy Train, daughter of Samuel Train and Rachel Allen, was born on 03 Jun 1757 in Weston, Middlesex, Massachusetts. She died on 06 Jun 1802 in Portland, Cumberland, Maine.

Lucy Train and Eleazer Crabtree had the following children:

i. Lucy Crabtree was born on 26 Feb 1781 in Hancock, Hillsborough, New Hampshire. She died after 1850 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. She married Peter Getchell on 30 Apr 1810 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 30 Mar 1783 in Brunswik, Kennebec, Maine. He died after 1830.

ii. David Crabtree was born on 26 Feb 1781 in Hancock, Hillsborough, New Hampshire. He died on 04 Nov 1859 in Augusta, Kennebec, Maine. He married Melatia Hawes on 02 Jun 1825 in Union, Knox, Maine. She was born on 21 Apr 1791 in Union, Knox, Maine. She died on 17 Feb 1858 in Hope, Knox, Maine.

iii. Rachael Crabtree was born after 1783 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died date Unknown. She married Charles Clapp. He was born in Bath, Sagadahoc, Maine. She married Charles Clapp. He was born in Bath, Sagadahoc, Maine.

iv. Eleazer Crabtree II was born on 10 Sep 1783 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died in 1865 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Lois Robbins on 10 Dec 1818 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 24 Feb 1799 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 14 Jul 1861 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

v. Benjamin Crabtree was born on 04 Aug 1786 in Hancock, Hillsborough, New Hampshire. He died on 19 Sep 1869 in Camden, Knox, Maine. He married Julia Glover on 10 Feb 1818 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 20 Apr 1787 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. She died on 13 Apr 1880 in Camden, Knox, Maine.

vi. Samuel P Crabtree was born on 12 Oct 1789 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 17 Jul 1865 in Hopr, Knox, Maine. He married Cynthia Metcalf on 20 Mar 1822. She was born on 12 Jul 1800. She died on 05 Mar 1861 in Hope, Knox, Maine.

vii. Jamima Crabtree was born on 15 Jun 1792 in Watertown, Middlesex, Massachusetts. She died on 12 May 1837 in North Haven,

Knox, Maine. She married James Beverage on 10 Jan 1822 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 03 Oct 1789 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 05 Dec 1850 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

viii. Nancy Crabtree was born on 15 Apr 1796 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 14 Sep 1866 in Camden, Knox, Maine. She married Elijah Glover on 20 Mar 1822 in Hope, Knox, Maine. He was born on 27 Aug 1792 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 16 Sep 1868 in Camden, Knox, Maine.

12. John White Beverage, son of Thomas Beverage and Mercy Kent, was born on 15 Aug 1774 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 01 Jun 1839 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Rachael Lucy Crosby on 02 Feb 1800 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

13. Rachael Lucy Crosby was born on 25 May 1778 in Edgartown, Dukes, Massachusetts. She died on 30 Nov 1863 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

Rachael Lucy Crosby and John White Beverage had the following children:

i. Thomas Beverage was born on 30 Nov 1800 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 23 Jun 1808 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

ii. Sarah Beverage was born on 25 Mar 1802 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died before 1850. She married William Banks Jr. on 09 Mar 1837 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 29 May 1803 in Butter Island, Knox, Maine. He died on 25 Sep 1901 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine.

iii. Nathaniel Beverage was born on 20 Oct 1803 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 18 Sep 1886 in Rockland, Knox, Maine. He married Sarah Alexander on 26 Apr 1838 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 08 Jul 1808 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 14 Jul 1864 in Rockland, Knox, Maine.

iv. Abigail Beverage was born on 11 Oct 1805. She died before 1830.

v. Robert Beverage was born on 10 Dec 1807 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 11 Feb 1854 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Lucy Verrill on 22 Jan 1837 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 16 Feb 1815 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 19 May 1872 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

vi. Norwood Beverage was born on 16 Feb 1810 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 28 Mar 1868 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Hannah Grant on 02 Sep 1832 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She wa born on 04 Apr 1811 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 21 Dec 1875 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

vii. Jane M. Beverage was born in Mar 1812 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 27 Apr 1896 in Providence, Providence, Rhode

Island. She married Asa Dyer on 29 Oct 1843 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born in 1810 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died after 1870.

viii. Thomas Beverage was born on 23 Dec 1814. He died before 1830.

ix. Lydia W. Beverage was born on 10 Mar 1818 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 08 Jan 1877 in Rockland, Knox, Maine. She married John H. Handley on 18 Nov 1849 in Rockland, Knox, Maine. He was born on 16 Apr 1820 in Hope, Knox, Maine. He died on 02 Sep 1902 in Rockport, Knox, Maine.

x. Josiah B. Beverage was born on 05 Jun 1821 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 16 Nov 1918 in Vinal Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Jane M. Young on 13 Oct 1844 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 16 Sep 1823 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 04 Nov 1909.

14. Solomon Grant, son of Andrew Grant and Elizabeth Dunton, was born on 05 Mar 1773 in Hampden, Penobscot, Maine. He died about 1851 in North Haven, Knox Co., Maine. He married Catherine Lassell on 12 Apr 1794 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

15. Catherine Lassell, daughter of Ellison Lassell and Martha Maloney, was born on 17 May 1769 in Islesboro, Waldo, Maine. She died in 1860 in Old, Forsyth, North Carolina.

Catherine Lassell and Solomon Grant had the following children:

i. Lydia Grant was born on 02 Aug 1794 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. She died on 23 Jul 1887 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She married Ebenezer Young on 11 Jul 1820 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 24 Mar 1784 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. He died on 26 Feb 1857.

ii. William Grant was born on 15 Sep 1796 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 14 Sep 1814 in Burlington, Chittenden, Vermont.

iii. Rachel Grant was born on 30 May 1797 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. She died after 1860. She married Mathew Whalen on 13 Aug 1820 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. He was born in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. She married Charles Carver on 06 Nov 1833 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. She married David Harrington Tolman on 12 Jul 1847 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

iv. Elisha Grant was born on 19 Apr 1799 in Islesboro, Waldo, Maine. He died on 31 May 1869 in Otis, Hancock, Maine. He married Sylvinia Philbrook on 17 Mar 1821. She was born on 17 Sep 1805 in Islesboro, Waldo, Maine. She died on 09 Jul 1881 in Otis, Hancock, Maine.

v. Zeruah Grant was born on 04 May 1802 in North Haven, Knox, Maine (North Island,Fox Islands). She died on 06 May 1879 in East

Gloucester, Essex, Massachusetts. She married John C Wheeler on 10 Apr 1826 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 05 Dec 1794 in Harpswell, Cumberland, Maine. He died on 14 Dec 1876 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

vi. Diadama Grant was born on 26 Mar 1803. She died after Mar 1855.

vii. Andrew Grant was born on 28 Aug 1804 in Vinalhaven North Island, Knox, Maine, USA. He died on 11 Oct 1868 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Deborah Lindsey on 14 Apr 1828. She was born on 14 Apr 1828 in Vinalhaven North Island, Hancock, Maine, USA. She died on 19 Jul 1879 in Rockland, Knox, Maine.

viii Louis Grant was born on 28 Dec 1807.

ix. Eliza J Grant was born on 23 Nov 1808 in North Haven, Knox, Maine (North Haven: Port Clyde, ME). She died on 17 Jun 1892 in Morrell, Maine. She married Richard Brown Jr. on 15 Feb 1831 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 27 Dec 1808 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 03 Oct 1900 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine.

x. Hannah Grant was born on 04 Apr 1811 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 21 Dec 1875 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She married Norwood Beverage on 02 Sep 1832 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 16 Feb 1810 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 28 Mar 1868 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

Descendants of Benjamin Crabtree Beverage

Generation 1

Benjamin Crabtree Beverage was born on 02 Oct 1822 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 17 Dec 1875 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married (1) Sarah W. Loveland, daughter of Elijah Loveland and Susan M. Peas, on 19 Oct 1848 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born about 1831 in Camden, Knox, ME. She died before 1854 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married (2) Amelia Beverage, daughter of Norwood Beverage and Hannah Grant, on 19 Feb 1854 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 04 Feb 1833 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 12 Feb 1908 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

Generation 2

Benjamin Crabtree Beverage and Amelia Beverage had the following children:

i. Theodore E. Beverage was born on 03 Jul 1855 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 28 Jun 1874 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

ii. Harriet N. Beverage was born in 1856 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died 6 March 1900 in Kenduskeag. She married Daniel A. Green, son of Robert Green and Nancy on 18 Feb 1882 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born in Dec 1854 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. He died in 1924.

iii. James Beverage was born on 05 Aug 1858 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 30 Jul 1863 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

iv. Orris Lyford Beverage was born on 11 Aug 1860 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 04 May 1921 in Dorchester, Suffolk, Massachusetts. He married (1) Ella May Thompson, daughter of Fletcher Thompson and Martha Gray, on 24 Dec 1883 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts. She was born on 31 Mar 1855 in North Anson, Somerset, Maine. She died on 13 Jan 1884 in Cape Elizabeth, Cumberland, Maine. He married (2) Rose Emma Pierson, daughter of Capt Albion Pierson and Olive F. Hart, on 11 Jul 1887 in Tenants Harbor, Knox, Maine. She was born on 27 Nov 1866 in Tenants Harbor, Knox, Maine. She died on 04 Oct 1939 in Orono, Penobscot, Maine.

v. Charles H. Beverage was born on 13 May 1862 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 26 Apr 1938 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Annie Ursula Leadbetter, daughter of Xenophon Leadbetter and Rebecca Calderwood, on 02 Jan 1883 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 09 Jun 1863 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died in 1960 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

vi. Jemima A. Beverage was born on 06 Nov 1866 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 08 Dec 1894 in Levant, Penobscot, Maine. She married Fred S. Carver, son of Hanson T. Carver and Louise B. Turner, on

30 Nov 1887 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 18 Sep 1860 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 30 Dec 1939 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

vii. James Norwood Beverage was born on 06 Nov 1866 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 17 Dec 1922 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Arletta Gertrude Thayer, daughter of Dighton Thayer and Margaret W. Grant, on 25 Dec 1895 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 13 Apr 1878 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died in May 1949 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

viii. Mary E. Beverage was born on 27 Feb 1869 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died after 1930. She married Lamont E Bemis, son of Nathan Bemis and Ellura Watson, on 30 Nov 1898 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 27 Feb 1869 in Wellington, Piscataquis, Maine. He died on 16 Nov 1952.

ix. Robert Edwin Beverage was born in Jul 1872 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died about Aug 1944 in Attleboro, Bristol, Massachusetts. He married Grace Louise Fowler, daughter of Frank Newton Fowler and Susan Emily Blackinton, 28 Nov 1901 in Attleboro, Bristol, Massachusetts. She was born on 16 Sep 1882 in Attleboro, Bristol, Massachusetts. She died about Jun 1945 in Taunton, Bristol, Massachusetts.

Generation 3

Daniel A. Green and Harriet N. Beverage adopted:

i. Hazel Green was born in Jan 1888 in Massachusetts.

Orris Lyford Beverage and Rose Emma Pierson had the following children:

i. Olive Amelia Beveridge was born on 29 Mar 1890 in Hallowell, Kennebec, Maine. She died on 20 Oct 1968 in Newton, Middlesex, Massachusetts. Her lifetime partner was Florence Merrill Budlong. She was born on 10 Feb 1900 in Providence, Providence, Rhode Island. She died on 15 Dec 1967 in Newton, Middlesex, Massachusetts.

ii. Helen Beveridge was born on 07 Jan 1896 in Brattleboro, Windham, Vermont. She died on 08 May 1984 in Warwick, Kent, Rhode Island. She married Robert William Thomas Barclay, son of Robert Barclay and Isabella Maywood, on 26 Jun 1925 in Dorchester, Suffolk, Massachusetts. He was born on 16 Apr 1898 in Barre, Washington, Vermont. He died on 22 Jul 1947 in Wakefield, Washington, Rhode Island.

iii. Lyford Pierson Beveridge was born on 22 Dec 1900 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts. He died on 03 Jan 1999 in Kennebunkport, York, Maine. He married Ruth Bingham Reynolds, daughter of Bertrand H Reynold and Annie M. on 10 Jun 1925. She was born on 04 Feb 1900 in Massachusetts. She died on 04 Feb 1988.

iv. Arnold Pierson Beveridge was born on 23 Nov 1903 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts. He died on 25 Oct 1987 in Yarmouth, Barnstable, Massachusetts. He married Marion Priscilla Delano, daughter of Frank Thomas Delano and Irene C on 04 Sep 1926 in Rockville Centre, Nassau, New York. She was born on 11 Apr 1900 in Rockville Centre, Nassau, New York. She died on 10 Jan 1996 in Kennebunk, York, Maine.

v. Lowell Pierson Beveridge was born on 19 Sep 1905 in Dorchester, Suffolk, Massachusetts. He died on 18 Jun 1991 in Rockville, Montgomery, Maryland. He married Ida Louise Gattrell, daughter of Charles Gattrell and Eliza Jane Chapman, on 25 Dec 1926 in Newburyport, Essex, Massachusetts. She was born on 28 Dec 1901 in Dunmanway, Cork, Ireland. She died on 23 Jan 1993 in Alexandria, Fairfax, Virginia.

vi. Albion Pierson Beverage was born on 09 Apr 1907 in Dorchester, Suffolk, Massachusetts. He died on 30 Jan 1951 in Silver Spring, Montgomery, Maryland. He married Grace Elizabeth Reed, daughter of Robert George Reed and Annie S. Mackinnon, on 26 Feb 1928 in Dorchester, Suffolk, Massachusetts. She was born on 31 Oct 1909 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts. She died on 07 Jun 2008 in Pittsfield, Somerset, Maine.

vii. Eliot Pierson Beveridge was born on 15 Sep 1908 in Dorchester, Suffolk, Massachusetts. He died on 20 Jan 1982 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Elizabeth Dorothy Gattrell, daughter of Charles Gattrell and Eliza Jane Chapman, on 09 Jun 1934 in Newburyport, Essex, Massachusetts. She was born on 11 Sep 1904 in Newburyport, Essex, Massachusetts. She died on 08 Sep 1991 in Rockland, Knox, Maine.

viii. Norwood Pierson Beveridge was born on 15 Aug 1911 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 05 Aug 1980 in Camden, Knox, Maine. He married (1) Winifred Dorothy Woodrow, daughter of James Arthur Stirling Woodrow and Winifred Ella Bell, on 07 Feb 1932 in Nashua, Hillsborough, New Hampshire. She was born on 09 Jul 1906 in Cambridge, Middlesex, Massachusetts. She died in Aug 1977. He married (2) Elizabeth Babb, daughter of C. Wilkes Babb and Theresa Parker, on 29 Jul 1955 in Camden, Knox, Maine. She was born on 21 Sep 1908 in Camden, Knox, Maine. She died on 11 Jul 1982 in Rockport, Knox, Maine.

Charles H. Beverage and Annie Ursula Leadbetter had the following child:

i. VERNON LINWOOD BEVERAGE was born on 13 Oct 1890 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died in 1979 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married (1) NELLIE MARION AMES, daughter of Frank L. Ames and Genevieve Keisar, on 08 Sep 1915 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She

was born on 07 Jun 1891 in Kenduskeag, Penobscot, Maine. She died in 1961. He married (2) LUCY QUINN, daughter of George Laforrest Quinn and Pauline Hanson, in Jun 1964. She was born in 1913. She died on 09 Apr 2001.

Fred S. Carver and Jemima A. Beverage had the following children:

i. Rose M. Carver was born in Aug 1888 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died after 1930. She married Harold S Tilley, son of Louis K Tiley and Annett B. on 24 Aug 1914 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 21 May 1886. He died on 15 May 1967 in Ashland, Aroostook, Maine.

ii. Constance E. Carver was born in Oct 1889 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died in 1972.

iii. Ralph W. Carver was born in Sep 1894. He married Bernice R. Crockett, daughter of John Brown Crockett and Nellie M Witherspoon, on 18 Jun 1923 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 01 Jan 1897 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 04 Dec 1989 in Auburn, Androscoggin, Maine.

James Norwood Beverage and Arletta Gertrude Thayer had the following children:

i. Ray Mckinley Beverage was born on 18 Nov 1896 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 04 Mar 1954 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Leah Muriel Young, daughter of Charles Herbert Young and Isadore Mills, on 22 Dec 1916 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 22 Dec 1898 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 18 Sep 1985 in Rockport, Knox, Maine.

ii. Vernita Amelia Beverage was born on 23 Feb 1899 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 07 Mar 1955 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She married (1) Walter Manning Joyce, son of Frank A Joyce and Ada B Annis, on 07 Mar 1919 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 05 Jul 1892 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 26 Mar 1939. She married (2) Florent Hanson Arey, son of Frederick Arey and Edith Ellen Beverage, on 26 Mar 1940 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 08 Sep 1899 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. He died date Unknown.

iii. Carl Norwood Beverage was born on 18 Mar 1901 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died in May 1976 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married (1) Alice Gertrude Nutt, daughter of Samuel A. Nutt and Gertrude L. Crabtree, on 13 Jan 1939 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 22 Jul 1912 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 01 Jun 1995 in Rockland, Knox, Maine. He married (2) Frances M. Young on 11 Mar 1925. She was born in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine.

iv. Robert Hanford Beverage was born on 19 Jan 1904 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died in Jan 1952 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

He married Ellen C. Parsons, daughter of Herbert C Parsons and Ruth E Dole, on 11 Jun 1937 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born in 1915.

v. Theodore Elwood Beverage was born on 19 Jul 1908 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 21 May 1965 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Florence Ella Brown, daughter of Corydon S Brown and Florence A Dole, on 21 Apr 1932. She was born in 1915. She died in 1999.

vi.Edward Mansfield Beverage was born on 15 Dec 1915 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 05 Mar 1960 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Norma Irene Howard, daughter of Freeman M. Howard and Ethel M. Small, on 24 Nov 1936. She was born on 27 May 1922 in Rockland, Knox, Maine. She died on 03 Feb 1999 in Buxton, York, Maine.

vii. Alton Thayer Beverage was born on 23 Mar 1917 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 20 Nov 1965 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married (1) Regina Idczak. She was born on 29 Mar 1926 in Falwark, Poland. He married (2) Violachasse.

viii. Dorothy Margaret Beverage was born on 22 Dec 1918 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 16 Aug 2010. She married Wendell E. Howard, son of Freeman M. Howard and Ethel M. Small, on 21 Oct 1939. He was born on 14 Jul 1914 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 09 Sep 1964.

Lamont E Bemis and Mary E. Beverage had the following children:

i. Maynard Beverage Bemis was born on 29 Dec 1894 in Kenduskeag, Penobscot, Maine. He died on 11 Jan 1973 in Pinellas, Florida.

ii. Florence M Bemis was born in 1905.

Robert William Thomas Barclay and Helen Beveridge had the following children:

i. Norma Helen4 Barclay was born in 1930 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts. She married Amedeo C. Merolla, son of John Merolla and Olympia on 18 Jul 1953 in North Brookfield, Worcester, Massachusetts. He was born in 1929 in Providence, Providence, Rhode Island.

ii. Olive Marion Barclay was born on 23 May 1935. She died on 22 Jul 1991 in East Greenwich, Kent, Rhode Island.

Lyford Pierson Beveridge and Ruth Bingham Reynolds had the following child:

i. Ann Morrison Beveridge was born on 08 Apr 1928 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts. She died on 19 Nov 1993 in Port Jefferson, Suffolk, New York. She married John Seaton Titterington, son of John Bertram Titterington and Katherine Maisie Seaton Morrice, on 25 Mar 1960 in Mineola, Nassau, New York. He was born on 08 Feb 1922 in

New York, New York, New York. He died on 24 Jan 1982 in Miller Place, Suffolk, New York.

Arnold Piersiion Beveridge and Marion Priscilla Delano had the following children:

i. Irene4 Beveridge was born in 1928 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts. She married (1) George Hall Sparhawk Jr. He was born on 10 Nov 1927 in Fort Sam Houston, Bexar, Texas. He died on 27 Mar 2011 in Venice, Sarasota, Florida.

ii. Frank Delano Beveridge was born in 1934 in Cambridge, Middlesex, Massachusetts. He married (1) Jeanette Mildred Hopkins, daughter of Elmer James Hopkins and Nina Emeline Cooper, on 20 Apr 1957 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 06 Jul 1934 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 30 Jun 1997 in Portland, Cumberland, Maine. He married (2) Sandra on 24 Dec 1999.

11. Lowell Pierson Beveridge and Ida Louise Gattrell had the following children:

i. Lowell Pierson4 Beveridge Jr. was born in 1930 in Newton, Middlesex, Massachusetts. He married (1) Hortense Sie, daughter of Thorgues Tor Sie and Rachel Hall, on 30 Jan 1954 in New York, New York, New York (St. Phillips' Church). She was born on 03 Oct 1924 in New York, New York, New York. She died on 08 Dec 1993 in Brooklyn, Kings, New York. He married (2) Caroline Bell Watkins, daughter of Harry Ashton Watkins and Barbara Cheney, on 30 Nov 2001 in Brooklyn, Kings, New York. She was born on 26 Nov 1933 in Paris, Ile-de-France, France. She died Aug 17, 2014.

ii. Thomas Gattrell Beveridge was born in 1938 in New York, New York, New York. He married (1) Dianna Carmelina Pezzi, daughter of Vincent Pezzi and Preziosa on 24 Sep 1960 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts. She was born in 1922 in Michigan. He married (2) Meryle Secrest on 23 Nov 1975 in Chevy Chase, Montgomery, Maryland. She was born in 1930 in Bath, Somerset, England.

Albion Pierson Beverage and Grace Elizabeth Reed had the following children:

i. Nancy4 Beverage was born in 1929 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts. She married Robert John Hylander, son of Clarence John Hylander and Doris Dann Leopold, on 11 Jun 1949 in Dresden, Lincoln, Maine. He was born in 1924 in New Haven, New Haven, Connecticut.

ii. Grace Beverage was born in 1931. She married Albert Edward Ball III, son of Albert Edward Ball and Alice on 16 Aug 1952 in Dresden, Lincoln, Maine. He was born in 1925 in South Portland, Cumberland, Maine.

iii. Rose Elizabeth Beverage was born in 1937. She married (1) Thomas O. Shields on 11 Jun 1962. She married (2) Axel Dale

Christensen, son of Axel Christensen and Alma Helmer, on 25 Oct 1967 in Valley City, Barnes, North Dakota. He was born on 22 Sep 1922. He died on 09 Jul 2006 in North Dakota.

iv. Albion Pierson Beverage JR. was born in1939. He married Janice Lynne Marshall, daughter of Elliott E. Marshall, on 10 Jun 1961 in Massachusetts. She was born in1940 in San Diego, San Diego, California.

v. Lyford Pierson Beverage was born in 1943. He married Judith Holiday Thompson on 19 Oct 1961. She was born in 1941.

Eliot Pierson Beveridge and Elizabeth Dorothy Gattrell had the following child:

I. Charles Eliot Beveridge was born in 1935 in Boston, Suffolk, Massachusetts. He married (1) Faye Harwell.

Norwood Pierson Beveridge and Winifred Dorothy Woodrow had the following children:

i. Deborah Woodrow4 Beveridge was born in 1935. She married Thomas Lawson Duff on 17 Aug 1963 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born oin1934.

ii. Norwood Pierson Beveridge Jr. was born in 1936. He married (1) Carol Letty Wentley, daughter of Howard Mcgee Wentley, on 02 Sep 1961 in Mount Lebanon, Allegheny, Pennsylvania. She was born in 1939 in Pittsburgh, Allegheny, Pennsylvania. He married (2) Diane Halpern on 30 Aug 1981 in New York, New York, New York. She was born in 1942 in Jamaica, Queens, New York. He married (3) Martha Baldwin on 02 Jan 1993 in Oklahoma City, Canadian, Oklahoma. She was born in 1941 in Anniston, Calhoun, Alabama.

1. iii. Arthur Woodrow Beveridge was born on 13 May 1943. He died on 07 Aug 2013 in Virginia. He married (1) Pamela R. Blau. She was born in 1946. He married (2) Vundee Vunlikul on 12 Apr 1984 in Springfield, Fairfax, Virginia.

2.Vernon Linwood Beverage and Nellie Marion Ames had the following children:

i. Laforrest4 Beverage was born on 06 Dec 1916 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died in Jun 1967. He married (2) SHIRLEY L. FOSS.

ii. Milton Ames Beverage was born on 10 Apr 1918 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 17 Mar 1993 in Florida. He married (1) Barbara Helen Perry, daughter of Horace Thayer Perry and Ruth Oliver, on 17 Nov 1942 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She was born on 06 Jun 1920 in Rockland, Knox, Maine. She died in 1945. He married (2) Ruth Virginia Duran on 26 Jun 1948. She was born (of Herman, Maine). She died on 14 Feb 2005 in Marlton, Burlington, New Jersey.

iii. Ralph Carlton Beverage was born on 02 Apr 1919 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 10 Oct 1936 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

iv. Lawrence Richard Beverage was born on 03 Aug 1921 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 08 Mar 1982 in Dade City, Pasco, Florida. He married Dorothy Louise Thayer, daughter of Raymond Lee Thayer and Florence Ethel Bray, on 31 May 1942. She was born on 09 Feb 1925 in Revere, Suffolk, Massachusetts. She died on 03 Jun 1978in Portland, Maine.

Harold S Tilley and Rose M. Carver had the following children:

i. Roger B Tilley was born on 30 Apr 1916 in Maine. He died on 18 Aug 2000 in St Petersburg, Pinellas, Florida.

ii. Constance L Tilley was born in 1919 in Maine. She died on 10 Jan 2008 in Gaithersburg, Montgomery, Maryland.

Ralph W. Carver and Bernice R. Crockett had the following child:

i. Ralph M. Carver Jr. was born in 1925.

Ray McKinley Beverage and Leah Muriel Young had the following children:

i. Ray Jasper4 Beverage was born on 12 Sep 1917 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died before 2001. He married Doris Rose Brown, daughter of Foy Weld Brown and Winona Mills, on 26 Apr 1943 in Lynn, Essex, Massachusetts. She was born on 29 Aug 1919 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

ii. Viola Gertrude Beverage was born on 04 Sep 1919 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died before 2001. She married Clyde Elmer Joy, son of Charles Elmer Joy and Emma Saterbee, on 08 Jan 1937 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born on 06 Jun 1913 in Vinalhaven, Knox, Maine. He died on 14 Jun 1971.

iii. Kieth Douglas Beverage was born on 24 Jan 1923 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 27 Aug 2001 in New Haven, New Haven, Connecticut. He married Ethel Marguerite Hamm, daughter of Eugene Hamm and Daisy Arbuckle, on 09 Jun 1947 in Belfast, Waldo, Maine. She was born on 14 Aug 1930 in Monroe, Waldo, Maine.

iv. Victor Mills Beverage was born on 29 Mar 1925 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 04 Apr 1973 in Camp Lejeune, Onslow, North Carolina. He married Mary Elizabeth Muller on 12 Jun 1949 in Roxbury, Suffolk, Massachusetts. She was born on 22 Oct 1922.

Walter Manning Joyce and Vernita Amelia Beverage had the following children:

i. Virginia Lucy4 Joyce was born on 24 May 1920 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 22 Feb 2010 in Rockport, Knox, Maine. She married (1) George William Brown. He was born on 23 Nov 1919. He died in Dec 1983 in Camden, Knox, Maine.

ii. Harold Franklin Joyce was born on 01 Apr 1923 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 06 Jan 1999 in El Paso, Texas. He married Evelyn Louise Brown, daughter of Jesse Franklin Brown and Lula May Copeland, on 03 Oct 1950. She was born on 03 Dec 1928. She died in 1984.

Carl Norwood Beverage and Alice Gertrude Nutt had the following child:

i. Gertrude Margaret4 Beverage was born in1939 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She married Adam Galen Foltz on 18 Aug 1961 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born in1937.

Robert Hanford Beverage and Ellen C. Parsons had the following children:

i. Thelma Margaret4 Beverage was born on 25 Mar 1938 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She died on 21 Apr 1940 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

ii. Roberta Ann Beverage was born in1939 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She married (1) Albert Martin.

iii. Frances Ruth Beverage was born in 1941 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

iv. Hugh Robert Beverage was born before 1946.

Theodore Elwood Beverage and Florence Ella Brown had the following children:

i. James Corydon4 Beverage was born in 1934 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Carol Ann Burchell on 11 Jun 1956. She was born in 1939.

ii. Theodore Elwood Beverage Jr. was born in 1937 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Jean Bertha Lake on 17 Jul 1956. She was born on 21 Nov 1935.

iii. John William Beverage was born on 23 Feb 1947 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He died on 12 Feb 2002 in Tolland, Connecticut. He married (1) Elizabeth Knapp.

iv. Barbara Beverage. She married (1) Robert Mcgill.

Edward Mansfield Beverage and Norma Irene Howard had the following children:

i. Edward James4 Beverage was born in 1937 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Judith Ann Athern on 13 Apr 1963. She was born in 1943.

ii. Carole Louise Beverage was born in1938 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She married (1) Dale Mclaughlin. She married (2) Russell L Ware on 24 Aug 1957. He was born about 1938. He died about 1963. She married (3) Fred Round. She married (4) Towne.

iii. Sharon Yvonne Beverage was born in1944 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She married Wesley Erwin Crockett, son of Leon G Crockett and Mabelle G Bray, on 23 Feb 1963. He was born in1941.

Alton Thayer Beverage and Regina Idczak had the following children:

i. Mary Christie4 Beverage was born in1947. She married Paul McKeever in 1979. He was born in 1942.

ii. James Joseph Beverage was born in 1950. He married (1) Linda. She was born about 1950. He married (2) Susan Storey on 19 May 1996 in Wethersfield, Hartford, Connecticut.

Wendell E. Howard and Dorothy Margaret Beverage had the following children:

i. Merton Wendell4 Howard was born in1942 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He married Nancy Nell Crockett, daughter of Harrison U. Crockett and Maureen Quirke, on 25 Sep 1966. She was born in1942.

ii. Leslie Maxwell Howard was born in1943. He married Paula Eva Romer on 05 Nov 1966. She was born in1948.

ii. Faye Carol Howard was born in1952 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. She married Harold W Cooper, son of Sherman B Cooper and Phyllis E Thayer, on 21 Oct 1973 in North Haven, Knox, Maine. He was born in 1951 in North Haven, Knox, Maine.

iii. Delbert James Howard was born in1955. He married (1) Susan Alden. She was born about 1955.

iv. Ray Matthew Howard was born in 1957. He married Rosemary Young in Manchester, Hartford, Connecticut.